

LESSON 0 · INTRODUCTORY/OPTIONAL
THE SYRIAC ALPHABET

Note: *This lesson is supplementary to the 12-lesson course plan. It is recommended for students with no prior exposure to Syriac script. Students who already read Estrangela may proceed directly to Lesson 1.*

The Alphabet and the Light: The Estrangela Script

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE SCRIPT

Syriac is written from **right to left**. The script used in this course is **Estrangela** (ܐܪܬܪܢܓܠܐ), meaning “rounded.” It is the oldest and most formal of the three Syriac scripts, and it is the primary script used in the earliest manuscripts of the Peshitta and the Acts of the Martyrs.

Core Principles:

1. **22 Consonants:** All letters are consonants. Vowels are indicated by separate small marks or dots (to be covered in Lesson 1).
2. **Connecting Letters:** Most letters connect to the preceding and following letters (like cursive or Arabic). However, 8 letters are “non-joiners” — they only connect to the letter before them.
3. **No Case:** There are no capital letters.
4. **Alaph as Carrier:** The first letter, Alaph (ܐ), is often a silent carrier for a vowel or a glottal stop.

SECTION 2: THE 22 LETTERS (THE ABGAD SYSTEM)

Syriac letters follow the same order as Hebrew and the ancient “Abgad” order of Arabic.

Letters 1–11

ESTRANGELA	NAME	TRANSLIT	PHONETIC	HEBREW	ARABIC
Ⲁ	Alaph	ʾ	Glottal stop/silent	א	أ
Ⲃ	Beth	b / v	b as in ‘boy’	ב	ب
Ⲅ	Gamal	g / gh	g as in ‘go’	ג	ج
Ⲇ	Dalath	d / dh	d as in ‘dog’	ד	د
Ⲉ	He	h	h as in ‘house’	ה	ه
Ⲋ	Waw	w	w as in ‘water’	ו	و
Ⲍ	Zain	z	z as in ‘zebra’	ז	ز
Ⲏ	Heth	ḥ	Pharyngeal ‘h’	ח	ح
Ⲑ	Teth	ṭ	Emphatic ‘t’	ט	ط
Ⲓ	Yodh	y	y as in ‘yes’	י	ي
Ⲕ	Kaph	k / kh	k as in ‘king’	כ	ك

Letters 12–22

ESTRANGELA	NAME	TRANSLIT	PHONETIC	HEBREW	ARABIC
𐤌	Lamad	l	l as in 'light'	ל	ل
𐤍	Mim	m	m as in 'man'	מ	م
𐤎	Nun	n	n as in 'noon'	נ	ن
𐤏	Semkath	s	s as in 'sun'	ס	س
𐤐	'e	'	Pharyngeal stop	ע	ع
𐤑	Pe	p / f	p as in 'paper'	פ	ف
𐤒	Sade	ṣ	Emphatic 's'/'ts'	צ	ص
𐤓	Qoph	q	Uvular 'k'	ק	ق
𐤔	Rish	r	Rolled 'r'	ר	ر
𐤕	Shin	š	sh as in 'she'	ש	ش
𐤖	Taw	t / th	t as in 'tall'	ת	ث

SECTION 3: JOINERS VS. NON-JOINERS

In your reading, you will notice that certain letters never connect to the letter following them. This creates a small visual gap within a word.

The Non-Joiners (Letters that only connect to the RIGHT):

𐤀 (Alaph), 𐤇 (Dalath), 𐤅 (He), 𐤋 (Waw), 𐤏 (Zain), 𐤑 (Sade), 𐤔 (Rish), 𐤖 (Taw).

Note: Taw (𐤖) often appears to connect, but technically follows the non-joiner rule in many formal manuscripts.

Dalath (𐤇) and Rish (𐤔) look identical except for a single dot: Dalath has a dot BELOW, Rish has a dot ABOVE.

SECTION 4: PRACTICE TABLE — VISUAL RECOGNITION

WORD	TRANSLIT	MEANING	ANALYSIS
ܐܠܗܐ	Alāhā	God	Alaph (NJ) + Lamad + He (NJ) + Alaph
ܡܠܟܐ	malkā	King	Mim + Lamad + Kaph + Alaph (NJ)
ܐܪܥܐ	’ar ‘ā	Earth	Alaph (NJ) + Rish (NJ) + ‘ e + Alaph
ܢܘܪܐ	nūhrā	Light	Nun + Waw (NJ) + He (NJ) + Rish (NJ) + Alaph
ܝܘܚܢܢ	Yūḥannan	John	Yodh + Waw (NJ) + Heth + Nun + Nun

SECTION 5: THE STORY — PART 0

The Scribe’s Beginning

Note: The story in this introductory lesson (*‘The Scribe’s Beginning’*) is a standalone narrative used to practice the alphabet. The main course narrative (*The Acts of Mar Yukhannan*) begins in Lesson 1.

Narrative note: Before the Acts of Mar Yukhannan begin, we see the scribe, Addai, preparing the parchment. This part introduces the visual rhythm of the script.

ܐܢܐ ܐܕܕܝܐ ܣܥܦܪܐ

’enā ‘Adday sāp̄rā.

’ENĀ (I) ‘ADDAY (ADDAI) SĀPRĀ (THE-SCRIBE)

I am Addai the scribe.

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܐܠܗܐ ܡܠܬܐ

kāteb ’enā meltā d-Alāhā.

KĀTEB (WRITING) ’ENĀ (I) MELTĀ (THE-WORD) D- (OF) ALĀHĀ (GOD)

I am writing the word of God.

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܝܫܥ

hannū ktābā d-Yūhannan.

HANNŪ (THIS-IS) KTĀBĀ (THE-WRITING/BOOK) D- (OF) YŪḤANNAN (JOHN)

This is the book of Yukhannan.

SECTION 6: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Alphabet Order

Write the following three letters in their Abgad sequence (the order used in the table in Section 2).

1. ܘ, ܟ, ܢ

2. ܐ, ܡ, ܝ

3. ܝ, ܡ, ܐ

Exercise 2: Identify the Non-Joiners

In the word ܢܗܪܐ (nūhrā, Light), which letters are non-joiners (do not connect to the letter on their left)?

Exercise 3: Transcription Practice

Write out the Syriac letters for the following names based on Section 2:

1. M-L-K-A (King)

2. A-L-H-A (God)

3. Y-W-H-N-N (Yukhannan / John)

Exercise 4: Directional Awareness

If you are reading the word ܡܠܟܐ, which letter do you read first (the one on the far right or the far left)?

SECTION 7: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1

1. א, ב, ג (A-B-G)
2. ד, ה, ו (H-T-Y)
3. ז, ח, ט (Q-R-S)

Exercise 2

ו (Waw), ה (He), ר (Rish), א (Alaph). All of these stop the cursive connection.

Exercise 3

1. ספר
2. מגלת
3. עט

Exercise 4

The letter on the far RIGHT (א - Alaph).

SECTION 8: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The 22 letter names learned in Section 2 (Alaph, Beth, Gamal ... Taw) count as the first 22 vocabulary items of this lesson. The 8 words below complete the set of 30, all drawn from the world of scribal culture that frames this course.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
סגול	Estrangelā	f	“Rounded” script
ספרא	sāprā	m	Scribe, writer
סבא	ktābā	m	Book, scripture
סגולת	megalltā	f	Scroll
סרסא	qarṣā	m	Parchment
סלמא	qalmā	m	Pen, reed
סדייטא	dīyūtā	f	Ink
סמאסא	nāmūsā	m	Law (from Gk Nomos)

LESSON 1

The Core Architecture: Nouns, Pronouns, and Verbless Clauses

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION AND WARM-UP

Quick Summary

Welcome to Syriac, the dialect of Aramaic that became the literary language of Middle Eastern Christianity from the 2nd to the 8th centuries. Before diving into verbs or complex syntax, we must lay the foundation of the language: the alphabet, nouns, and how to string them together to make a sentence.

1. **The Alphabet:** The Syriac alphabet (Estrangela script) consists of 22 consonants, written right to left. Like Hebrew and Arabic, vowels were originally unwritten.
2. **The Noun System:** Syriac nouns have gender (masculine/feminine), number (singular/plural), and three “states” (absolute, construct, emphatic).
3. **The Emphatic State:** The default form of a Syriac noun. It ends in an Alaph (ܐ) and historically signaled the definite article (“the”), though in classical Syriac it is the standard dictionary form.

5-Question Baseline Drill

(Since this is Lesson 1, these questions reflect general Semitic language principles to prime your existing knowledge. Answers are in Section 9).

1. Semitic languages are built on root systems. How many consonants typically make up a root?
 2. Looking closely at the script, in which direction is Syriac written?
 3. What is a “verbless clause” in Hebrew or Arabic?
 4. What consonant do you think represents the ‘Alaph’ (the first letter)?
 5. If the Hebrew word for “king” is *melek* and Arabic is *malik*, what do you hypothesize the Aramaic/Syriac root consonants might be?
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SECTION 2: CORE ARCHITECTURE — OVERVIEW

One of the most striking differences between Indo-European languages (Greek, Latin, English) and Semitic ones (Hebrew, Arabic, Syriac) is syntax and the copula (“to be”).

In English, we say “God **is** good.” In Greek, “ὁ θεὸς ἀγαθός **ἐστίν**.” We require a verb to link the subject to its predicate. In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the “is” functions implicitly. You simply place two nouns, or a noun and an adjective, next to one another.

Alāhā ṭābā = God [is] good.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Definite Article

Another major shift is how Syriac handles “the”.

- **Hebrew** uses a prefix: מֶלֶךְ (ha-melek, “the king”).
- **Arabic** uses a prefix: الملك (al-malik, “the king”).
- **Greek** uses a separate word: ὁ βασιλεὺς (ho basileus, “the king”).
- **Syriac** originally used a **suffix** (the Emphatic State Alaph: ܐ). Over time, this state became the default form. Thus, *malkā* (ܡܠܟܐ) can mean “a king” or “the king” depending on context, but it is structurally the emphatic, determinate form.

SECTION 3: PRONOUNS AND PARTICLES

1. Independent Personal Pronouns

Pronouns stand alone as the subject of a sentence. They distinguish gender in the 2nd and 3rd persons (unlike English “you” or “they”).

2. The Particles **d-** and **l-**

Syriac relies heavily on tiny prepositions that attach directly to the front of the next word.

- **The Relative Particle **d-** (ܕ):** This acts like the English “of”, “which”, “who”, or “that”. It defines relationships and possession.
 - *Malkūtā d-Alāhā* (The kingdom **of** God)
 - *Nūhrā d-ṭābā* (The light **which** is good)
- **The Preposition **l-** (ܠ):** This means “to” or “for”, but it is also used heavily as a Direct Object marker (similar to the Hebrew **et** ־, though functioning prepositionally).
 - *l-malkā* (to the king)

- *l-Yūḥannan* (to Yukhannan)

SECTION 4: INDEPENDENT PRONOUNS PARADIGM

Here are the independent personal pronouns in Syriac. Observe the similarities to other Semitic languages.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	ARABIC COGNATE	HEBREW COGNATE
1 c.sg.	ܐܢܐ	'enā	I	anā (أنا)	'ānī (אני)
2 m.sg.	ܐܢܬܐ	'ant	You (m)	'anta (أنت)	'attāh (אתה)
2 f.sg.	ܐܢܬܝ	'anti	You (f)	'anti (أنتِ)	'att (את)
3 m.sg.	ܐܘܐ	hū	He / It	huwa (هو)	hū ' (הוא)
3 f.sg.	ܐܘܝܐ	hī	She / It	hiya (هي)	hī ' (היא)
1 c.pl.	ܡܢܗܢ	ḥnan	We	naḥnu (نحن)	'ānaḥnū (אנחנו)
2 m.pl.	ܐܢܬܬܐ	'antūn	You (m.pl)	'antum (أنتم)	'attem (אתם)
2 f.pl.	ܐܢܬܬܝ	'antēn	You (f.pl)	'antunna (أنتن)	'atten (אתן)
3 m.pl.	ܡܢܗܡ	hennōn	They (m)	hum (هم)	hēm (הם)
3 f.pl.	ܡܢܗܢ	hennēn	They (f)	hunna (هنّ)	hēn (הן)

Note: In 'ant, 'anti, 'antūn, and 'antēn, the 'n' is historically written but often silent in pronunciation (assimilated: "at", "ati").

SECTION 5: THE EMPHATIC NOUN STATE

In the absolute state, the word for king is *malk*. In the emphatic state (the standard dictionary form), an 'Alaph is added.

GENDER	ABSOLUTE STATE	EMPHATIC STATE (DEFAULT)	TRANSLITERATION
Masc.	ܡܠܟܐ	ܡܠܟܐ	malkā (King)
Fem.	ܡܠܟܬܐ	ܡܠܟܬܐ	malkūtā (Kingdom)

Rule of Thumb: If a noun ends in -ā (Alaph), it's overwhelmingly likely to be a masculine emphatic singular or a feminine emphatic.

SECTION 6: THEOLOGICAL VOCABULARY

The following core nouns feature prominently in classical Syriac literature and the Peshitta (the Syriac

Bible).

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	GENDER	MEANING	ETYMOLOGY / NOTES
ܐܠܗܐ	Alāhā	m.	God	Cognate w/ Arabic <i>Allāh</i> , Heb <i>ʿĒlōhīm</i>
ܒܪܢܫܐ	barnāšā	m.	Human, son of man	Compounded from <i>bar</i> (son) + <i>nāšā</i> (man). Standard term for human.
ܡܠܟܐ	malkā	m.	King	Semitic root <i>m-l-k</i>
ܡܠܟܘܬܐ	malkūtā	f.	Kingdom	Abstract noun ending <i>-ūtā</i>
ܡܠܬܐ	meltā	f.	Word, Logos	The Syriac translation of Greek <i>Logos</i> (John 1:1)
ܢܗܪܐ	nūhrā	m.	Light	Root <i>n-h-r</i> . Cf. Arabic <i>nūr</i>
ܐܪܥܐ	ʿarʿā	f.	Earth, land	Cognate with Hebrew <i>ʿereṣ</i> , Arabic <i>ʿarḍ</i>
ܬܒܐ	ṭābā	m.	Good	Adjective behaving as noun. Heb <i>ṭōb</i>
ܒܝܫܐ	bīšā	m.	Evil, bad	Adjective behaving as noun.
ܝܘܗܢܢܐ	Yūḥannan	m.	John	Proper Name.
ܪܒܐ	rabbā	m.	Great, large	Root <i>r-b-b</i> . Cf. “Rabbi” (my great one).
ܚܝܐ	ḥayyē	m.pl.	Life	Root <i>ḥ-y-y</i> . Plural form (like Heb <i>ḥayyīm</i>)

The Setting

*Narrative note: This introductory passage is written entirely in verbless sentences, establishing the setting and main characters using classical equational syntax, pronouns, and the relational **d-** particle.*

Sentence 1

ܐܬܐ ܡܠܟܐ malkā hū. malkā (a-king) hū (he-[is]). → He is a king. / There is a king.

Sentence 2

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܪܒܬܐ hī. w- (and-) malkūtā (the-kingdom) d- (of) malkā (the-king) rabbā (great) hī (she-[is]). → And the kingdom of the king is great. (Note: ‘malkūtā’ is feminine, so the pronoun ‘hī’ is used).

Sentence 3

ܐܬܐ ܒܪܢܐܫܐ ܒܝܫܐ hū. barnāšā (the-man) bīšā (evil) hū (he-[is]). → The man is evil.

Sentence 4

ܒܪܢܐܫܐ ܬܒܐ Yūḥannan hū ṭābā. Yūḥannan (John) hū (he-[is]) ṭābā (good). → Yukhannan is good.

Sentence 5

ܐܬܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܝܫܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ Alāhā l-Yūḥannan nūhrā hū. Alāhā (God) l- (to/for) Yūḥannan (John) nūhrā (light) hū (he-[is]). → God is light to Yukhannan.

Sentence 6

ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ meltā d-Alāhā b- ‘ar ‘ā hī. meltā (the-word) d- (of) Alāhā (God) b- (in) ‘ar ‘ā (the-earth) hī (she-[is]). → The word of God is in the earth.

Sentence 7

ܐܬܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ malkā b- ‘ar ‘ā, w-Yūḥannan l-malkā nūhrā hū. malkā (the-king) b- (in) ‘ar ‘ā (the-earth), w- (and) Yūḥannan (John) l- (to) malkā (the-king) nūhrā (light) hū (he-[is]). → The king is in the earth, and Yukhannan is a light to the king.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Pronoun Identification

Identify the person, gender, and number of the following pronouns, and give the English translation.

1. ܐܢܢ (ḥnan)
2. ܗܝ (hī)
3. ܐܢܬܘܢ (ʾ antūn)
4. ܗܢܢܘܢ (hennōn)
5. ܗܘ (hū)

Exercise 2: Morphology (Nouns)

Identify whether the following words are taking the Emphatic State suffix (-ā).

1. ܢܗܪܐ (nūhrā)
2. ܡܠܟܐ (malk)
3. ܬܒܐܐ (ṭābā)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following basic verbless clauses into English.

1. Alāhā hū ṭābā.
2. Nūhrā b-malkūtā hū.
3. Yūḥannan barnāšā hū.
4. Meltā d-malkā bīšā hī.
5. ʾ Enā Yūḥannan.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following English sentences into Syriac transliteration using verbless clauses. (Remember to include the correct 3rd person pronoun at the end to act as “is”).

1. God is a great light.
2. The earth is the kingdom of God. (Earth is feminine *hī*).
3. The king is an evil man.

4. I am the king. (No “is” pronoun needed, just “I king”).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following:

1. What adjective is used to describe the king’s kingdom?
 2. To whom is Yukhannan a “light”?
 3. Where is the word of God?
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SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. Three consonants (the triliteral root).
2. Right to left.
3. A sentence lacking a verb (like “to be”), where subject and predicate are placed adjacently (e.g., “The man [is] good”).
4. Usually a glottal stop or silent carrier for a vowel.
5. m-l-k.

Exercise 1: Pronoun Identification

1. 1 c.pl. (We)
2. 3 f.sg. (She)
3. 2 m.pl. (You all)
4. 3 m.pl. (They, m)
5. 3 m.sg. (He)

Exercise 2: Morphology

1. Yes (Ends in Alaph/ ā).
2. No (Absolute state).
3. Yes (Ends in Alaph/ ā).

Exercise 3: Translation

1. God is good.
2. The light is in the kingdom.
3. Yukhannan is a man.
4. The word of the king is evil. (Because *meltā* is feminine, *hī* is used).
5. I am Yukhannan.

Exercise 4: Production

1. Alāhā nūhrā rabbā hū.
2. 'ar 'ā malkūttā d-Alāhā hī.
3. Malkā barnāšā bīšā hū.
4. 'Enā malkā.

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. Great (*rabbā*).
2. To the king (*l-malkā*).
3. In the earth (*b- 'ar 'ā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE VERBLESS CLAUSE — FORMATION RULES

COMPONENT 1	COMPONENT 2	COPULA (PRONOUN)	TRANSLATION
Subject Noun	Predicate Noun/Adj	Pronoun matching Subject	
Alāhā (God)	ṭābā (good)	hū (he)	God is good.
Meltā (Word)	rabbā (great)	hī (she)	The word is great.

PRONOUN REFERENCE TABLE

PERSON	SINGULAR	PLURAL
1st Common	' enā (I)	ḥnan (We)
2nd Masc	' ant (You)	' antūn (You all)
2nd Fem	' anti (You)	' antēn (You all)
3rd Masc	hū (He)	hennōn (They)
3rd Fem	hī (She)	hennēn (They)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qṛītā	f. noun	village	emphatic state
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m. noun	tongue, language	
ܟܕܝܐ	garmā	m. noun	bone	
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	f. noun	stone, rock	
ܡܝܐ	māyā	m. noun (pl.)	water	plural in form
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m. noun	fish	
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f. noun	city	
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m. noun	sun	
ܬܪܝܐ	tar'ā	m. noun	door, gate	
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	m. noun	oil	
ܫܠܐ	ḥaylā	m. noun	power, army	
ܐܕܢܐ	'ednā	f. noun	ear	
ܩܝܣܐ	qaysā	m. noun	wood, tree	
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	m. noun	river	
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	m. noun	hope	
ܕܗܠܬܐ	dehltā	f. noun	fear, religion	abstract noun
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	m. noun	moon	
ܪܓܠܐ	reglā	f. noun	foot	
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m. noun	peace	common greeting
ܐܬܪܐ	'atrā	m. noun	place, country	
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	m. noun	witness, martyr	
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	m. noun	flesh	
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūtā	f. noun	grace	

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܬܐܪܐ	tawrā	m. noun	bull, ox	
ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	m. noun	covenant	
ܪܘܚܐ	ʾūrḥā	f. noun	way, road	
ܚܝܠܐ	hayklā	m. noun	temple, palace	
ܥܝܢܐ	ʿaynā	f. noun	eye	
ܦܡܐ	pūmā	m. noun	mouth	
ܕܢܐ	dīnā	m. noun	judgment	

LESSON 2

The Narrative Present: Participles and Enclitics

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 1

Quick Summary

In Lesson 1, we established the basic building blocks of Syriac syntax. We learned that Syriac sentences do not strictly require a “to be” verb; rather, placing a subject and predicate side-by-side with a matching independent pronoun acts as an equational sentence (e.g., *Malkā hū ṭābā* — “The king [is] good”). We also looked at the absolute versus empathic states of nouns, with the emphatic ending in *ā* (Alaph) acting as the default dictionary form.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. Translate: *Alāhā rabbā hū*.
 2. What is the Syriac absolute state for “word” (from *meltā*)?
 3. How do you say “We” in Syriac?
 4. What particle is used to express “of”, “who”, or “that”?
 5. In *Malkūtā d-Alāhā hī*, why is the pronoun *hī* (she) used instead of *hū* (he)?
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SECTION 2: THE PARTICIPLE AS PRESENT TENSE — OVERVIEW

In Indo-European languages like English, and Greek, the “present tense” is a fully conjugated finite verb (e.g., “I walk”, περιπατῶ). Participles are verbal adjectives (e.g., “the walking man”).

In Aramaic and Syriac, the **active participle** stepped in to take over the function of the present tense almost entirely. A Syriac speaker didn’t say “I write” as a finite verb; they literally said “Writing [am] I.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

- **Hebrew:** Biblical Hebrew primarily used the Imperfect for ongoing action, but by the Mishnaic period (interfacing with Aramaic), Hebrew also adopted the participle for the present tense (e.g., *ānī kōtēb* = I am writing).

- **Arabic:** Standard Arabic relies on the imperfect prefix conjugation (يَكْتُبُ *yaktubu*, “he writes”). The active participle (كَاتِبٌ *kātib*) means “writer” or “one who has written,” but does not serve as a primary present tense verb.
 - **Greek:** Syriac’s reliance on the participle to form continuous action heavily influenced how Syriac translators rendered Greek continuous tenses (often translating a Greek present indicative with a Syriac participle + pronoun).
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SECTION 3: THE PEAL ACTIVE PARTICIPLE & ENCLITICS

The Peal Stem

Semitic verbs exist in different “stems” (or binyanim) that modify their meaning. The basic, un-augmented ground-stem is called the **Pearl**. Almost all basic actions occur in the Pearl.

Forming the Participle

For a strong tri-consonantal root (C-C-C) like *k-t-b* (write), the active participle is formed by inserting a long *ā* after the first consonant, and an *e* after the second.

- *kāteb* (writing, m.sg.)
- *kātbā* (writing, f.sg.)

Enclitic Pronouns

To turn “writing” into “I am writing,” Syriac attaches an **enclitic** pronoun to the back of the participle. Enclitics are shortened, rhythmic versions of the independent pronouns from Lesson 1.

- *'enā* (I) → *-nā*
 - *kāteb* + *-nā* = *kāteb-nā* (I am writing)
-

SECTION 4: PARTICIPLE AND ENCLITIC PARADIGMS

1. The Enclitic Pronoun Set

PERSON	INDEPENDENT	ENCLITIC FORM	ATTACHED EXAMPLE (<i>KĀTEB</i>)	TRANSLATION
1 c.sg.	'enā	-nā	kāteb-nā / kātbā-nā	I am writing
2 m.sg.	'ant	-t	kāteb-t	You (m) are writing
2 f.sg.	'anti	-tī	kātbā-tī	You (f) are writing
3 m.sg.	hū	-hū / (none)*	kāteb / kāteb-hū	He is writing / writes
3 f.sg.	hī	-hī / (none)*	kātbā / kātbā-hī	She is writing / writes
1 c.pl.	ḥnan	-ḥnan	kātbīn-ḥnan / kātbān-ḥnan	We are writing
2 m.pl.	'antūn	-tūn	kātbīn-tūn	You (m.pl) are writing
2 f.pl.	'antēn	-tēn	kātbān-tēn	You (f.pl) are writing
3 m.pl.	hennōn	(none)**	kātbīn	They (m) are writing
3 f.pl.	hennēn	(none)**	kātbān	They (f) are writing

**In the 3rd person singular, the participle often stands entirely alone without an enclitic. **In the 3rd person plural, the plural suffix (-īn / -ān) is sufficient; no enclitic is added.*

2. The Peal Active Participle Declension (Root **k-t-b**)

GENDER/NUM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION
Masc. Sg.	כּתב	kāteb
Fem. Sg.	כתב	kātbā
Masc. Pl.	כתבין	kātbīn
Fem. Pl.	כתבן	kātbān

SECTION 5: SENTENCE SYNTAX

When the active participle drives the sentence, the word order is very fluid, but Verb-Subject-Object (VSO) or Subject-Verb-Object (SVO) are both common.

- **SVO:** *Yūḥannan kāteb meltā.* (Yukhannan writes a word).
- **VSO:** *Kāteb Yūḥannan meltā.* (Writes Yukhannan a word).
- **Enclitic:** *Kāteb-nā meltā.* (I am writing a word).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (STRONG VERBS & ADVERBS)

ROOT	PEAL PTCP (M.S.)	MEANING	ADVERB/PARTICLE	MEANING
כ.ת.ב	kāteb	to write	כ.ע.א (hāšā)	now
א.ל.ז	'āzel	to go	ד.נ (dēn)	but, then, however
א.מ.ר	'āmer	to speak/say	ת.מ.נ (tammān)	there
ש.מ.ע	šāma ' *	to hear	ל.ל (l' el)	above
ר.א.ו	hāzē	to see	כ.א.ר (harkā)	here
ע.ב.ד	'ābed	to do/make	ע.א (' am)	with
נ.א.ר	nāter	to keep/guard	ע.ל (' al)	upon, against
ר.א.ד	rādep	to pursue		
ש.ב.ע	šābeq	to leave		
נ.א.ע	nāpeq	to go out		

*Note: Roots ending in gutturals (like ' Ayn) change the **e** to an **a** (šāma ' instead of šāme ').

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 2

Preparation

Narrative note: The present tense (participle + enclitics) is used here to create an immediate, action-oriented dialogue as Yukhannan prepares his disciples.

Sentence 1

ቃላት ማብራር ዕለታዊ ጽሑፍ Yūḥannan ’āmer l-talmīdē d-īt l-eh. Yūḥannan (John) ’āmer (is-speaking) l- (to) talmīdē (the-disciples) d- (that) īt (there-are) l-eh (to-him). → Yukhannan is speaking to the disciples that are his.

Sentence 2

אֶזֶל נָא מֵעַן הֵרָא 'āzel-nā men harkā. 'āzel (going) -nā (am-I) men (from) harkā (here). → “I am going from here.”

Sentence 3

אני הולך למלכות הרע 'āzel-nā l-malkūttā d-biṣā, 'āmer-hū. 'āzel (going) -nā (am-I) l-
(to) malkūttā (the-kingdom) d- (of) biṣā (the-evil-[one]), 'āmer (says) -hū (he). → "I am going to the
kingdom of the evil one," he says.

Sentence 4

ܬܠܡܝܕܝܫܡܝܢ talmidē šām ' in meltā d-Yūḥannan. talmidē (the-disciples) šām ' in (are-hearing) meltā (the-word) d- (of) Yūhannan (John). → The disciples hear the word of Yukhannan.

Sentence 5

ܐܡܪܝܢ ܗܝܢܐܢ ܡܠܟܐ ܒܝܫܐ ܬܡܡܢ. ܗܝܢܐܢ (they)
 'āmṛīn (are-saying): ḥāzēn (seeing) -ḥnan (are-we) malkā (a-king) bīšā (evil) tammān (there). → They say:
 “We see an evil king there.”

Sentence 6

נִכְרָא חֲבֵרָא בְּיָמֵי יוֹחָנָן Yūḥannan ‘ābed nūhrā b-’ar ‘ā. Yūḥannan (John) ‘ābed (is-making/doing) nūhrā (light) b- (in) ’ar ‘ā (the-earth). → Yukhannan makes light in the earth.

Sentence 7

ᐱᓄ ᐃᓕ ᐱᓂᐱ ᐱᓂᐱ ᐱᓂᐱ ᐱᓂᐱ kāteb-nā meltā d-Alāhā, ’āmer hāšā. kāteb (writing) -nā (am-I)
meltā (the-word) d- (of) Alāhā (God), ’āmer (says-[he]) hāšā (now). → “I am writing the word of God,” he
says now.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Participle Identification

Identify the gender and number of the following participles.

1. ܕܠܒܝܢ (kātḇīn)
2. ܫܡܐܐ (šām ‘ ā)
3. ܢܦܩܢܐܢ (nāpḡān)
4. ܪܕܦܐ (rādep)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Combine the root ‘-b-d (to do, make) with the correct enclitic pronoun to form the present tense for:

1. I am making (m.sg)
2. We are making (m.pl)
3. You (f.sg) are making
4. They (m.pl) are making.

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following present tense clauses.

1. ‘āzel-nā l-malkūttā.
2. Šām ‘īn-tūn meltā d-Alāhā.
3. Barnāšā bīšā rādep l-Yūḡannan.
4. Ḥāzēn-ḡnan nūhrā rabbā tammān.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following active present sentences into Syriac transliteration.

1. I (m) am hearing the word.
2. She is writing a good word.
3. They (m) are going from here.
4. You (m.pl) are seeing the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. From where does Yūkhannan say he is going?
 2. What do the disciples fear they will see there?
 3. What is Yūkhannan “writing” right now?
-

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. God is great.
2. *Melt* (ܡܠܬܐ)
3. *ḥnan*
4. *d-*
5. Because *malkūtā* (kingdom) is a feminine noun.

Exercise 1: Participle Identification

1. Masculine Plural
2. Feminine Singular
3. Feminine Plural
4. Masculine Singular

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. ‘ābed-nā
2. ‘ābdīn-ḥnan
3. ‘ābdā-tī
4. ‘ābdīn (no enclitic needed for 3rd person pl)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. I am going to the kingdom.
2. You all are hearing the word of God.
3. The evil man is pursuing Yūkhannan.
4. We are seeing a great light there.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. Šāma^ʿ -nā meltā.
2. Kātbā meltā ṭābtā.
3. ʾĀzlīn men harkā.
4. Ḥāzēn-tūn l-malkā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. “From here” (*men harkā*).
2. An evil king (*malkā bīšā*).
3. The word of God (*meltā d-Alāhā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

PARTICIPLE + ENCLITIC COMBINATIONS (Masc. Root k-t-b)

ENGLISH	PARTICIPLE	ENCLITIC	COMBINED SYRIAC FORM
I write (m)	kāteb	-nā	kāteb-nā
You write (m)	kāteb	-t	kāteb-t
He writes	kāteb	(-hū)	kāteb / kāteb-hū
We write (m)	kātbīn	-ḥnan	kātbīn-ḥnan
You all write (m)	kātbīn	-tūn	kātbīn-tūn
They write (m)	kātbīn	(none)	kātbīn

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on

nouns and derived verbal nouns relevant to narrative present (participle) usage.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܫܒܬܐ	šabbtā	f. noun	sabbath, week	pl. šabbē
ܠܒܫܐ	lbūšā	m. noun	garment, clothing	from root l-b-š (to wear)
ܕܟܪܢܐ	dəkrānā	m. noun	memory, remembrance	from root d-k-r (to remember)
ܩܥܐ	peg‘ā	m. noun	encounter, accident	from root p-g-‘ (to meet)
ܫܒܥܐ	šeb‘ā	f. noun	finger	body part
ܩܠܬܐ	pūlhānā	m. noun	labor, toil	from root p-l-ḥ (to serve)
ܢܬܪܐ	nāṭōrtā	f. noun	guard, watchfulness	from root n-ṭ-r (to guard)
ܕܡܠܬܐ	gəməlūtā	f. noun	kindness, mercy	from root g-m-l (to treat well)
ܠܒܟܐ	lebḵātā	f. noun	capture, grasping	from root l-b-k (to hold)
ܡܫܟܢܐ	meskēnūtā	f. noun	poverty, want	abstract noun
ܩܠܬܐ	pəlgūtā	f. noun	division, share	from root p-l-g (to divide)
ܩܠܬܐ	qəlpəttā	f. noun	shell, exterior	
ܪܓܝܐ	rugzā	m. noun	rage, wrath	from root r-g-z (to be angry)
ܝܕܐ	īdā‘tā	f. noun	knowledge	from root y-d-‘ (to know)
ܩܦܪܐ	kəprā	m. noun	village, hamlet	place noun
ܩܦܪܐ	pəqrā	m. noun	opening, aperture	from root p-q-r (to open)

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܟܡܝܪܘܬܬܐ	gmīrūtā	f. noun	completion, perfection	from root g-m-r (to complete)
ܟܬܐܢܐ	‘ ūšnā	m. noun	strength, might	from root ‘ -š-n (to be strong)
ܟܬܐܬܐ	šəp ‘ ā	m. noun	abundance, plenty	from root š-p- ‘ (to suffice)
ܟܬܐܠܐ	laḥmā	m. noun	bread, food	staple item
ܟܬܐܡܐ	pəsmā	m. noun	measure, standard	
ܟܬܐܡܬܐ	šəlmūtā	f. noun	completeness, wholeness	from root š-l-m (to be whole)
ܟܬܐܠܩܐ	‘ alqā	m. noun	ascent, stairway	from root ‘ -l-q (to ascend)
ܟܬܐܓܐ	syāgā	m. noun	enclosure, hedge	from root s-w-g (to fence)
ܟܬܐܠܦܐ	šuḥlāpā	m. noun	change, alteration	from root š-ḥ-l-p (to change)
ܟܬܐܠܩܘܬܐ	dəḥīqūtā	f. noun	clinging, adherence	from root d-b-q (to cling)
ܟܬܐܠܫܘܬܐ	qaddīšūtā	f. noun	holiness, sanctity	from root q-d-š (to be holy)
ܟܬܐܠܘܬܐ	gdūlūtā	f. noun	greatness, grandeur	from root g-d-l (to be great)
ܟܬܐܠܝܘܬܐ	‘ arṭlāyūtā	f. noun	nakedness, exposure	from root ‘ -r-ṭ-l (to be naked)
ܟܬܐܠܪܐܐ	dəbrānā	m. noun	leader, governor	related to d-b-r
ܟܬܐܠܡܐ	rawmā	m. noun	height, elevation	from root r-w-m (to be high)

LESSON 3

The Narrative Past: The Peal Perfect and Verb Syntax

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 2

Quick Summary

In Lesson 2, we moved our verbless clauses into the active present tense using the **Peal Active Participle** (e.g., *kāteb*, “writing”). We learned that by attaching shortened enclitic pronouns to the participle (*-nā*, *-t*, *-ḥnan*), Syriac forms the equivalent of the English present continuous (*kāteb-nā*, “I am writing”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. What is the m.sg. active participle of the root ‘-*b-d* (to do/make)?
 2. How would you say “We are going” (root: ‘-*z-l*, enclitic: *-ḥnan*)?
 3. Translate: *Šām ‘īn-tūn meltā d-Alāhā*.
 4. What happens to the enclitic pronoun in the 3rd person plural (*hennōn/hennēn*) present tense?
 5. Write “She is writing” using the root *k-t-b* and the 3rd f.sg pronoun.
-

SECTION 2: THE SEMITIC PERFECT TENSE — OVERVIEW

While the participle covers the present, the **Perfect tense** covers the past (completed action). The Perfect is formed by adding *suffixes* to the root to indicate person, gender, and number. It is therefore often called the “Suffix Conjugation.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Suffix Conjugation

The Perfect tense behaves almost identically across the major Semitic languages. The core pattern is a C-a-C-a-C vocalization in the 3rd m.sg (or similar variant) followed by distinct suffixes for “I”, “you”, “we”, “they”.

- **Hebrew Qal Perfect:** קָטַב (*kātab* — he wrote), קָטַבְתִּי (*kātabtī* — I wrote).
- **Arabic Form I Perfect:** كَتَبَ (*kataba* — he wrote), كَتَبْتُ (*katabtu* — I wrote).
- **Syriac Peal Perfect:** ܟܬܒ (*ktab* — he wrote), ܟܬܒܬ (*ketbet* — I wrote).

- **Greek/Latin:** Greek Aorist (ἔγραψα) or Latin Perfect (scripsi) serve similar functions for completed past narrative actions, but without the triliteral root morphology.
-

SECTION 3: THE PEAL PERFECT & NARRATIVE SYNTAX

Forming the Peal Perfect

For a strong root like *k-t-b* (write), the 3rd person masculine singular is the base form: **ktab** (he wrote). Notice the vocalization shift from the Hebrew/Arabic *a-a* to the Syriac *zero-a* (k-t-a-b) due to vowel reduction. The suffixes are added directly to the root:

- Root + *-et* (1st person) → *ketb-et* (I wrote).
- Root + *-ū* (3rd m.pl) → *ktab-ū* (They wrote).

Narrative Syntax: V-S-O Word Order

Syriac is a heavily VSO (Verb-Subject-Object) language in past narrative. When reading historical or biblical texts, the verb will almost always come first.

- *Ktab Yūḥannan meltā.* (Wrote Yukhannan a word → Yukhannan wrote a word).

The Conjunction **w-** (And)

Syriac narratives chain countless actions together using the attached conjunction **w-** (and). “And he went... and he saw... and he wrote.”

- *W-npaq Yūḥannan w-ḥza malkā.* (And Yukhannan went out and saw the king).
-

SECTION 4: PERFECT TENSE PARADIGMS

1. The Peal Perfect Conjugation (Root **k-t-b**)

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	ARABIC COGNATE SUFFIX	HEBREW COGNATE SUFFIX
3 m.sg.	כתב	ktab	he wrote	kataba (كَتَبَ)	kātab (כָּתַב)
3 f.sg.	כתבת	ketbat	she wrote	katabat (كَتَبَتْ)	kātbāh (כָּתְבָהּ)
2 m.sg.	כתבת	ktabt	you (m) wrote	katabta (كَتَبْتَ)	kātabtā (כָּתַבְתָּ)
2 f.sg.	כתבת	ktabtī	you (f) wrote	katabti (كَتَبْتِ)	kātabt (כָּתַבְתְּ)
1 c.sg.	כתבת	ketbet	I wrote	katabtu (كَتَبْتُ)	kātabtī (כָּתַבְתִּי)
3 m.pl.	כתבו	ktabū	they (m) wrote	kabū (كَاتَبُوا)	kātbū (כָּתְבוּ)
3 f.pl.	כתבו	ktabī	they (f) wrote	kabna (كَاتَبْنَ)	-
2 m.pl.	כתבתם	ktabtūn	you (m.pl) wrote	katabtum (كَاتَبْتُمْ)	ktabtem (כָּתַבְתֶּם)
2 f.pl.	כתבתם	ktabtēn	you (f.pl) wrote	-	-
1 c.pl.	כתבנו	ktabn	we wrote	kabnā (كَاتَبْنَا)	kātabnū (כָּתַבְנוּ)

Orthography Note: Notice how the single letter Taw (ח) represents both **-t** (you, m) and **-et** (I). Context and pointing (if present) clarify the reading.

SECTION 5: NARRATIVE WORD ORDER EXAMPLES

VERB	SUBJECT	OBJECT	TRANSLATION
כתב	ישוע	מלתא	Yukhannan wrote a word.
ktab	Yūḥannan	meltā	
שמעו	תלמידיה	קול	The disciples heard a voice.
šma ' ū	talmīdē	qālā	

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (STRONG VERBS & TRANSITIONS)

ROOT	PEAL PERFECT (3 M.S.)	MEANING	TRANSITIONS	MEANING
מ.ב.י	šbaq (שבּ) (3 M.S.)	to leave, abandon	ו (w-)	and
מ.פ.נ	npaq (נפּ) (3 M.S.)	to go out, exit	כּ (kad)	when, while
י.נ.נ	nṭar (נִטַּר) (3 M.S.)	to keep, watch	גֵּר (gēr)	for, because (Greek γὰρ)
ב.נ.מ	qreb (קִרַּב) (3 M.S.)	to draw near	תּוּב (tūb)	again, furthermore
פ.ר.ר	rdap (רִדַּפּ) (3 M.S.)	to pursue	הַיָּדֵן (hāydēn)	then, at that time
פ.ל.פ	plah (פִּלַּח) (3 M.S.)	to serve, work	דֵּן (dēn)	but, however (Greek δέ)
נ.ש.ג	sgad (שָׁגַד) (3 M.S.)	to worship, bow		
נ.ש.ק	qtal (קִטַּל) (3 M.S.)	to kill		
פ.ר.צ	praq (פִּרַּץ) (3 M.S.)	to save, rescue		
פ.ר.ח	‘raq (פִּרַּח) (3 M.S.)	to flee		
נ.ל.י	īled (יָלַד) (3 M.S.)	to give birth		
ר.מ.ח	‘qar (חָרַח) (3 M.S.)	to root out, dig		
מ.ל.ש	sleq (שָׁלַח) (3 M.S.)	to ascend, climb		

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 3

The Journey

Narrative note: The story now utilizes the VSO narrative chain to describe Yūḥannan’s past actions, transitioning from the immediate present tense of Part 2.

Sentence 1

וּכְהַנֵּן אֵלֶּם אֵלֶּם וּכְהַנֵּן אֵלֶּם w-kad ‘emar hānēn, npaq Yūḥannan. w-kad (and-when) ‘emar (he-said) hānēn (these-[things]), npaq (went-out) Yūḥannan (John). → And when he said these things, Yūḥannan went out.

Sentence 2

וְעָזַל יוֹחָנָן בֶּן־אֶרְצָא וְשִׁבְּאָתְּלִמְדָּאֵיהּ וְעָזַל (went) Yūḥannan (John) b- (in) 'ar 'ā (the-earth), w- (and-) shbaq (he-left) talmīdāw-hy (his-disciples). → And Yukhannan went in the earth, and he left his disciples.

Sentence 3

וְעָהָד יוֹחָנָן נֹחְרָא בֶּן־וְרַחָא וְעָהָד (he-held/carried) Yūḥannan (John) nūhrā (light) b- (in) 'ūrḥā (the-way/road). → Yukhannan held light on the way.

Sentence 4

וְקִרֵּב יוֹחָנָן לְמַלְכוּתָא דְּמַלְכָּא בִּישָׂא וְקִרֵּב (drew-near) Yūḥannan (John) l- (to) malkūttā (the-kingdom) d- (of) malkā (the-king) bīšā (evil). → And Yukhannan drew near to the kingdom of the evil king.

Sentence 5

וְרַבִּי דְּמַלְכָּא רִדַּפּ לְיוֹחָנָן וְרַבִּי (the-great-one) d- (of) malkā (the-king) rdap (pursued) l- (to) Yūḥannan (John). → And the great one of the king pursued Yukhannan.

Sentence 6

וְרָאָה יוֹחָנָן וְקָאֵם קִדָּם תַּרְעָא דְּמַלְכוּתָא וְרָאָה (fled) Yūḥannan (John) w- (and-) qām (stood) qdām (before) tar 'ā (gate) d- (of) malkūttā (the-kingdom). → And Yukhannan fled and stood before the gate of the kingdom.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Perfect Identification

Identify the person, gender, and number of the following verbs in the Perfect tense.

1. כְּתַבּוּ (ktabū)
2. שִׁבְּאֵת (šbaqt - assuming 2nd m.sg)
3. נִתְרַת (neṭrat - assuming 3rd f.sg)
4. רָאָה ('raqn)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Conjugate the root *p-l-ḥ* (to serve) in the following forms of the Peal Perfect:

1. He served
2. They (m) served
3. I served
4. You all (m) served

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following past narrative clauses.

1. W-šbaq Yūḥannan l-malkā.
2. Rdapū talmīdē l-bīšā.
3. Npaq malkā dēn men tar‘ā.
4. Ktabn meltā d-Alāhā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following past narrative sentences into Syriac transliteration. Use VSO order!

1. The evil man fled from the light. (Use **men** for “from”).
2. And Yukhannan kept the word of God.
3. When the disciples drew near, they worshipped (*sgadū*).
4. The great king saved the earth.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. Who did Yukhannan leave behind when he went out?
 2. What did the “great one” of the king do?
 3. Where did Yukhannan stand at the end of the passage?
-

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. ‘*ābed*
2. ‘*āzlīn-ḥnan*
3. You all (pl) are hearing the word of God.
4. It is not used. The plural participle ending (-*īn* / -*ān*) already marks the plural unambiguously.
5. *Kātbā-hī* (or just *Kātbā*).

Exercise 1: Perfect Identification

1. 3.m.pl (They wrote)
2. 2.m.sg (You left)
3. 3.f.sg (She kept)
4. 1.c.pl (We fled)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. *plaḥ*
2. *plaḥū*
3. *pelḥet*
4. *plaḥtūn*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. And Yukhannan left/abandoned the king.
2. The disciples pursued the evil man.
3. But the king went out from the gate.
4. We wrote the word of God.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. ‘*raq barnāšā bīšā men nūhrā.*
2. *W-nṭar Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā.*
3. *Kad qrebū talmīdē, sgadū.*
4. *Praq malkā rabbā l- ‘ar ‘ā.*

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. His disciples (*talmīdāw-hy*).
2. He pursued (*rdap*) Yūkhannan.
3. Before the gate of the kingdom (*qdām tar ʿ ā d-malkūtā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PEAL PERFECT (Root š-b-q)

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT
3 m.sg.	ܫܒܩ	shbaq (he left)
3 f.sg.	ܫܒܩܬ	šebqat (she left)
2 m.sg.	ܫܒܩܬ	šbaqt (you left)
1 c.sg.	ܫܒܩܬ	šebqet (I left)
3 m.pl.	ܫܒܩܘ	shbaqū (they left)
1 c.pl.	ܫܒܩܢ	shbaqn (we left)

VSO RULE

1. VERB	2. SUBJECT	3. OBJECT / PREPOSITION
Npaq (Went out)	Malka (The King)	men (from) ʿ ar ʿ ā (the earth)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on

nouns related to narrative past (perfect tense) action and contexts.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܫܪܐ	šrā	verb (Peal)	to loosen, release; to dwell	III-Yodh root š-r-y
ܫܒܬܐ	šbītā	f. noun	captivity, escape	from root š-b-y (to capture)
ܩܬܠܐ	qeṭlā	m. noun	slaughter, killing	from root q-ṭ-l (to kill)
ܓܢܒܬܐ	gənūbūtā	f. noun	theft, stealing	from root g-n-b (to steal)
ܫܒܩܐܢܐ	šubqānā	m. noun	forgiveness, remission	from root š-b-q (to leave)
ܡܢܦܩܐܢܐ	mappqānā	m. noun	going out, exit	from root n-p-q (to go out)
ܕܡܥܬܐ	dem ʿ etā	f. noun	tear, weeping	from root d-m-ʿ (to weep)
ܚܡܡܬܐ	ḥammīmūtā	f. noun	heat, warmth	from root ḥ-m-m (to be hot)
ܡܚܬܐ	mḥūtā	f. noun	striking, blow	from root m-ḥ-y (to strike)
ܐܪܩܐ	ʿ ārōqā	m. noun	fugitive	from root ʿ-r-q (to flee)
ܩܪܒܐ	qūrbā	m. noun	drawing near, approach	from root q-r-b (to draw near)
ܪܕܦܐ	redūpyā	m. noun	pursuit, persecution	from root r-d-p (to pursue)
ܡܨܩܐܢܐ	masqānā	m. noun	ascent, rising	from root s-l-q (to ascend)
ܡܠܬܐ	pəlḥūtā	f. noun	service, labor	from root p-l-ḥ (to serve)

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܕܪܟܐ	dūrkā	m. noun	treading, path	from root d-r-k (to tread)
ܥܡܕܐ	‘amdā	m. noun	pillar, column	
ܫܠܬܐ	šallīṭā	m. noun	authority, ruler	from root š-l-ṭ (to rule)
ܪܓܡܐ	regmā	m. noun	stoning, lapidation	from root r-g-m (to stone)
ܡܬܪܬܐ	maṭartā	f. noun	guard, watch	from root n-ṭ-r (to watch)
ܢܬܪܐ	nāṭōrūtā	f. noun	watching, guarding	from root n-ṭ-r (to watch)
ܟܢܐ	kyānā	m. noun	nature, being	from root k-w-n (to be)
ܫܒܥܐ	səb ‘ūtā	f. noun	satisfaction, plenty	from root s-b-‘ (to be satisfied)
ܓܪܒܐ	garbā	m. noun	scab, leprosy	from root g-r-b
ܫܒܝܐ	šəbyā	m. noun	captive, prisoner	from root š-b-y (to capture)
ܦܠܬ	pəlah	verb (Peal)	to serve, work	Peal perfect form
ܡܡܠܐ	mamlā	m. noun	speech, discourse	from root m-l-l (to speak)
ܓܝܘܬܐ	gelyūtā	f. noun	revelation, manifestation	from root g-l-y (to reveal)
ܬܘܒ	tūb	adverb	again, furthermore	common particle
ܥܕܡܐ	‘edāmā	preposition	until, as far as	used in past narrative
ܡܕܒܪܐܢܐ	mədbərānā	m. noun	leader, guide	from root d-b-r (to lead)

LESSON 4

Personalizing the Text: Suffixes and Possession

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 3

Quick Summary

In Lesson 3, we examined the Peal Perfect tense (the suffix conjugation), learning how Syriac describes completed, past actions. The sentence structure shifted from fluidly subject-led (in the present participle) to stringently Verb-Subject-Object (VSO) led narrative chains using the conjunction **w-** (and).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. What does the suffix **-ū** indicate on a Perfect verb (e.g., *ktabū*)?
2. Translate the basic VSO sentence: *Shbaq malkā l- 'ar 'ā*.
3. What happens to the pronunciation of *k-t-b* (ka-tab) in the Syriac 3rd m.sg Perfect?
4. How do you distinguish between “I went” and “You (m) went” if both are written ܬܬܒܬ (*ktabt/ketbet*) without vowels?
5. Translate: *w-qreb Yūḥannan*.

SECTION 2: POSSESSION AND PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES — OVERVIEW

In English, we indicate possession using separate pronouns placed before a noun: “my house”, “your king”. In Greek, it’s often an independent genitive pronoun: ὁ οἶκός μου (*ho oikos mou*).

However, in Semitic languages, possession is expressed by attaching a **pronominal suffix** directly to the end of the noun.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Possessive Suffix

- **Hebrew:** סוס (*sūs*, horse) → סוסי (*sūsī*, my horse). אב (*'āb*, father) → אבינו (*'ābīnū*, our father).
- **Arabic:** كتاب (*kitāb*, book) → كتابي (*kitābī*, my book).
- **Syriac:** ܬܬܒܬ (*ktāb*, book) → ܬܬܒܝ (*ktāby*, my book). ܐܒ (*'ab*, father) → ܐܒܝܢ (*'abūn*, our father).

These suffixes are derived from the same ancient roots as the independent pronouns (*ʿenā*, *ʿant*, *hū*) but are highly compressed.

SECTION 3: PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES ON NOUNS & PREPOSITIONS

1. Suffixes on Singular Nouns

To add a suffix, Syriac uses the Absolute state of the noun, not the Emphatic state. (You don't say "the my-king" **malkā-y* ; you say "king-my", *malk-y*).

- *Malk-* (king) + *-eh* (his) = *malkeh* (his king).
- *ʿAb-* (father) + *-y* (my) = *ʿaby* (my father).

2. Suffixes on Prepositions

The exact same suffixes attach to the inseparable prepositions *b-* (in) and *l-* (to/for).

- *b-* + *-eh* = *beh* (in him / in it).
- *l-* + *-k* = *lāk* (to you, m.sg).

3. The Idiom for "To Have"

Syriac (like Hebrew and Arabic) lacks a dedicated verb meaning "to possess" (like English "to have" or Latin "habere"). Instead, Semitic languages use a prepositional phrase: "there is to me" or just "to me".

- *īt l-y* (there-is to-me) → *ītly* = I have.
 - *layt l-eh* (there-is-not to-him) = He does not have.
 - *ītly srārā* = I have truth. (Lit: There is to me truth).
-

SECTION 4: THE SUFFIX PARADIGM FOR SINGULAR NOUNS

This paradigm uses the masculine noun *malk-* (king, root m-l-k) and the feminine noun *malkūtt-* (kingdom). Notice the suffix column; you must memorize these endings.

PERSON	SUFFIX	MASCULINE NOUN (MALK-)	TRANSLIT	FEM NOUN (MALKŪTT-)	TRANSLIT
1 c.sg. (my)	ﻱ (-y)	ﻣﺎﻟﻚ	malk-y	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻱ	malkūtt-y
2 m.sg. (your)	ﻛ (-k)	ﻣﺎﻟﻚ	malk-āk	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻛ	malkūtt-āk
2 f.sg. (your)	ﻛﻲ (-ky)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻲ	malk-ēky	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻛﻲ	malkūtt-ēky
3 m.sg. (his)	ﻩ (-eh)	ﻣﺎﻟﻚ	malk-eh	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻩ	malkūtt-eh
3 f.sg. (her)	ﻩ (-āh)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﻲ	malk-āh	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻩ	malkūtt-āh
1 c.pl. (our)	ﻧ (-n)	ﻣﺎﻟﻚ	malk-an	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻥ	malkūtt-an
2 m.pl. (your)	ﻛﯘﻥ (-kūn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-kūn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻛﯘﻥ	malkūtt-kūn
2 f.pl. (your)	ﻛﻪﻥ (-kēn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-kēn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻛﻪﻥ	malkūtt-kēn
3 m.pl. (their)	ﻫﯘﻥ (-hūn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-hūn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻫﯘﻥ	malkūtt-hūn
3 f.pl. (their)	ﻫﻪﻥ (-hēn)	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﻥ	malk-hēn	ﻣﺎﻟﻜﯘﺗﺖﻫﻪﻥ	malkūtt-hēn

Orthography Note: The 3rd masculine singular (-eh) and 3rd feminine singular (-āh) are both spelled with a final Heh (ﻩ). Only vowel pointing or context distinguishes “his” from “her”.

SECTION 5: PREPOSITIONAL "TO HAVE" PARADIGM (L- + SUFFIX)

How to say "I have", "You have", "He has", etc., by attaching suffixes to the **l-** preposition, often preceded by *it* (there is).

PERSON	ESTRANGELA (L- + SUFFIX)	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING
1 c.sg.	ل	lī	to me (I have)
2 m.sg.	لك	lāk	to you (You have)
2 f.sg.	لكي	lēky	to you (You have)
3 m.sg.	له	lēh	to him (He has)
3 f.sg.	له	lāh	to her (She has)
1 c.pl.	لنا	lān	to us (We have)
2 m.pl.	لكم	lkūn	to you (You all have)
3 m.pl.	لهم	lhūn	to them (They have)

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (FAMILY, BODY PARTS & BELONGINGS)

Family and body parts are the most common nouns to receive pronominal suffixes.

ABSOLUTE / EMPHATIC	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING	EXAMPLE WITH SUFFIX (1 C.SG.)
אב / אבא	'ab / 'abā	Father	'ab-y (my father)
אם / אמא	'em / 'emmā	Mother	'em-y (my mother)
בן / בנא	bar / brā	Son	bar-y (my son)
בת / בתא	bart / brattā	Daughter	bart-y (my daughter)
אח / אחא	'ah / 'ahā	Brother	'ah-y (my brother)
יד / ידא	'id / 'idā	Hand (f)	'id-y (my hand)
ראש / ראשא	rēš / rēšā	Head (m)	rēš-y (my head)
קול / קולא	qāl / qālā	Voice (m)	qāl-y (my voice)
לבוש / לבושא	lbūš / lbūšā	Garment	lbūš-y (my garment)
בית / ביתא	bēt / baytā	House	bayt-y (my house)
מה / מא	mā / mānā	What?	(Interrogative pronoun)
איפה	'aykō	Where?	(Interrogative adverb)

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 4

A Dialogue at the Gate

*Narrative note: Watch how the guards use suffixes with prepositions (*lēh* , *lḵūn*) and nouns (*'abūk* , *'emāk*) to interrogate Yūḥannan about his origins and possessions.*

Sentence 1

אבא דמלכותא קאם יוֹחָנָן בִּתְרֵי אֲדִמְלְכֻתָּא. qām Yūḥannan b-tar 'ā d-malküttā. qām (stood) Yūḥannan (John) b-tar 'ā (in-the-gate) d-malküttā (of-the-kingdom). → Yūḥannan stood at the gate of the kingdom.

Sentence 2

וְאֵלֵּי הַשָּׁרֵפִים וְאֵלֵּי הַשָּׂרֵפִים w- 'āmrīn qašīšē d-tar 'ā l-ēh: w- 'āmrīn (and-are-saying) qašīšē (the-elders/guards) d-tar 'ā (of-the-gate) l-ēh (to-him): → And the guards of the gate say to him:

Sentence 3

מֵאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה מֵאֵי מְדִינָה men 'aynā 'atrā 'ant? men (from) 'aynā (what) 'atrā (country/place) 'ant (you-[are])? → “From what country are you?”

Sentence 4

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה w- 'aykō 'ab-ūk w- 'em-āk? w- 'aykō (and-where) 'ab-ūk (father-your) w- 'em-āk (and-mother-your)? → “And where is your father and your mother?”

Sentence 5

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה w-mā it lāk b- 'īd-āk? w-mā (and-what) it (there-is) lāk (to-you) b- 'īd-āk (in-hand-your)? → “And what do you have in your hand?”

Sentence 6

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה 'emar l-hūn Yūḥannan: 'emar (said) l-hūn (to-them) Yūḥannan (John): → Yukhannan said to them:

Sentence 7

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה Alāhā hū 'ab-y, w- 'ar 'ā hī 'em-y. Alāhā (God) hū (he-[is]) 'ab-y (father-my), w- 'ar 'ā (and-the-earth) hī (she-[is]) 'em-y (mother-my). → “God is my father, and the earth is my mother.”

Sentence 8

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה w-layt lī lbūšā bīšā. w-layt (and-there-is-not) lī (to-me) lbūšā (a-garment) bīšā (evil). → “And I do not have an evil garment.”

Sentence 9

וְאֵי מְדִינָה אַתָּה אֵי מְדִינָה nūhrā d-Alāhā it-awhy b- 'īd-y. nūhrā (the-light) d-Alāhā (of-God) it-awhy (it-is) b- 'īd-y (in-hand-my). → “The light of God is in my hand.”

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification

Identify the person, gender, and number of the possessor for the following suffixed nouns.

1. ܡܠܟܐ (malk-an)
2. ܒܝܬܐ (bayt-eh)
3. ܐܝܕܐ (ʾīd-ēky)
4. ܡܠܟܘܬܐ (malkūt-hūn)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill (Possession)

Translate the following phrases using ܐܝܬ- + suffix (using *īt* where appropriate to mean “have”):

1. To you (f.sg).
2. We have (There is to us).
3. He does not have (There is not to him).
4. To them (m.pl).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences containing suffixed nouns.

1. ʾAbī ṭābā hū, w-ʾemī ṭābtā hī.
2. Šbaqū talmīdē l-baythūn.
3. Īt lān nūhrā rabbā.
4. Qālā d-malkā b-ʾarʿan (ʾarʿan).

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration.

1. My brother is writing a word.
2. The king and his son are going to his kingdom.
3. What is in your (m.sg) hand?
4. We do not have (*layt lān*) an evil king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. Under what three topics does the guard interrogate Yuxhannan?
 2. Who does Yuxhannan claim as his parents?
 3. What does Yuxhannan explicitly state he *does not* have?
-

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. 3rd person masculine plural (“they”).
2. The king left the earth.
3. The *a* vowel in the middle of the root disappears (vowel reduction), making it *ktab* (k-t-a-b).
4. Only context or vowel pointing.
5. And Yuxhannan drew near.

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification

1. 1st common plural (Our king)
2. 3rd masc singular (His house)
3. 2nd fem singular (Your hand)
4. 3rd masc plural (Their kingdom)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. lēky
2. īt lān
3. layt lēh
4. lhūn

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. My father is good, and my mother is good.
2. The disciples left their house (*bayt-hūn*).
3. We have a great light (There is to us a great light).
4. The voice of the king is in our land (‘ar ‘-an = ‘ar ‘ā + -an).

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. ' aḥ-y kāteb meltā.
2. Malkā w-bar-eh ' āzlin l-malkūt-eh.
3. Mā it b- ' id-āk?
4. Layt lān malkā bīšā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. Origin (what country), Family (where are father/mother), and Possessions (what is in hand).
 2. God (father) and the earth (mother).
 3. An evil garment (*lbūšā bīšā*).
-

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PRONOMINAL SUFFIXES (ATTACH TO NOUNS AND PREPOSITIONS)

SUFFIX	MEANING	EXAMPLE (BAYT- HOUSE)	EXAMPLE (L- TO)
-y	my	baytī (my house)	lī (to me)
-k	your (m)	baytāk (your house)	lāk (to you)
-ky	your (f)	baytēky (your house)	lēky (to you)
-eh	his	bayteh (his house)	lēh (to him)
-āh	her	baytāh (her house)	lāh (to her)
-an	our	baytan (our house)	lān (to us)
-kūn	your (pl)	baytkūn (your house)	lkūn (to you all)
-hūn	their (pl)	baythūn (their house)	lhūn (to them)

SAYING “TO HAVE” (Possession Formula)

FORMULA	SYRIAC	MEANING
ĪT + L- + Suffix	īt lī / itly	I have (There is to me)
LAYT + L- + Suffix	layt lēh	He does not have
ĪT + L- + Suffix	īt lhūn malkā	They have a king

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 18 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܠܦܬܐ	sputā	f. noun	lip	emphatic state
ܬܠܓܐ	talggā	m. noun	ridge, back	
ܫܝܪܐ	ṣirē	f. noun	side, rib	
ܕܥܒܐ	ganbā	m. noun	thigh	
ܕܪܥܐ	dar ʿ ā	f. noun	arm	
ܕܠܓܐ	ʿaggālā	m. noun	calf (leg part)	
ܕܬܢܐ	ḥatnā	m. noun	bridegroom	
ܕܬܠܐ	kaltā	f. noun	bride	
ܕܝܡܪܐ	ʿammūrā	m. noun	uncle (paternal)	
ܕܝܡܬܐ	ʿammtā	f. noun	aunt (paternal)	
ܕܝܡܩܐ	ʿammqā	m. adj	deep	
ܕܠܬܐ	paltā	m. noun	escape, safety	
ܕܝܬܪܐ	ʿattirā	m. adj	rich, mighty	
ܕܝܡܟܢܐ	meskennā	m. adj	poor, humble	
ܕܝܡܒܪܐ	gibbōrā	m. adj	mighty, strong	
ܕܠܠܐ	qallilā	m. adj	small, few	
ܕܝܠܕܐ	yḥiddā	m. adj	alone, unique	
ܕܠܕܐ	ʿaddālā	m. adj	just, righteous	

LESSON 5

The Aphel Stem: Divine Action & Causative Verbs

ܐܦܗܠ

ʾAPHEL

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–4

Quick Summary

Before diving into the Aphel stem, let's review the foundational material from the first four lessons:

- Lesson 0: The Estrangela alphabet, letter order, and the non-joining letters.
- Lesson 1: The noun system (gender, number, and the absolute, construct, and emphatic states), independent pronouns, verbless clauses, and the particles *d-* (relative/possessive) and *l-* (to/for, direct object).
- Lesson 2: The Peal stem and its active participle. With enclitic pronouns, the participle forms the narrative present (*kāteb-nā*, “I am writing”).
- Lesson 3: The Peal perfect (suffix conjugation) of ܬܒܬ (*k-t-b*, ‘write’), V-S-O narrative word order, and the conjunction *w-*.
- Lesson 4: Pronominal suffixes on nouns and prepositions, and the idiom *ʾit l-* for “to have”.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions using what you've learned. Answers are in Section 9.

1. ܬܒܬ — Give the 3rd m.sg. Peal perfect and its meaning.
2. What are the three states of the Syriac noun? Give an example of each.
3. Translate: ܗܘ ܪܒܒܐ ܗܘ (*hū rabbā hū*)
4. What does the Peal active participle of ܐܠܬ (*ʾ-z-l*, ‘go’) look like, m.sg.?
5. Identify the root and stem of the form ܬܒܬܐ (*ketbat*)

SECTION 2: THE DERIVED STEMS — OVERVIEW

One of the most powerful features of Semitic languages — shared by Syriac, Hebrew, and Arabic — is the system of **derived verbal stems**. A single three-consonant root can generate multiple verbs with systematically related meanings, simply by modifying the vowel pattern and/or adding prefixes or affixes.

This is very different from Greek or Latin, where related meanings usually require entirely different words. In Syriac, once you know a root, you already know the building blocks of an entire semantic family.

The Three Major Active Stems

Stem Name	Formation Pattern	Basic Meaning Shift	Example
Peal	Basic vowel pattern	Basic action / state	ܟܬܒ — <i>katab</i> , ‘he wrote’
Paael	Middle root letter doubled	Intensive / Factitive	ܩܕܕܫ — <i>qaddaš</i> , ‘he sanctified’
Aphel	’a- prefix added	Causative	ܐܚܝܬ — <i>’ahyī</i> , ‘he caused to live’

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

For those coming from Hebrew or Arabic, these correspondences will look familiar:

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Hebrew	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Function	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative

For learners with a Greek background: Greek uses **voice** (active, middle, passive) and **aspect** to express some of these distinctions, but there is no exact parallel to the Semitic derived stem system. The Greek causative construction (e.g., *ποιεῖν + infinitive*) expresses what the Aphel does morphologically. Latin similarly uses circumlocutions (*facere + infinitive*) or prefix verbs for some causative senses.

SECTION 3: THE APHEL STEM

Core Meaning: Causative

The Aphel stem expresses **causative** action — ‘to *cause* X to happen’ or ‘to *make* X do Y.’ In theological language, this is the stem of divine action: God *’ahyī* (gave life), God *’aglī* (revealed), God *’aqreb* (brought

near).

Formation

- **Perfect:** 'a- prefix + CeCC pattern (same person suffixes as Peal perfect)
- **Participle:** m- prefix + CaCC-eC pattern (cf. Peal participle)

Comparison with Other Languages

- **Hebrew Hiphil:** prefix הִ/הֵ (hi-/he-) added to the root. E.g., *ḥāyāh* (live) → *heḥēyāh* (give life); *qārāb* (draw near) → *hiqrīb* (bring near/offer). The structural parallel to Syriac Aphel is very close.
- **Arabic Form IV:** 'a- prefix + CaCaCa → 'aCCaCa. E.g., *ḥaraja* (go out) → '*aḥraja* (bring out); *qāraba* (approach) → '*aqraba* (bring near). The Syriac Aphel prefix 'a- is cognate with Arabic Form IV.
- **Greek/Latin:** No direct morphological equivalent. Greek uses prefix verbs (e.g., ζωοποιεῖν, 'to give life') or constructions with ποιεῖν + inf. Latin uses *facere* + *infinitive* or prefix verbs.

Aphel Examples: Peal → Aphel

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Aphel (Syr)	Aphel Translit	Aphel Meaning
ܣܪ ܗ-ܝ-ܝ'ܬ	o live' ܣܪ	ܣ * 'aḥyī (Peal)	* 'to give lif	e,	save'
ܩܪ ܩ-ܪ-ܒ'	to draw ܩܪ	ܩܪ * 'aqr near' (Peal)	ܐܒ * 'to bring ne	ar,	offer'
ܩܪ ܢ-ܦ-ܩ	'to go	ܩܪ * 'a out' (Peal)	ܩܩܩ * 'to bring	out,	produce'
ܩܪ ܢ-ܦ-ܠ'ܬ	o fall' ܩܪ	ܩܪ * 'appe (Peal)	ܐܠ * 'to cause to f	all,	throw down'

The 'Alap-Lamed-Peh Root ('-l-p) in the Aphel

The root ܐܠܦ ('-l-p) means 'learn' in the Peal stem. In the Aphel, it means '**to teach**' — that is, 'to cause someone to learn.' This root will be used for all paradigm tables in Sections 4–5.

SECTION 4: APHEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: 'l-p | Stem: Aphel | Meaning: 'to teach'

לפ Perfect — Full Conjugation

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	לפ 'alep	he ta	ught
3 f.sg.	לפ * 'allpa	t* she	taught
2 m.sg.	לפ * 'alept	* you (m.sg	.) taught
2 f.sg.	לפ * 'alepti	* you (f.sg	.) taught
1 c.sg.	לפ * 'allpe	t* I t	aught
3 m.pl.	לפ * 'allpū	* they (m	.) taught
3 f.pl.	לפ * 'allpī	* they (f	.) taught
2 m.pl.	לפ * 'aleptū	n* you (m.pl	.) taught
2 f.pl.	לפ * 'alepti	n* you (f.pl	.) taught
1 c.pl.	לפ * 'allpe	n* we t	aught

Formation Notes:

- **Prefix:** 'a- added before the root (3 m.sg.: 'alep)
- **Root-internal vowel:** e vowel between R2 and R3 in 3 m.sg.
- **Suffixes:** Identical to Peal perfect suffixes (-at, -t, -ti, -et, -ū, -ī, -tūn, -tin, -n)
- **Note on gutturals:** When R1 is Alaph ('), assimilation or lengthening may occur in some forms

Comparison: Hebrew Hiphil Perfect

The Hebrew Hiphil perfect is structurally parallel to the Syriac Aphel perfect, with a causative prefix (ܐ- hi-/ܐ- he-) and essentially the same suffix set:

Person	Hebrew (Hiphil)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	אֱמַן	he 'ēmīn	he believed (H. Hiphil of ' -m-n)
3 f.sg.	אֱמַנָה	he 'ēmīnāh	she believed
1 c.sg.	אֱמַנְתִּי	he 'ēmantī	I believed
3 m.pl.	אֱמַנּוּ	he 'ēmīnū	they believed

Comparison: Arabic Form IV Perfect

Arabic Form IV (' aCCaCa) is cognate with the Syriac Aphel. The prefix ' a- and the causative meaning are identical; only the internal vowel pattern differs:

Person	Arabic (Form IV)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	أَرْسَلَ	' arsala	he sent (Form IV of r-s-l)
3 f.sg.	أَرْسَلَتْ	' arsalat	she sent
1 c.sg.	أَرْسَلْتُ	' arsaltu	I sent
3 m.pl.	أَرْسَلُوا	' arsalū	they sent

SECTION 5: APHEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: ' -l-p | Stem: Aphel | Meaning: 'causing to learn / teaching'

The Aphel active participle expresses ongoing or habitual causative action. It also frequently serves as an adjective. The participle prefix is **m-** (as in all derived stems).

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg. (active)	ܡܠܦܐ ma 'lep	teaching	(m.sg.)
f.sg. (active)	ܡܠܦܐ ma 'lpā	teaching	(f.sg.)
m.pl. (active)	ܡܠܦܝܢ ma 'lpī	n teaching	(m.pl.)
f.pl. (active)	ܡܠܦܝܢ ma 'lpā	n teaching	(f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- added before the root (same prefix as Paael and other derived-stem participles)
- **Vowel pattern:** ma ' - + R2 + vowel + R3 (cf. Peal participle kāteb → Aphel ma 'lep)
- **Gender/number suffixes:** Same as all Syriac participles: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Hiphil participle: prefix מִ/מֵ (ma-/me-). E.g., *ma'āmīn* (believing/trusting — from 'm-n Hiphil). The m- participle prefix is pan-Semitic.

Arabic Form IV active participle: pattern muCCiC. E.g., *mursil* (sending/sender — from 'arsala). Note the Arabic Form IV participle has the vowel shift u-i, while Syriac uses a-e.

KEY PATTERN: In all Syriac derived stems, the participle prefix is m-. This is one of the most consistent features of Syriac verbal morphology. If you see a verb beginning with m- that is not a Peal form, suspect a derived-stem participle.

SECTION 6: THEOLOGICAL VOCABULARY

Abstract Nouns and Key Theological Terms

The following twenty terms form the core theological vocabulary of early Syriac Christianity. Many are

abstract nouns derived from the same roots as the verbs you are learning.

Estrangela	Transliteration	Meaning	Notes
ܠܝܚܝܬܐ / ܠܝܚܝܬܐ	ḥayye / purqānā s	salvation / life (life/li	Two overlapping terms; ḥayye ves, pl.) often = ‘eternal life’; purqānā = ‘redemption’
ܠܝܠܝܐ glāyā	revelation,	From Aphe disclosure	ܠܝܠܝܐ ḡlāyā; cf. Gk apokalypsis, Lat revelatio
ܫܕܪܐ šedārā	sending, miss	From šadar	; cf. Heb šāliah (envoy), Gk apostolos
ܒܪܝܬܐ brītā	creation	From brā	; cf. Heb bārā ’, Gen 1:1
ܪܗܡܐ raḥmē	mercy,	Pl. of raḥmā compassion	; cognate with Heb raḥmīm, Arabic raḥma
ܕܝܢܐ dīnā	judgment	Cf. Heb dīn	(legal judgment), Arabic dīn (religion/judgment)
ܫܒܚܐ šūbhā	glory, prais	e Cf. Heb kābōd	; used in doxologies
ܬܝܒܐ ṭaybūt	ā grace, goodne	ss Abstract nou	n from ṭāb (good); cf. Gk charis, Latin gratia
ܚܝܡܢܐ haymānūt	tā faith, trus	t Abstract nou	n from hayman; cf. Heb ’ēmūnāh
ܠܝܚܝܬܐ kēnūt	ā righteousness	s, Cf. Gk dikai justice	osynē, Heb šēdāqāh
ܠܝܠܝܐ ḥēttā	sin,	Cf. Gk ha transgression	martia, Heb ḥēṭ
ܡܠܬܐ ma ‘ mūdīt	tā baptism	Lit. ’immers	ion’; from ‘-m-d; cf. Gk baptisma
ܫܠܬܐ šlūtā	prayer	From š-l-y;	cf. Heb tefillah
ܘܠܦܐ ṭalpān	ā teaching,	Abstract nou instruction	n from Aphel ṭalp
ܢܒܝܐ nebūt	ā prophecy	From n-b-y;	cf. Heb nēbū ’āh, Gk prophēteia
ܩܝܡܐ qyāmā	covenant,	Double meanin resurrection	g: covenant (cf. Heb bērit) and resurrection
ܟܬܒܐ ktābā	scripture,	From k-t-b; writing	cf. Arabic kitāb, Hebrew kētābīm

בִּרְכָּה bŭrktā	blessing	From b-r-k;	cf. Heb bĕrākāh, Arabic baraka
רוּחַ rūḥā	spirit, wind	, f. noun; cf breath	. Heb rūaḥ, Arabic rūḥ, Gk pneuma
שְׂרָרָה šrārā	truth, reali	ty Cf. Heb 'ēmet	, Gk alētheia; šrār = 'to be firm/true'

Key Aphel Verbs in Theological Context

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Usage Note
אָהַי 'ahyī	Aphel	to save, give	Causative of life	ḥ-y-y (live); divine act par excellence
אָגַל 'aglī	Aphel	to reveal,	Causative o uncover	f g-l-y (be revealed); cf. Heb gillāh
שָׂדַר šadar	Peal/Aphel	to send	Common verb;	šadar/ ' ešdar; cf. Heb šālāḥ
בָּרָא brā	Peal	to create	Note: in Sy	riac this is Peal (not Aphel); cf. Heb bārā '
קָרַז 'kraz	Aphel	to proclaim,	From k-r-z; preach	kerygmatic vocabulary
רָמַר 'rīm	Aphel	to exalt,	Causative of lift up	r-m (be high); cf. Heb hērīm
שָׁפַל 'špel	Aphel	to humble,	Causative o lower	f š-p-l (be low); antonym of ' rīm
פָּרַק 'praq	Aphel	to redeem,	Causative o deliver	f p-r-q (be freed); cf. purqānā above
קִדְּדַשׁ qaddaš	Paael	to sanctify,	Preview of make holy	Paael; from q-d-š (be holy); cf. Heb qiddēš
אָקֵרַב 'aqreb	Aphel	to bring	Causative of near, offer	q-r-b (draw near); cf. Arabic qurraba

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 5

Yukhannan Preaches to the Crowds

Narrative note: This passage features heavy use of the Aphel stem to describe God’s causative actions in history. Notice the verbless clauses used for theological assertions (sentences 6 and 9). Aphel forms are highlighted in the transliteration.

Key Aphel forms in this passage: ’kraz (proclaimed), ’alep (taught), ’aḥyī (gave life/saved), ’aglī (revealed), ’aqrebtūn (brought near), ’appaqnī (brought me out), ’aḥyat (gave life), ’aqrebtñī (brought me near)

Sentence 1

וַיִּקְרָא יוֹחָנָן בֶּן־זִכְיָא בְּתוֹכָם וַיִּבְרָךְ אֶת־הָעָם

w-Yukhannan qam b-meṣ’ at ‘ammā w-’kraz ’ennūn

w- (and-) Yukhannan (John) qam (rose/stood) b-meṣ’ at (in-the-midst-of) ‘ammā (the-people) w-’kraz (and-proclaimed) ’ennūn (them)

→ *And Yuhannan stood in the midst of the people and proclaimed to them:*

Sentence 2

וַיִּבְרָךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וַיִּתֵּן לָנוּ דְּבַר חַיָּיָה

Māryā šadar lī d-’alep yātḵūn ’ūrḥā d-ḥayye

Māryā (the-Lord) šadar (sent) lī (to-me) d-’alep (that-I-should-teach) yātḵūn (you(pl.)) ’ūrḥā (the-way) d-ḥayye (of-life)

→ *‘The Lord has sent me to teach you the way of life.’*

Sentence 3

אֱלֹהֵינוּ דְּבְרָא כֻּלְּמַדְמַתְּ אֶתְּכֻן בְּפֻרְקָנֵהּ

Alāhā d-brā kull medem ’aḥyī lḵūn b-purqāneh

Alāhā (God) d-brā (who-created) kull (all) medem (thing) ’aḥyī (caused-to-live/saved) lḵūn (you(pl.)) b-purqāneh (by-his-redemption)

→ *‘God, who created all things, has saved you through his redemption.’*

Sentence 4

ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܪܐܝܬܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ

Hū 'aglī lān rāzā d-ṭaybūtteh

Hū (He) 'aglī (revealed) lān (to-us) rāzā (the-mystery) d-ṭaybūtteh (of-his-grace)

→ *'He has revealed to us the mystery of his grace.'*

Sentence 5

ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܪܐܝܬܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ

w-hāšā 'aqrebtūn l-Alāhā b-haymānūtā

w- (and-) hāšā (now) 'aqrebtūn (you(pl.)-have-been-brought-near) l-Alāhā (to-God) b-haymānūtā (by-faith)

→ *'And now you have been brought near to God through faith.'*

Sentence 6

ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܪܐܝܬܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ

Hannū šrārā d-malkūtā d-Alāhā

Hannū (This-is) šrārā (the-truth) d-malkūtā (of-the-kingdom) d-Alāhā (of-God)

→ *'This is the truth of the kingdom of God.'*

Sentence 7

ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܪܐܝܬܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ ܕܗܝܠܐ

w- 'ammā šma ' mellāw-hy w- 'etdammer ṭāb

w- (and-) 'ammā (the-people) šma ' (heard) mellāw-hy (his-words) w- 'etdammer (and-marveled) ṭāb (greatly/well)

→ *And the people heard his words and marveled greatly.*

Sentence 8

וְאָמַר גַּבְרָא חָד מֵעַם אַמְמָּא מַן אַנְתְּ וּמִן שֶׁדְרָאֲךָ?

w- 'emar gabrā ḥad men ' ammā: man ' ant w-man šedrāk?

w- 'emar (and-said) gabrā (a-man) ḥad (one) men (from) ' ammā (the-people) man (who) ' ant (are-you)

w-man (and-who) šedrāk (sent-you)

→ *And a man from the people said: 'Who are you, and who sent you?'*

Sentence 9

חָא אָמַר גַּבְרָא חָד מֵעַם אַמְמָּא מַן אַנְתְּ וּמִן שֶׁדְרָאֲךָ?

' nā Yukhannan w- 'emar: ' enā ' abdeh d-Māryā

' nā (answered) Yukhannan (Yukhannan) w- 'emar (and-said) ' enā (I) ' abdeh (servant-of) d-Māryā (the-Lord)

→ *Yukhannan answered and said: 'I am the servant of the Lord.'*

Sentence 10

חָא אָמַר גַּבְרָא חָד מֵעַם אַמְמָּא מַן אַנְתְּ וּמִן שֶׁדְרָאֲךָ?

Hū ' appaqnī men madbārā d- ' alep l- ' ammeh

Hū (He) ' appaqnī (brought-me-out) men (from) madbārā (the-wilderness) d- ' alep (to-teach) l- (to)

' ammeh (his-people)

→ *'He brought me out from the wilderness to teach his people.'*

Sentence 11

וְרֻחָא דְאַלְהָא חֵי דְ אֲהַיַּת לִי וְאַקְרֵבְתִּי לְמַלְכְּוֹתָא

w-rūḥā d-Alāhā hī d- ' aḥyat lī w- ' aqrebtī l-malkūtteh

w- (and-) rūḥā (the-Spirit) d-Alāhā (of-God) hī (she/it-is) d- ' aḥyat (who-gave-life) lī (to-me) w- ' aqrebtī

(and-brought-me-near) l-malkūtteh (to-his-kingdom)

→ *'And it is the Spirit of God who gave me life and brought me near to his kingdom.'*

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify each verb form as Peal or Aphel, give its person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	ܐܠܦ	'alep
2	ܟܬܒ	katab
3	ܐܗܝܝ	'ahyī
4	ܐܙܠ	'azal
5	ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb
6	ܡܐܠܦ	ma 'lep
7	ܫܡܐ	šma 'ē
8	ܐܦܦܩ	'appeq
9	ܟܬܒ	kāteb
10	ܐܒܠܝ	'aglī

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Aphel verbs in the perfect (all 10 persons) and the participle (all 4 forms). Use the paradigm in Sections 4–5 as a model.

6. Root *š-d-r* (*send*) — Aphel: 'ešdar

7. Root *r-m* (*be high*) — Aphel: 'rīm (*exalt*)

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences into English. All contain Aphel forms.

1. ܐܠܗܐ ܐܗܝܠ-ܐܡܡܗ (Alāhā 'ahyī l-'ammeh)

2. ܝܘܗܢܢܐܢ ܐܠܦ ܠܬܠܡܝܕܐܘܗܝ (Yūḥannan 'alep l-talmīdāw-hy)

3. ܠܗܘܐ ܐܦܦܩ ܠܗܘܢ ܡܢ ܒܝܬ ܐܦܦܩܐ (Hū 'appeq lhūn men bēt 'esūrā)

4. ܪܘܗܐ ܐܓܠܝ ܫܪܐܪܐ (*Rūḥā 'aglī šrārā*)
5. ܡܪܝܐ ܐܩܪܒܢܐܢ ܠܡܠܟܘܬܬܗ (*Māryā 'aqrebnān l-malkūtteh*)
6. ܡܐ ܠܦܥܢܐ ܠܟܘܢ ܐܘܪܗܐ (*Ma 'lep 'enā lkūn 'ūrḥā*)
7. ܐܢܬ ܪܝܡܬ ܠܐܒܕܐܟ (*'Ant 'rīmt l- 'abdāk*)
8. ܠܡܠܟܘܬܬܐ ܐܘܠܦܢܐ ܕܡܠܟܘܬܬܐ (*Hannū 'ūlpānā d-malkūtā*)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Aphel)

Render the following causative sentences into Syriac using the Aphel stem. More than one correct answer may exist.

1. God revealed his glory to the people.
2. She taught the children the law.
3. The Spirit brought him out of the wilderness.
4. You (m.pl.) have brought near the offering.
5. The prophet gave life to the dead (mītē).
6. The Lord exalted the humble (makīkē).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7, then answer the following comprehension questions in complete Syriac sentences if possible, or in English.

1. What did Yukhannan say the Lord sent him to do?
2. What three actions does Yukhannan attribute to God in his speech? (Name the Aphel verbs.)
3. What question does the man from the crowd ask?
4. How does Yukhannan identify himself?
5. What brought Yukhannan out of the wilderness and brought him near the kingdom?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

Q1: Peal perfect 3 m.sg. of k-t-b: כתב (katab) = ‘he wrote’

Q2: Absolute: מלך (malk, ‘king’); Emphatic: מלכא (malkā, ‘the king’); Construct: מלך (malk + genitive, ‘king of...’)

Q3: ‘He is great’ — verbless clause with pronoun as copula

Q4: אצל (‘āzel), ‘going’ — the CāCeC pattern

Q5: Root: k-t-b; Stem: Peal; Form: perfect 3 f.sg. — ‘she wrote’ (the same letters also spell 2 m.sg. and 1 c.sg.)

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Aphel	3 m.sg.	’-l-p	he taught
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
4	Peal	3 m.sg.	’-z-l	he went
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
6	Aphel Ptcp	m.sg.	’-l-p	teaching
7	Peal	3 m.sg.	š-m-‘	he heard
8	Aphel	3 m.sg.	n-p-q	he brought out
9	Peal Ptcp	m.sg.	k-t-b	writing/writer
10	Aphel	3 m.sg.	g-l-y	he revealed

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	God saved his people.
2	Yukhannan taught his disciples.
3	He brought them out of prison.
4	The Spirit revealed the truth.
5	The Lord brought us near to his kingdom.
6	I am teaching you the way.
7	You (m.sg.) have exalted your servant.
8	This is the teaching of the kingdom.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Alāhā 'aglī šūbhēh l- 'ammā*
2. *'alepat l-yalūdē nāmūsā*
3. *Rūhā 'appaqeh men madbārā*
4. *'aqrebtūn qūrbānā*
5. *Nebīyā 'ahyī l-mītē*
6. *Māryā 'rīm l-makīkē*

Exercise 5: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	To teach them the way of life ('ūrḥā d-ḥayye).
2	'ahyī (saved/gave life), 'aglī (revealed), 'aqrebtūn (brought near).
3	‘Who are you, and who sent you?’
4	As the servant ('abdeh) of the Lord.
5	The Spirit of God (Rūhā d-Alāhā).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE APHEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Feature	Rule	Example
Perfect prefix	'a- (Ayin-Alaph) before root	'a + R1 + e + R2 + suffix
Perfect 3 m.sg.	'a + R1R2eR3 (no suffix)	'alep, 'ahyī, 'aqreb
Suffix set	Same as Peal perfect	-at, -t, -ti, -et, -ū, -ī, -tūn, -tin, -n
Participle prefix	m- before root	m + ' + R2 + e + R3
Participle 3 m.sg.	ma ' + R2eR3	ma 'lep
Participle suffixes	Same as all participles	-ā (f.sg.), -īn (m.pl.), -ān (f.pl.)
Core meaning	Causative	'to cause X to happen' / 'to make X do Y'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + 'a- prefix = APHEL (causative) 'to X' → 'to cause to X' / 'to make X happen' ḥ-y-y: live → 'ahyī: give life/save | q-r-b: draw near → 'aqreb: bring near | n-p-q: go out → 'appeq: bring out

Comparative Summary: Three Stems

Stem	Meaning	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	'he wrote' / 'writing'
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	qaddaš	mqaḍdeš	'he sanctified' / 'sanctifying'
Aphel	Causative	'alep	ma 'lep	'he taught' / 'teaching'

Remember: In all three derived stems (Paael, Aphel, Ethpaael, etc.), the active participle always takes a m- prefix. This is your clearest signal that you are reading a derived-stem participle.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 15 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
כַּחַיָּא	'aḥyā	m	give life
כַּחֲלָא	'aglā	m	reveal
כַּלְבָּשׁ	'albāš	m	clothe
כַּפְּקַד	'apqad	m	entrust
כַּרְמִי	'armī	m	lift up
כַּשְׁדָּר	'ašdar	m	send
כַּלְפָּא	'alpā	m	teach
כַּחֲלֻתָּא	aglūtā	f	revelation
כַּחֲשֻׁתָּא	asdūtā	f	sending
כַּחֲלֻתָּא	a 'lūtā	f	ascent
כַּחֲלֻתָּא	alpūtā	f	teaching
כַּחֲמָא	'astmā	m	hide
כַּחֲבֻשָּׂא	albūšā	m	clothing
כַּחֲרַב	'aqrab	m	bring near
כַּחֲמָא	'aqūm	m	raise, stand

LESSON 6

The Paael Stem: Intensive, Factitive, and Formal Religious Action

ܐܠܠܗ

PĀ'EL

Worship and religious vocabulary · Conflict with established religion

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–5

Cumulative Review

Lesson 6 builds directly on Lesson 5. You should now be comfortable with the Aphel stem (causative). This lesson introduces its close sibling: the Paael, the intensive/factitive stem.

- **Lesson 5 review:** The Aphel stem: 'a- prefix, causative meaning (“to cause X”). Perfect paradigm (ʿ allep), participle (ma 'lep). Comparison with Hebrew Hiphil and Arabic Form IV.
- **Lessons 1–4 recap:** Estrangela alphabet; noun states, pronouns and verbless clauses; the Peal participle with enclitics (present); the Peal perfect (past); pronominal suffixes and 'it l- (“to have”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions before proceeding. Answers in Section 8.

1. Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of the root q-r-b (draw near) and translate it.
2. ܐܠܠܗ — what form is this? What is its root and stem?
3. Translate: ܪܘܚܐ ܐܓܠܝ ܫܪܐܪܐ (Rūḥā 'aglī šrārā)
4. What is the Hebrew Hiphil equivalent of the Syriac Aphel? Give one example.
5. Give the Aphel participle (all four forms) of root 'l-p (teach).

SECTION 2: THE PAAEL STEM

Core Meaning: Intensive and Factitive

The Paael stem (also spelled Pael or Pā'el) expresses two related types of intensified meaning:

- **Intensive:** Repeated, thoroughgoing, or heightened action. ‘He wrote’ (Peal) → ‘he wrote carefully/copied out’ (Paael).
- **Factive:** Causing someone or something to enter into a state. ‘Be holy’ (Peal) → ‘make holy/sanctify’ (Paael). The Paael turns intransitive verbs into transitive ones.

Formation: Gemination of the Middle Root Letter

The defining feature of the Paael is the **doubling (gemination) of the middle root consonant (R2)**. This is written with a *dageš*-like diacritic in pointing, or simply by writing the letter twice in some scripts.

- **Perfect:** CaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern — e.g., barrek (from b-r-k), qaddaš (from q-d-š), yallep (from y-l-p)
- **Participle:** mCaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern (m- prefix) — e.g., mbarrek, mqaddeš, myallep

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

- **Hebrew Piel:** The direct cognate of the Syriac Paael. Also formed by doubling R2. Compare: *kipper* (Piel, ‘atone/cover’ — from k-p-r), *bērak* (Piel, ‘bless’ — from b-r-k), *qiddēš* (Piel, ‘sanctify’). The structural identity is near-perfect.
- **Arabic Form II:** Formed by doubling R2 (qaddama, ‘to present/offer’; ‘allama, ‘to teach/instruct’; qaddasa, ‘to sanctify’). Arabic Form II corresponds precisely to Syriac Paael in both form and function.
- **Greek:** No direct morphological equivalent. Intensives expressed via prefix verbs (e.g., *κατα-* compounds), aspect (perfect), or adverbs. Latin uses intensifying prefixes or separate lexical items.

Paael Examples: Peal → Paael

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Paael (Syr)	Paael Translit	Paael Meaning
ܒܪܟܐ b-r-k	'kneel,	ܒܪܟܐ barre bless (Peal)'	ܟܒܪܟܐ k 'bless/prono	unce	'blessing'
ܩܕܝܫ q-d-š'	be holy	ܩܕܕܝܫ qadda (Peal)'	ܫܒܪܟܐ š 'sanctify/make	holyl'	
ܥܠܡܐ y-l-p	'learn	ܥܠܡܐ yalle (Peal)'	ܡܥܠܡܐ p 'teach (ma	ke	'learned)'
ܫܡܫܐ š-m-š	'serve	ܫܡܫܐ šamme (Peal)'	ܫܡܫܐ š 'minister/s	erve	'formally'
ܕܠܝܬܐ k-n-š	'gather	ܕܠܝܬܐ kanne (Peal)'	ܕܠܝܬܐ š 'assemble/col	lect'	

KEY INSIGHT: When the Paael is applied to an INTRANSITIVE verb (e.g., 'be holy'), it makes the action TRANSITIVE and FACTITIVE: 'make X holy / sanctify.' This is called the factitive use, and it is the Paael's most theologically important function. Compare Hebrew Piel kipper ('atone'), qiddēš ('sanctify'), bērak ('bless').

Comparison of the Three Major Stems

Syriac	Peal (basic)	Paael (intensive/factitive)	Aphel (causative)
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy')	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy')	—
b-r-k	berak ('kneel')	barrek ('bless intensively')	—
k-t-b	katab ('write')	katteb ('write carefully/copy') ('	'akteb dictate/cause to write')
y-l-p	yalep ('learn')	yallep ('teach — make 'al learned')	lep ('cause to learn')
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve')	šammeš ('minister formally')	—

SECTION 3: PAAEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: ‘to bless’

ברך Perfect — Full Conjugation (Root b-r-k)

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בָּרַךְ *barrek	* he bl	essed
3 f.sg.	בָּרְכָה *barreka	t* she b	lessed
2 m.sg.	בָּרַכְתָּ *barrek	t* you (m.sg	.) blessed
2 f.sg.	בָּרַכְתְּ *barrekt	i* you (f.sg	.) blessed
1 c.sg.	בָּרַכְתִּי *barreki	t* I bl	essed
3 m.pl.	בָּרְכוּ *barrek	ū* they (m.	) blessed
3 f.pl.	בָּרְכוּ *barrek	ī* they (f.	) blessed
2 m.pl.	בָּרַכְתֶּם *barrekit	ūn* you (m.pl	.) blessed
2 f.pl.	בָּרַכְתֶּם *barrekit	in* you (f.pl	.) blessed
1 c.pl.	בָּרַכְנוּ *barreki	n* we bl	essed

Formation Notes

- **Root:** b-r-k. In the Paael, R2 (resh, r) is geminated: b-rr-k → barrek
- **Perfect vowel pattern:** a under R1, doubled R2, e vowel between R2 and R3 (same as Peal CeCC but with geminate R2)
- **Suffix set:** Essentially identical to Peal and Aphel perfect suffixes
- **Guttural roots:** When R2 is a guttural (Ayin, Het, He, Alaph), gemination may be ‘virtual’ — compensatory lengthening of the preceding vowel occurs instead

Comparison: Hebrew Piel Perfect

The Hebrew Piel perfect is structurally near-identical to the Syriac Paael perfect. Compare:

Person	Hebrew (Piel)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בֵּרַךְ	bērāk	he blessed (Piel b-r-k)
3 f.sg.	בֵּרְכָה	bērēkāh	she blessed
1 c.sg.	בֵּרַכְתִּי	bēraktī	I blessed
3 m.pl.	בֵּרְכוּ	bērēkū	they blessed

SECTION 4: PAAEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: ‘one who blesses’

The Paael active participle takes the same m- prefix as all derived-stem participles. The gemination of R2 is preserved throughout.

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܐ *mbarre	k* blessing	(m.sg.)
f.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܬܐ *mbarrk	ā* blessing	(f.sg.)
m.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܝܢ *mbarrkī	n* blessing	(m.pl.)
f.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܬܝܢ *mbarrkā	n* blessing	(f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- (identical to Aphel participle prefix)
- **Vowel pattern:** m + a + R1R2R2 + e + R3 (preserves gemination of R2)
- **Suffixes:** Standard participle endings: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Piel participle: prefix נִ (mē-) + doubled R2. E.g., *mēbārēk* (blessing, from b-r-k Piel), *mēqaddēš* (sanctifying, from q-d-š Piel). Structurally identical to Syriac Paael participle.

Arabic Form II active participle: pattern muCaCCiC (mu + R1 + a + R2R2 + i + R3). E.g., *mu‘allim* (teacher, from ‘-l-m Form II), *muqaddis* (sanctifier, from q-d-s Form II). The m- prefix and gemination are pan-

Semitic features.

SECTION 5: WORSHIP AND RELIGIOUS VOCABULARY

Paael Verbs for Worship and Ministry

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Notes
ܒܪܟܝ barrek	Paael b-r-k	bless,	Cf. Heb Pie pronounce blessing	l bērak; Arabic bāraka
ܠܬ laṭ	Peal l-ṭ	curse	Antonym of ba	rrek; cf. Heb qillēl
ܫܠܝ šallī	Paael š-l-y	pray,	Cf. Heb hit intercede	pallēl; Arabic šallā
ܫܓܕ sgad	Peal s-g-d	bow down,	Cf. Arabic sa worship	jada; Heb hištaḥawāh
ܫܡܡܝܫ šammeš	Paael š-m-š	minister,	Liturgical se serve formally	rvice; cf. Hebrew šimmeš
ܝܠܦ yallep	Paael y-l-p	teach,	Factitive of instruct	‘learn’; cf. Arabic ‘allama
ܩܕܕܝܫ qaddaš	Paael q-d-š	sanctify,	Cf. Heb Piel make holy	qiddēš; Arabic qaddasa
ܫܒܚܫ šabbēh	Paael š-b-ḥ	praise,	Cf. Syriac glorify	šūbhā (glory); doxological use
ܩܒܠ qabbel	Paael q-b-l	receive,	Cf. Arabic qa accept (ritual)	bila; used for receiving sacraments
ܡܠܠ mallel	Paael m-l-l	speak,	Intensive of converse, preach	speech; cf. Heb millēl
ܕܩܕܕ dakkī	Paael d-k-y	purify,	Factitive cleanse	of ‘be pure’; cf. Heb Piel zikkāh
ܡܫܚܐ mašeḥ	Paael m-š-ḥ	anoint, smear	Root of m with oil	ēšīḥā (Messiah/Christ); cf. Heb māšaḥ
ܫܡ šam	Peal š-w-m	fast, abstain	Cf. Heb šûm	; Arabic šāma
ܚܓܓ ḥagag	Peal ḥ-g-g	feast,	Cf. Heb ḥāga celebrate	g; Arabic ḥajja

Nouns for Temple, Worship, and Religious Community

Estrangela	Translit	Meaning	Notes
ܡܕܒܚܐ madbhā	altar	From d-b-ḥ (	slaughter/sacrifice); cf. Heb mizbēah
ܟܗܢܐ kahnā	priest	Cf. Heb k	ōhēn; Arabic kāhin
ܗܝܟܠ hayklā	temple,	Cf. Heb h sanctuary	ēkāl (from Akkadian ēkallu); Gk naos
ܩܢܝܬܐ knūštā	synagogue,	From k-n-š (g assembly	ather); cf. Heb kēneset
ܩܘܪܒܢܐ qūrbānā	offering,	From q-r-b (	draw near/offer); cf. Heb qorbān (Mark 7:11)
ܒܫܡܐ besmā	incense, spic	e Cf. Heb b	ōšem; Arabic balsam
ܡܝܝܐ mayyā	water	Pl. form sta	ndard; cf. Heb mayim, Arabic mā
ܡܫܗܐ mešhā	oil, ointment	From m-š-ḥ (a	noint); root of Messiah
ܠܗܡܐ lahmā	bread, food	Cf. Heb le	hem (Bethlehem = bēt lehem); Arabic lahm
ܟܣܐ kāsā	cup	Cf. Heb	kôs; Gk potērion
ܢܡܘܨܐ nāmūsā	law, Torah	From Gk	nomos via Aramaic
ܫܠܬܐ šlūttā	prayer	Abstract no	un from š-l-y (Paael)
ܩܢܝܬܐ knūštā	assembly,	Also used for congregation	synagogue (same word)
ܩܘܕܢܐ pūqdānā	commandment,	From p-q-d (c decree	ommand); cf. Heb piqqūd
ܢܡܘܨܐ nāmūsā	law, rule	Dual use: T	orah and general law

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 6

Yukhannan Blesses the People and Angers the Priests

Narrative note: This passage is rich in Paael forms (barrek, ṣallī, šabbēh, yallep, qaddaš, šammeš). It also introduces the central conflict of the Acts: Yukhannan’s ministry challenges the established religious order. Notice the theological contrast between sacrifice (qūrbānā) and faith (haymānūttā).

Key Paael forms: *barrek* (blessed), *ṣallī* (prayed), *šabbēḥ* (praised), *yallep* (taught), *qaddaš* (sanctified), *šammeš* (minister), *šabbēḥ* (praised again at end). Note also *metqaddeš* — the *Ethpaael* (passive of Paael), previewing Lesson 7.

Sentence 1

וַיִּקְרָא יוֹחָנָן בְּרֵכָה לְעָם

w-Yukhannan qam ' al madbhā w-barrek l- ' ammā

w- (and-) *Yukhannan* (John) *qam* (stood) ' *al* (upon) *madbhā* (the-altar) *w-barrek* (and-blessed) *l- ' ammā* (the-people)

→ *And Yuxhannan stood at the altar and blessed the people.*

Sentence 2

וַיִּשְׁבַּח בְּקוֹל רָם וַיְבָרֵךְ אֱלֹהִים

w-ṣallī b- ' ednā rāmā w-šabbēḥ l-Alāhā

w-ṣallī (and-prayed) *b- ' ednā* (with-voice) *rāmā* (loud) *w-šabbēḥ* (and-praised) *l-Alāhā* (God)

→ *He prayed with a loud voice and praised God.*

Sentence 3

וַיְבָרֵךְ אֶת הָעָם בְּדֶרֶךְ הַתְּפִלָּה הַחֲדָשָׁה

w-yallep lhūn ' ūrhā ḥattā d-šlūttā

w-yallep (and-taught) *lhūn* (them) ' *ūrhā* (the-way) *ḥattā* (new) *d-šlūttā* (of-prayer)

→ *He taught them the new way of prayer.*

Sentence 4

וַיְבָרֵךְ אֶת הָעָם בְּרֵכָה לְעָם

w- ' emar: lā madbhā d-kahnūttā hū d-qaddaš ' enāš

w- 'emar (and-said) lā (not) madbhā (the-altar) d-kahnūtā (of-the-priesthood) hū (it-is) d-qaddaš (that-sanctifies) 'enāš (a-person)

→ *'It is not the altar of the priesthood that sanctifies a person.'*

Sentence 5

אלה מרענן אתכם ברוח קדשו
'ellā Māryā hū d-qaddaš lkūn b-rūḥeh

'ellā (but/rather) Māryā (the-Lord) hū (he-is) d-qaddaš (who-sanctifies) lkūn (you(pl.)) b-rūḥeh (by-his-Spirit)

'ellā (but/rather) Māryā (the-Lord) hū (he-is) d-qaddaš (who-sanctifies) lkūn (you(pl.)) b-rūḥeh (by-his-Spirit)

→ *'Rather, it is the Lord who sanctifies you by his Spirit.'*

Sentence 6

שמעו דין במלכותם, אלהיו חלמו
šme ' ū dēn kāhnē mellāw-hy w- 'etragzū 'lāw-hy

šme ' ū (heard) dēn (but/now) kāhnē (the-priests) mellāw-hy (his-words) w- 'etragzū (and-were-angered)

šme ' ū (heard) dēn (but/now) kāhnē (the-priests) mellāw-hy (his-words) w- 'etragzū (and-were-angered) 'lāw-hy (against-him)

→ *But the priests heard his words and were angered against him.*

Sentence 7

אמר להם מתיב לך שולטאנה דשמש בחיכלא
w- 'emrū: man yahab lāk šulṭānā d-šammeš b-hayklā?

w- 'emrū: man yahab lāk šulṭānā d-šammeš b-hayklā?

w- 'emrū (and-they-said) man (who) yahab (gave) lāk (to-you) šulṭānā (authority) d-šammeš (to-minister) b-hayklā (in-the-temple)

→ *'Who gave you authority to minister in the temple?'*

Sentence 8

הא אלהי אברהם, יצחק, ויעקב
'nā Yukhannan w- 'emar: Alāhā šedarnī d- 'qaddeš l- 'ammeh

'nā Yukhannan w- 'emar: Alāhā šedarnī d- 'qaddeš l- 'ammeh

‘ nā (answered) Yukhannan (Yukhannan) w- ’ emar (and-said) Alāhā (God) šedarnī (sent-me) d- ’ qaddeš (to-sanctify) l- ’ ammeh (his-people)

→ *Yukhannan answered: ‘God sent me to sanctify his people.’*

Sentence 9

לֹא בִּזְבָּחַן אֵלֶּא כִּי בִּיֵּאֵמָן מֵתְקַדֵּשׁ אִישׁ

lā b-qūrbānā ’ ellā b-haymānūttā metqaddeš ’ enāš

lā (not) *b-qūrbānā* (by-sacrifice) ’ *ellā* (but) *b-haymānūttā* (by-faith) *metqaddeš* (is-sanctified) ’ *enāš* (a-person)

→ *‘A person is not sanctified by sacrifice but by faith.’*

Sentence 10

וְרֵגַז רַב כֹּהֲנֵי וּפְקַד דְּנֻפְּקֻן לֵהּ מֵן הַיִּכְלָא

w-regaz rab kahnē w-pqad d-nuppqūn leh men hayklā

w-regaz (and-was-enraged) *rab* (chief) *kahnē* (of-priests) *w-pqad* (and-commanded) *d-nuppqūn* (that-they-expel) *leh* (him) *men* (from) *hayklā* (the-temple)

→ *And the chief priest was enraged and commanded that they expel him from the temple.*

Sentence 11

יֻכְחָנָן דֵּן לֹא דְּחֵל אֵלֶּא כִּי שַׁבְּבֵהּ לֵאלֹהִים בְּכֻלְּהּ לֵבְבֵהּ

Yukhannan dēn lā dḥel ’ ellā šabbeḥ l-Alāhā b-kulleh lebbeh

Yukhannan (Yukhannan) *dēn* (but/however) *lā* (not) *dḥel* (feared) ’ *ellā* (but) *šabbeḥ* (praised) *l-Alāhā* (God) *b-kulleh* (with-all) *lebbeh* (his-heart)

→ *But Yukhannan was not afraid; rather he praised God with all his heart.*

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification (Mixed: Peal, Paael, Aphel)

Identify each verb form: state the stem (Peal/Paael/Aphel), person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	ܒܪܝܟ	barrek
2	ܟܬܒ	katab
3	ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb
4	ܫܒܒܗ	šabbeḥ
5	ܐܗܝܝ	'aḥyī
6	ܡܒܪܟ	mbarrek
7	ܩܕܕܫ	qaddaš
8	ܡܠܥ	ma'lep
9	ܫܡܡܝܫ	šammeš
10	ܫܓܕ	sgad
11	ܫܠܝ	šallī
12	ܐܠܠܥ	'allep

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Paael verbs in the perfect (10 persons) and the participle (4 forms). Use Sections 3–4 as a model.

1. Root *š-b-ḥ* (*praise*) — Paael: *šabbeḥ*
2. Root *m-l-l* (*speak*) — Paael: *mallel*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences, all containing Paael verbs.

1. ܝܘܗܢܢܢ ܒܪܝܟ ܠܥܡܡܐ (*Yūḥannan barrek l- 'ammā*)
2. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܫܡܡܝܫ ܒܗܝܟܠܐ (*Kāhnā šammeš b-hayklā*)

3. חַיָּהּ קַדְדֵּשַׁת לִבְנָיָהּ (Hī qaddešat l-bnāy-hy)
4. מְבָרֵק עֲנָה לֵאלֹהֵי (Mbarrek 'enā l-Alāhā)
5. יַבְבְּחֻ לְמָרְיָהּ בְּכֻלּ יַוָּמָהּ (Šabbhū l-Māryā b-kull yawm)
6. אֲנִי יַלְלַפְתִּי לָאֵן נָאֻסָּה ('Ant yallapt lān nāmūsā)
7. דַּכְּכִי מַיְיָהּ לְמַא' מֻדִּיטָהּ (Dakkī mayyā l-ma' mūdittā)
8. מַן מְשַׁח בְּמֶשְׁחָהּ? (Man mšaḥ b-mešḥā?)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Pael)

Render these sentences into Syriac using the Pael stem.

1. The prophet blessed the offering.
2. They (m.) praised God with a loud voice.
3. The priest sanctified the assembly.
4. She prayed every day in the temple.
5. He anointed the king with oil.
6. We ministered to the Lord together.

Exercise 5: Peal vs. Pael Comparison

For each root pair below, explain how the Peal and Pael meanings differ, and give one example sentence using each.

Root	Peal Meaning	Pael Meaning
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy' Peal) qa	ddaš ('sanctify/make holy' Pael)
b-r-k	berak ('kneel/bless' Peal)	barrek ('bless solemnly' Pael)
y-l-p	yalep ('learn' Peal)	yallep ('teach, make learned' Pael)
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve' Peal) ša	mmeš ('minister formally' Pael)
d-k-y	dakī ('be pure' Peal)	dakkī ('purify, cleanse' Pael)

Exercise 6: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6, then answer the following questions.

1. What actions does Yuhannan perform at the altar? (List the Pael verbs.)
2. What does Yuhannan teach about the true source of sanctification?
3. How do the priests react, and why?
4. What authority does the chief priest invoke, and what does Yuhannan claim?
5. What does Yuhannan do after being threatened with expulsion? What does this tell us about his character?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

Q1: Aphel perf. 3 m.sg.: אָקֵרַב ('aqreb) = 'he brought near / offered'

Q2: Aphel active participle m.sg. of 'l-p (ma 'lep), 'teaching'

Q3: 'The Spirit revealed the truth.'

Q4: Hebrew Hiphil — e.g., hiqrīb (brought near, from q-r-b)

Q5: m.sg.: ma 'lep / f.sg.: ma 'lpā / m.pl.: ma 'lpīn / f.pl.: ma 'lpān

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Paael	3 m.sg.	b-r-k	he blessed
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
4	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-b-ḥ	he praised
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
6	Paael ptcp	m.sg.	b-r-k	blessing
7	Paael	3 m.sg.	q-d-š	he sanctified
8	Aphel ptcp	m.sg.	'-l-p	teaching (causative)
9	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-m-š	he ministered
10	Peal	3 m.sg.	s-g-d	he worshipped
11	Paael	3 m.sg.	ṣ-l-y	he prayed
12	Aphel	3 m.sg.	'-l-p	he taught (causative)

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	Yukhannan blessed the people.
2	The priest ministered in the temple.
3	She sanctified her children.
4	I am blessing God.
5	They praised the Lord every day.
6	You (m.sg.) taught us the law.
7	He purified the water for baptism.
8	Who anointed with oil?

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Nebīyā barrek l-qūrbānā*
2. *Šabbhū l-Alāhā b- 'ednā rāmā*
3. *Kāhnā qaddaš l-knūštā*
4. *šalleyyat b-kull yawm b-hayklā*
5. *Mšaḥ l-malkā b-mešḥā*
6. *Šammešnān l-Māryā ḥdāyīt*

Exercise 6: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	He blessed (barrek), prayed (šallī), praised (šabbēḥ), and taught (yallep).
2	Not the altar but the Lord, by his Spirit (b-rūḥeh).
3	They were angered (' etragzū) — he was bypassing priestly authority.
4	Priests claimed temple authority; Yukhannan claimed divine commission (šedarnī).
5	He praised God (šabbēḥ) — showing fearless devotion over fear of human authority.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PAAEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Formation feature	Pattern	Example (b-r-k)
Root consonant pattern	R1 + R2 DOUBLED + R3	b-rr-k
Perfect 3 m.sg.	CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	barrek
Participle m.sg.	m + CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	mbarrek
Participle suffixes	-ā, -īn, -ān	mbarrkā, mbarrkīn, mbarrkān
Core meaning	Intensive or Factitive	'bless solemnly'; 'sanctify = make holy'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + R2 DOUBLED = PAAEL (intensive/factitive) ‘to X’ → ‘to X thoroughly’ or ‘to make X happen / cause X state’ *q-d-š: be holy* → *qaddaš: sanctify* | *b-r-k: bless* → *barrek: bless solemnly* | *y-l-p: learn* → *yallep: teach*

Three-Stem Comparison Table

Stem	Meaning Type	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	‘he wrote’ / ‘writing’
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	barrek	mbarrek	‘he blessed’ / ‘blessing’
Aphel	Causative	’ allep	ma ’lep	‘he taught’ / ‘teaching’

Semitic Language Family Comparison

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Meaning	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative
Hebrew (cognate)	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic (cognate)	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Formation key	Basic vowels	R2 DOUBLED	’ a- prefix

FINAL REMINDER: All three stems — Peal, Paael, and Aphel — share the same suffix set for the perfect and the same m- prefix for the active participle. The stems are distinguished by: (1) Peal: basic vowels only; (2) Paael: R2 gemination; (3) Aphel: ’ a- prefix.

LOOKING AHEAD — Lesson 7: The *Ethpeel* and *Ethpaael* (reflexive/passive stems). You have already seen *metqaddeš* in this lesson’s story — that is the *Ethpaael* passive of *qaddaš*. Soon you will master the full passive system of Syriac.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 10 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
דִּינָא	dīnā	m	judgment
קִדְדָּשָׁא	qaddāšā	m	make holy
קִדְדְּשֻׁתָּא	qaddšūtā	f	holiness
פִּלְגָּא	palggā	m	divide
פִּלְגְּשֻׁתָּא	palgūtā	f	division
סַגְגָּד	saggad	m	worship
סַגְדְּשֻׁתָּא	saḡdūtā	f	worship
פַּרְצַפְּא	parzappā	m	interpreter
מַרְמָא	marmā	m	raise, exalt
תַּפְּפָּא	ṭappā	m	strike, beat

LESSON 7

Navigating Weak Roots: I-Alaph, I-Yodh, and III-Yodh verbs

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 5–6

Quick Summary

In Lessons 5 and 6, we expanded our vocabulary exponentially by learning how Semitic roots generate new meanings through derived stems. The **Aphel** stem (prefix *ʾa-*) generates causative verbs (e.g., God *ʾahyī* “gave life”). The **Paael** stem (doubled middle radical) generates intensive or factitive verbs (e.g., *qaddas* “he made holy”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. What stem does a verb belonging to the pattern *ʾaCCeC* belong to (e.g., *ʾaqreb*)?
 2. What consonant prefix marks the active participle of *all* derived stems (Aphel, Paael, etc.)?
 3. Translate: *Alāhā ʾaglī šrārā*.
 4. If *q-d-š* in Peal means “to be holy”, what does it mean in Paael (*qaddas*)?
 5. How would you recognize a Paael participle versus a Peal participle?
-

SECTION 2: THE WEAK VERB CHALLENGE — OVERVIEW

Until now, we have mostly dealt with “strong” roots (like *k-t-b* or *š-b-q*), where all three consonants boldly assert themselves in every conjugation. However, some of the most common verbs in human language—to say, to be, to know, to give, to come—are “weak”. This means one of their three root consonants is a “weak letter” (Alaph, Waw, or Yodh), which tends to assimilate, drop out entirely, or turn into a vowel depending on the surrounding sounds.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Weak Consonants

Weak verbs are the bane of every Semitic language student, but they follow highly predictable phonetic rules.

- **Hebrew:** I-Guttural (אָמַר *ʾāmar* = he said); I-Yod (יָדָע *yādaʿ* = he knew); Lamed-He/Yod (בָּנָה *bānāh* = he built).
 - **Arabic:** Hollow verbs (قَالَ *qāla* = he said); Defective/Final Weak (رَمَى *ramā* = he threw).
 - **Syriac:**
 - **I-Alaph:** Root *ʾ-m-r* (to say) → *ʾemar* (not *ʾamar*).
 - **I-Yodh:** Root *y-d-ʿ* (to know) → *īdaʿ* (Yodh acts like an *i* vowel).
 - **III-Yodh:** Root *ḥ-z-y* (to see) → *ḥzā* (the Yodh drops out, leaving an *ā* vowel).
-

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY OF WEAK ROOTS (PEAL PERFECT)

Despite the spelling changes, weak verbs function syntactically exactly like strong verbs: VSO word order, taking suffixes, and forming the spine of clauses.

1. I-Alaph Verbs (First consonant is Alaph)

The most famous is *ʾ-m-r* (“to say”). In the Peal perfect 3rd masc singular, the vowel shifts to *e*:

- *ʾemar* (he said), rather than *ʾamar*.
- *ʾemret* (I said), rather than *ʾamret*.

2. I-Yodh Verbs (First consonant is Yodh)

Very common verbs like *y-d-ʿ* (to know) and *y-t-b* (to sit). The initial *y* fuses with the preceding invisible glottal stop to form an *ī* vowel.

- *y-d-ʿ* → *īdaʿ* (he knew).
- *y-t-b* → *īteb* (he sat). *Note: The verb y-h-b (to give) is highly irregular and behaves like a strong verb without an internal vowel: yahb (he gave).*

3. III-Yodh Verbs (Third consonant is Yodh)

Verbs ending in Yodh (like *ḥ-z-y*, *b-n-y*, *ḥ-y-y*). The Yodh falls away in the 3rd masc singular, leaving a final *ā* vowel. In other persons, the Yodh can reappear as heavily vocalized endings.

- *ḥ-z-y* (to see) → *ḥzā* (he saw) [looks like a 2-consonant word].
- *ḥ-z-y* + *-et* (I saw) → *ḥzēt* (the *ay* contracts to *ē*).
- *ḥ-z-y* + *-ū* (They saw) → *ḥzaw* (the *ay-ū* contracts to *aw*).

SECTION 4: III-YODH PARADIGM (ROOT: Ḥ-Z-Y "TO SEE")

Because III-Yodh verbs lose their third consonant so frequently, memorizing their exact endings is essential.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION	NOTES
3 m.sg.	ܠܐ	ḥzā	he saw	Ends in <i>ā</i> (Alaph)
3 f.sg.	ܠܐܬ	ḥzāt	she saw	Ends in <i>āt</i>
2 m.sg.	ܠܐܬܐ	ḥzayt	you (m) saw	Yodh reappears, <i>ay</i> diphthong
2 f.sg.	ܠܐܬܐܝ	ḥzaytī	you (f) saw	Yodh reappears
1 c.sg.	ܠܐܬܝܬ	ḥzēt	I saw	Yodh contracts with <i>et</i> to <i>ēt</i>
3 m.pl.	ܠܐܘ	ḥzaw	they (m) saw	<i>w</i> makes <i>aw</i> diphthong
3 f.pl.	ܠܐܝܬܐ	ḥzay	they (f) saw	<i>y</i> makes <i>ay</i> diphthong
1 c.pl.	ܠܐܝܬܝܢ	ḥzayn	we saw	<i>ay</i> diphthong

SECTION 5: THE HIGHLY IRREGULAR VERBS ' -T-Y AND H-W-Y

Two of the most common verbs in Syriac are doubly weak and highly irregular.

1. ' -t-y (to come): I-Alaph AND III-Yodh.

- 3 m.s: 'etā (he came).
- 1 c.s: 'etēt (I came).
- 3 m.pl: 'etaw (they came).

2. h-w-y (to be/become): Used as an auxiliary verb, or to mean "it happened". III-Yodh.

- 3 m.s: hwā (he was / it happened).
- 1 c.s: hwēt (I was).
- 3 m.pl: hwaw (they were).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (WEAK VERBS & COURT TERMS)

ROOT	PEAL PERFECT 3M.S.	MEANING	CLASSIFICATION
א.מ.ר	'emar (אמר)	to say	I-Alaph
א.כ.ל	'ekal (אכל)	to eat	I-Alaph
א.ז.ל	'ezal (אזל)	to go	I-Alaph
י.ד.ע	īda' (ידע)	to know	I-Yodh
י.ש.ב	īteb (ישב)	to sit	I-Yodh
י.ת.ב	yahb (יתב)	to give	I-Yodh (Irregular)
י.ר.א	h̄zā (ירא)	to see	III-Yodh
ק.ר.א	qrā (קרא)	to call / read	III-Alaph (behaves like III-Yodh)
ב.נ.ה	bnā (בנה)	to build	III-Yodh
י.ח.י	h̄yā (יחי)	to live	III-Yodh
י.א.ח	'etā (אתא)	to come	I-Alaph & III-Yodh
י.ה.ו	hwā (יהו)	to be/become	III-Yodh
(Noun)	ר.ג.ז (rūgzā)	anger/wrath	Emotion abstract
(Noun)	ח.מ.צ.מ (hemzman)	word / report	Court term

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 7

The Summons

Narrative note: Pay attention to the massive use of weak roots— 'emar (said), 'ezal (went), īda' (knew), hwā (was/became), h̄zaw (they saw), 'etā (came).

Sentence 1

כאד 'emar Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā, 'ezalū qāšīšē l-wāt malkā. kad (when) 'emar (said) Yūḥannan (John) meltā (the-word) d-Alāhā (of-God), 'ezalū (went) qāšīšē (the-elders/guards) l-wāt (to-the-presence-of) malkā (the-king). → When Yukhannan said the word of God, the guards went to the king.

Sentence 2

אָמַרְיִן לֵיהּ יָאָד 'יֵן-הֵנָּן מָא הַוָּא ב־תַּר 'א! 'אָמַרְיִן (they-[are])-
saying) l-eh (to-him): yād 'īn (knowing) -h̄nan (are-we) mā (what) hwā (happened/was) b-tar 'ā (in-the-
gate)! → They say to him: “We know what happened at the gate!”

Sentence 3

הֲזַיִן גַּבְרָא, וְ- 'עֵמָר מֵלְתָא בִּישְׁתָּ. הֲזַיִן (we-saw) gabrā (a-man), w-
'emar (and-said) meltā (a-word) bīštā (evil-[f]). → “We saw a man, and he said an evil word.”

Sentence 4

הַוָּא הָשָׂא מַלְכָּא רַגִּיז תָּב. הַוָּא (became/was) hāšā (now) malkā (the-king)
ragīz (angry) ṭāb (greatly/very). → Now the king was very angry.

Sentence 5

אָמַרְיִן מַלְכָּא לְ-קַשִּׁישֵׁ: 'אֵיטָא-הֵי לְ-הַרְכָּא! 'עֵמָר (said) malkā
(the-king) l-qašīšē (to-the-guards): 'aytāw-hy (let-them-bring-him [Aphel imperative]) l-harkā (to-here)!
→ The king said to the guards: “Bring him here!”

Sentence 6

וְ- 'עָתָא יוֹחָנָן קְדָמַּ מַלְכָּא. וְ- 'עָתָא (and-came) Yūḥannan (John) qdām
(before) malkā (the-king). → And Yukhannan came before the king.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Weak Root Identification

Identify the root and grammatical form of these weak verbs:

1. הֲזַיִן (h̄zēt)
2. אָמַרְיִן ('emarū)
3. אָמַרְיִן ('etā)
4. אָמַרְיִן (yahbū)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Conjugate the root ʾ-*m-r* (to say) in the Peal perfect for:

1. I said
2. We said
3. You (m.sg) said
4. They (m.pl) said

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following past narrative clauses involving weak verbs.

1. ʾEmarū qaššē meltā.
2. Ḥzayn nūhrā d-Alāhā b-tar ʿ ā.
3. W-īda ʿ malkā rūgzā (wrath).
4. Hwaw b- ʾ ar ʿ ā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following narrative sentences into Syriac transliteration. (Remember VSO order).

1. The evil king saw (ḥzā) the man.
2. We came (ʾ etayn) to the kingdom.
3. I gave (yahbet) the garment to the guard (*qaššā*).
4. John knew (*īda* ʿ) the word of God.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. Who did the guards go to?
2. What do the guards claim they saw and heard?
3. How did the king react to the news?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. Aphel. (Causative).
2. *Mīm* (m-). e.g., *ma 'lep, mqaddeš*.
3. God revealed the truth.
4. To make holy / to sanctify.
5. The vowel pattern: *mqaddeš* (Paael) vs *kāteb* (Peal). The Peal has no *m*- prefix in the active participle.

Exercise 1: Weak Root Identification

1. Root: *ḥ-z-y*. Form: Peal perfect, 1 c.sg (I saw).
2. Root: *'-m-r*. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.pl (They said).
3. Root: *'-t-y*. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.sg (He came).
4. Root: *y-h-b*. Form: Peal perfect, 3 m.pl (They gave).

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. *'emret*
2. *'emarn*
3. *'emart*
4. *'emarū*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. The guards said a word.
2. We saw the light of God in the gate.
3. And the king knew wrath.
4. They were in the earth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. *Ḥzā malkā bīšā l-gabrā*. (*l-* marks direct object).
2. *'Etain l-malkūtā*.
3. *Yahbet lbūšā l-qašīšā*.
4. *Īda ' Yūḥannan meltā d-Alāhā*.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. To the king.
2. A man who said an evil word.
3. He became very angry (*ragīz ṭāb*) and demanded the man be brought to him.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

WEAK VERB SHIFT SUMMARY

CLASS	ROOT	SHIFT RULE	3 M.SG EXAMPLE	1 C.SG EXAMPLE
I-Alaph	'-m-r	First vowel becomes <i>e</i>	'emar (he said)	'emret (I said)
I-Yodh	y-d-'	Initial Yodh + stop → <i>ī</i>	īda' (he knew)	īd'et (I knew)
III-Yodh	ḥ-z-y	Yodh drops, ends in <i>ā</i> in 3ms	ḥzā (he saw)	ḥzēt (I saw)
Double Weak	'-t-y	Follows both rules	'etā (he came)	'etēt (I came)

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on

derived nouns (abstract and concrete) from weak roots and related weak-root vocabulary.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING	NOTES
አሳህጉ	ḥadāyūttā	f. noun	oneness, unity	from root ḥ-d-y
አሳህጉ	dāmūttā	f. noun	likeness, image	from root d-m-y (to be like)
አሳህ	ḥezwā	m. noun	vision, sight	from III-Yodh root ḥ-z-y
አሳህ	benyānā	m. noun	building, structure	from III-Yodh root b-n-y
አሳህ	masqəṭā	f. noun	ascent, exaltation	from root s-l-q
አሳህ	qərūttā	f. noun	calling, vocation	from III-Alaph/Yodh root q-r-ʾ
አሳህ	ʾawdərānā	m. noun	help, aid	from root ʾ-d-r
አሳህ	yāzəpā	m. noun	beauty, loan	from root y-z-p
አሳህ	mawḥabtā	f. noun	gift, offering	from I-Yodh root y-h-b
አሳህ	meʾtūttā	f. noun	coming, arrival	from weak root ʾ-t-y
አሳህ	hewyā	m. noun	being, existence	from III-Yodh root h-w-y
አሳህ	ʾālmā	m. noun	world, eternity	from root ʾ-l-m
አሳህ	dūqā	m. noun	observation, look-out	from weak root d-w-q
አሳህ	gūrā	m. noun	dwelling, cave	from weak root g-w-r
አሳህ	tūpsā	m. noun	pattern, type	loanword/concept
አሳህ	qūmā	m. noun	standing, height	from root q-y-m
አሳህ	nḥīyā	m. noun	prophet	from root n-b-ʾ
አሳህ	ʾūšnā	m. noun	strength, power	from root ʾ-š-n

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING	NOTES
ሩሐገጢ	sāhdüttā	f. noun	testimony, witness	from root s-h-d
ሩወገ	rawmā	m. noun	highness, height	from weak root r-w-m
ሩዕ	qarā	m. noun	cold	from weak root q-r-
ሩህ	ḥelmā	m. noun	dream	from weak root ḥ-l-m
ሩገ	dayšā	m. noun	trampling, treading	from weak root d-w-š
ሩህህ	yaleltā	f. noun	lamenting, wailing	from root y-l-l
ሩዕፍ	pūrā	m. noun	winepress, fruit	from weak root p-w-r
ሩዕረ	'esūrā	m. noun	bond, chain	from root ' -s-r
ሩሂ	šelyā	m. noun	quiet, peace	from weak root š-l-y
ሩሐ	'ātā	f. noun	sign, omen	from root ' -t-y
ሩህ	nyāḥā	m. noun	rest, tranquility	from weak root n-w-ḥ
ሩሐጢ	behttā	f. noun	shame, disgrace	from root b-h-t

LESSON 8

The Subjunctive Future: The Imperfect Tense

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 7

Quick Summary

In Lesson 7, we tackled “weak roots”—verbs that contain an Alaph (ܐ) or Yodh (ܝ). We saw that while they can lose or transform their weak consonants in conjugation (e.g., ܡܪܝܢܐ → ܡܪܝܢܐ; ܝܠܕܝܢܐ → ܝܠܕܝܢܐ), they still behave syntactically like normal verbs.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. What does the Yodh in a III-Yodh verb turn into in the 3rd masc singular perfect (e.g., ܝܠܕܝܢܐ)?
 2. Translate: ܡܪܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
 3. Identify the root of ܝܕܐ (he knew).
 4. Translate: ܐܝܬܐܝܠܝܗ (bring him!). Why is the suffix -ܝܠܝܢܐ used instead of -ܝܠܝܢܐ?
 5. How would you say “I saw” (1 c.sg. of ܝܠܕܝܢܐ)?
-

SECTION 2: THE SEMITIC PREFIX CONJUGATION — OVERVIEW

We have learned that the Participle handles the *Present* (ongoing action) and the *Perfect* (Suffix Conjugation) handles the *Past* (completed action).

How does Syriac talk about the Future or expressing wishes/commands? It uses the **Imperfect Tense**, often called the “Prefix Conjugation.”

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: The Imperfect

In all Semitic languages, the Imperfect adds prefixes (ܢ-, ܬ-, ܝ-, ܝܬ-, etc.) to the root to indicate the person, while suffixes are used to indicate plural number.

- **Hebrew Qal Imperfect:** ܝܬܬܝܒ (yiktōb — he will write), ܝܬܬܝܒ (ektōb — I will write).
- **Arabic Form I Imperfect:** ܝܬܬܝܒ (yaktubu — he writes/will write), ܝܬܬܝܒ (aktubu — I write).

- **Syriac Peal Imperfect:** ܠܝܬܘܒ (*nektūb* — he will write), ܠܝܬܘܒܐ (*'ektūb* — I will write).

Crucial Note on Syriac vs. Hebrew/Arabic: In Hebrew and Arabic, the 3rd person masculine prefix is **y-** (*ya-* or *yi-*). In standard Syriac, the 3rd person prefix shifted to **n-** (*ne-*).

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY AND SYNTAX OF THE IMPERFECT

1. Forming the Peal Imperfect

For a strong root like *k-t-b*, the base vocalization of the imperfect shifts to an *ū* (Waw) theme vowel between the second and third consonant: *-ktūb*. We then add the person-marking prefixes:

- *n-* (He / They m) → *n-ek-tūb* → **nektūb** (He will write).
- *t-* (You / She / They f) → **tektūb** (You will write / She will write).
- *'-* (I) → **'ektūb** (I will write).

2. Syntax: The Simple Future

By itself, the Imperfect functions as a simple future tense.

- *Nektūb Yūḥannan meltā.* (Yukhannan will write a word).
- *Tehze tammān malkā.* (You will see a king there).

3. Syntax: The Subjunctive / Purpose (**d-** + Imperfect)

Syriac uses the Imperfect heavily for purpose clauses, wishes, and commands. It accomplishes this by attaching the relative particle **d-** directly to the Imperfect verb. This corresponds to the Greek subjunctive with ἵνα (*hina*).

- *'Etā d-nehze* = He came **in order that he might see**.
- *'Āmer-nā d-tektūb* = I say **that you should write**.

SECTION 4: IMPERFECT TENSE PARADIGMS (PEAL, PAAEL, APHEL)

1. The Peal Imperfect Conjugation (Root **q-ṭ-l**)

In the Peal, the prefix has an *e* vowel in modern pronunciation (or *i* historically), and the theme vowel is usually *ū* (or *a* for gutturals).

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION	PREFIX	SUFFIX
3 m.sg.	ܢܥܬܘܠ	neqtūl	he will kill	n-	(none)
3 f.sg.	ܬܥܬܘܠ	teqtūl	she will kill	t-	(none)
2 m.sg.	ܬܥܬܘܠ	teqtūl	you (m) will kill	t-	(none)
2 f.sg.	ܬܥܬܝܢ	teqtlīn	you (f) will kill	t-	-īn
1 c.sg.	ܐܥܬܘܠ	'eqtūl	I will kill	' -	(none)
3 m.pl.	ܢܥܬܠܘܢ	neqtlūn	they (m) will kill	n-	-ūn
3 f.pl.	ܬܥܬܠܢ	neqtlān	they (f) will kill	n-	-ān
1 c.pl.	ܐܥܬܘܠ	neqtūl	we will kill	n-	(none)

Warning: The forms for “He will kill” (neqtūl) and “We will kill” (neqtūl) are identical in spelling and pronunciation! Context almost always makes it obvious.

2. The Pael Imperfect (Root **q-d-š** , to sanctify)

In the Pael the prefix has only a reduced vowel (*nqaddeš*), and the middle root letter is doubled.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
3 m.sg.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫ	nqaddeš	he will sanctify
1 c.sg.	ܐܩܕܕܝܫ	'qaddeš	I will sanctify
3 m.pl.	ܢܩܕܕܝܫܘܢ	nqaddšūn	they will sanctify
1 c.pl.	ܐܩܕܕܝܫ	nqaddeš	we will sanctify

3. The Aphel Imperfect (Root **n-p-q** , Aphel = **'appeq** to bring out)

In the Aphel, the original 'a- prefix of the perfect drops out, and the imperfect prefix takes its place with an *a* vowel. The theme vowel is *e*.

PERSON	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
3 m.sg.	ⲙⲁⲩ	nappeq	he will bring out
1 c.sg.	ⲙⲁⲩⲉ	'appeq	I will bring out
3 m.pl.	ⲙⲁⲩⲉⲙ	nappqūn	they will bring out

SECTION 5: THE SUBJUNCTIVE FLOW

Observe how the purpose clause flows in translation:

PRIMARY ACTION (PAST/PRESENT)	SUBJUNCTIVE CLAUSE (D- + IMPERFECT)	TRANSLATION
'Etā malkā (The king came)	d-neqṭūl l-eh (that he might kill him)	The king came in order to kill him.
Yūḥannan 'ābed nūhrā (Yukhannan makes light)	d-neḥzūn 'ammā (that the people might see)	Yukhannan makes light so that the people will see.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (TIME, JUDGMENT & ROYAL COURT)

ROOT/NOUN	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING	RELATED CONCEPT
זכר / זמן	zban / zabnā	time	Temporal boundary
דמא	‘ damā	until	Used with <i>d-</i> (until that)
דין / דין	dīn / dīnā	judgment, law	Eschatological judgment
עלם / עולם	‘ ālam / ‘ ālmā	world, eternity	Often <i>l-</i> ‘ ālam (forever)
יום / יומא	yūm / yūmā	day	Heb. <i>yōm</i>
ש.מ.ד	sehed (Peal)	to testify/witness	Court setting
גזר	gzar (Peal)	to decree/cut	Royal authority
י.ה.ב	īteb (Peal)	to sit/enthronement	enthronement
ס.פ.ל	qṭal (Peal)	to kill	execution context
דחל / דחל	dḥal / deḥlā	fear/reverence	Root <i>d-ḥ-l</i> (to fear)
דן	dān (Peal, Hollow)	to judge	Active verb of <i>dīnā</i>

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 8

The Threat

Narrative note: The king uses the Subjunctive/Imperfect to express his threats and purpose concerning Yūkhannan's future.

Sentence 1

qām Yūḥannan qdām malkā d-dīnā. qām (stood) Yūḥannan (John) qdām (before) malkā (the-king) d-dīnā (of-judgment). → Yūkhannan stood before the king of judgment.

Sentence 2

w-īteb malkā w- 'emar l-ēh: w-īteb (and-sat) malkā (the-king) w- 'emar (and-said) l-ēh (to-him): → And the king sat and said to him:

Sentence 3

Sentence 4

Sentence 5

Sentence 6

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

1. נֶקְטֹּב (nektüb)
2. תֵּשֶׁבֶקֻּן (tešbqūn)
3. נֶבְדָּן (ne^ʿ bdān)
4. עֶזְזָה (ʿehzē — root h-z-y)

1. He will kill

2. We will kill
3. I will kill
4. They (m) will kill

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following future or subjunctive clauses.

1. Npaq malkā d-neḥzē l-Yūḥannan. (Remember ḥ-z-y acts weak).
2. Lā neqṭūl malkā l-gabrā ṭābā.
3. Tešbqūn l-baytkūn l- ʿ ālam.
4. Ktabt meltā d-yād ʿ īn ḥnan šrārā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration using the Imperfect.

1. I will write the decree (*gzar*) in the day of judgment.
2. The king decreed (*gzar*, perfect) that he might kill the men (*gabrē*).
3. If you (m.sg) do not leave heaven, you will see God.
4. They (m.pl) will come to the kingdom. (Hint: *nēthūn* from ʿ -t-y).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. What does the king threaten to do to Yukhannan?
2. What is the condition the king sets?
3. What is Yukhannan's stated purpose for coming to the world?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. It becomes a long ʿ Alaph (ā). Example: ḥzā.
2. The king said.
3. y-d- ʿ (to know). I-Yodh.

4. Because the suffix is attaching to a vowel-ending word (the Aphel imperative *ʾaytāw*).
5. *ḥzēt* (I saw).

Exercise 1: Imperfect Identification

1. 3.m.sg or 1.c.pl (He will write / We will write)
2. 2.m.pl (You all will leave)
3. 3.f.pl (They [feminine] will do)
4. 1.c.sg (I will see)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. neqṭūl
2. neqṭūl
3. ʾeqṭūl
4. neqṭlūn

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. The king went out in order to see Yukhannan.
2. The king will not kill the good man.
3. You all will leave your house forever.
4. You wrote a word so that we might know the truth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. ʾEktūb gzar b-yūm dīnā.
2. Gzar malkā d-neqṭūl l-gabrē.
3. ʾEn lā tešbūq šmayyā, teḥzē l-Alāhā.
4. Nēthūn l-malkūttā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. To kill him in the day of judgment.
2. If Yukhannan does not leave his land (“my land”).
3. To say/speak the word of God to the world.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PEAL IMPERFECT (Root q-t-l)

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT
3 m.sg.	ܩܬܠܐ	neqtūl (he will kill)
3 f.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܐ	teqtūl (she will kill)
2 m.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܝܐ	teqtūl (you will kill)
1 c.sg.	ܩܬܠܝܐ	'eqtūl (I will kill)
3 m.pl.	ܩܬܠܘܐ	neqtlūn (they will k.)
1 c.pl.	ܩܬܠܡܐ	neqtūl (we will kill)

SYNTAX OF PURPOSE

Verb 1 (Any Tense) + **d-** + Verb 2 (Imperfect) = Purpose Clause 'Ezal (*He went*) *d-ne 'bed* (*in order to do*) *qyāmā* (*a covenant*).

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 20 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
𐤀𐤔𐤕	pāraḥtā	f	bird
𐤀𐤔𐤕𐤕	ḥadūtā	f	joy
𐤀𐤔𐤕𐤕	ḥekmtā	f	wisdom
𐤀𐤔𐤕𐤕	ḥayyūtā	f	animal, beast
𐤀𐤔𐤕	pīrā	m	fruit
𐤀𐤔𐤕	kalbā	m	dog
𐤀𐤔𐤕	‘erbā	m	sheep
𐤀𐤔𐤕	ṭūrā	m	mountain
𐤀𐤔𐤕	šūqā	m	street, market
𐤀𐤔𐤕	‘āqtā	f	distress, anguish
𐤀𐤔𐤕	nūrā	f	fire
𐤀𐤔𐤕	raḥmē	m.pl	mercy
𐤀𐤔𐤕𐤕	meḥartā	f	tomorrow
𐤀𐤔𐤕	zannā	m	time, era
𐤀𐤔𐤕	rešā	m	head (leadership)
𐤀𐤔𐤕	’in	conj	if
𐤀𐤔𐤕	’ōlyā	adv	perhaps
𐤀𐤔𐤕𐤕	p ’āltā	f	trust, confidence
𐤀𐤔𐤕	deḥlā	m	fear
𐤀𐤔𐤕	yed ’ ā	m	knowledge

LESSON 9

Commands and Intentions

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–8

Before diving into new material, take a moment to consolidate what you have learned so far. Lessons 1–8 have introduced you to the following foundational topics:

- **Lesson 0:** The Estrangela alphabet
- **Lesson 1:** Noun states, independent pronouns, verbless clauses, and the particles *d-* and *l-*
- **Lesson 2:** The Peal active participle with enclitic pronouns (the narrative present)
- **Lesson 3:** The Peal perfect (*qṭal*) — all persons and numbers; V-S-O word order
- **Lesson 4:** Pronominal suffixes on nouns and prepositions; *ʾit l-* (“to have”)
- **Lesson 5:** The Aphel stem — causation
- **Lesson 6:** The Paael stem — intensive and factitive meaning
- **Lesson 7:** Weak roots: I-Alaph, I-Yodh, and III-Yodh verbs
- **Lesson 8:** The Peal imperfect (*neqṭol*): the future, and *d-* + imperfect for purpose

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer each question from memory before checking against your notes. Write your answer in full Syriac script with transliteration.

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	What is the Peal perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>k-t-b</i> (write)?	<i>ktab</i> — he wrote	ܠܝܬܒ
2	What is the Peal imperfect 3 m.sg. of <i>š-m-ʿ</i> (hear)?	<i>nešmaʿ</i> — he will hear	ܬܫܡܥ
3	How do you say “the king commanded” (<i>p-q-d</i> , 3 m.sg. perfect)?	<i>pqad malkā</i> — the king commanded	ܩܕܡܠܟܐ
4	What does the Paael stem add to the root’s meaning?	Intensity, repetition, or a denominative meaning	—
5	Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>n-p-q</i> (go out).	<i>ʿappeq</i> — he brought out / caused to go out	ܥܦܩ

SECTION 2: THE IMPERATIVE

2.1 What Is the Imperative?

The imperative is the grammatical form used to issue **direct commands** or requests addressed to a second person (“you”). In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the imperative exists only in the second person — singular and plural, masculine and feminine. There is no first-person or third-person imperative; those ideas are expressed by other means (the cohortative and the jussive).

The **formation** of the Peal imperative follows a straightforward rule: take the **imperfect form**, strip away the **t-** prefix of the 2nd person, and you have the imperative. The vowel pattern is then **CCoC** for the masculine singular (e.g., *ktob* “write!”). This parallels the Hebrew Qal imperative (כתוב *ktōv*) and the Arabic imperative (اكتب *uktub*), though the exact vowel patterns differ.

2.2 Peal Imperative — Formation

Masculine Singular: **CCoC** — the simplest form, the bare root with the characteristic o-vowel. E.g., **ktob** ܠܝܬܒ “Write! (to one man)”

Feminine Singular: **CCoC + -ī** — add the feminine marker *ī*. E.g., **ktobī** ܠܝܬܒܝ “Write! (to one woman)”

Masculine Plural: *CCoC + -w* — add the masculine plural ending. E.g., **ktobw** כתוב “Write! (to a group of men)”

Feminine Plural: *CCoC + -ān* — add the feminine plural ending. E.g., **ktobān** כתוב “Write! (to a group of women)”

2.3 Complete Paradigm Tables

Root k-t-b כתב (write)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg (m. sg.)	כתוב ktob	Write! (to on	e man)
2fsg (f. sg.)	כתובי ktobī	Write! (to on	e woman)
2mpl (m. pl.)	כתובו ktobw	Write! (to a	group of men)
2fpl (f. pl.)	כתובנה ktobān	Write! (to a	group of women)

Root š-m-‘ שמע (hear)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg	שמע šma ‘	Hear! (to one	man)
2fsg	שמעי šma ‘ ī	Hear! (to one	woman)
2mpl	שמעו šma ‘ w	Hear! (to a g	roup of men)
2fpl	שמענה šma ‘ ān	Hear! (to a g	roup of women)

2.4 Derived Stems: Pael and Aphel Imperatives

Pael Imperative: The Pael intensifies or extends the root meaning. Its imperative is built from the Pael imperfect. The form is **mCaCC-e** (msg) — note the characteristic doubled middle radical. E.g., **bārek** בָּרַךְ “Bless! / Praise!”; **’allep** אָלַץ “Teach!”

Aphel Imperative: The Aphel is causative. Its imperative begins with **’a-**. E.g., **’appaq** אֶפְקֹ “Bring out!”; **’ahwī** אֶהַרְוֵ “Show!”

2.5 Negative Commands

Key Rule: Negating Commands

In Syriac, negative commands (prohibitions) are NOT formed with the imperative.

Instead, use: lā + IMPERFECT (2nd person).

This is identical to Biblical Hebrew (לֹא + jussive / יִצַּח + imperfect) and Arabic (لا + mudāri‘).

Example: lā tektob ܠܐ ܬܬܝܒ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not write!” (lit. “you-shall-not write”)

Example: lā tešma‘ ܠܐ ܬܫܡܥ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not listen!”

2.6 Cross-Linguistic Comparison

Students coming from different language backgrounds will find useful parallels:

LANGUAGE	FORM (WRITE!)	FORM (HEAR!)	NEGATIVE	NOTES
Syriac	ktob ܬܬܝܒ	šma‘ ܬܫܡܥ	lā + imperfect	2nd person only; 4 forms (g/n)
Hebrew	ktōv כָּתוּב	šma‘ שְׁמַע	לֹא + jussive	Similar 4-form paradigm
Arabic	uktub اكتب	isma‘ اسمع	لا + imperfect	Form I imperative derived from imperfect
Greek	γράφε / γράψον	ἄκουε / ἄκουσον	μή + subjunctive	Pres./Aor. distinction; no gender
Latin	scribe	audi	noli + infinitive	4th conjugation; no gender marking

2.7 Example Commands with Interlinear Gloss

Study each command carefully. The word-by-word gloss is given directly below the Syriac.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܕܠܝܬܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ * ܕܠܝܬܐ	ktob šmeh d-malkā* w of-the.king	rite! name-his W the king!	rite the name of
ܫܡܐ * ܩܠܝܬܐ	šma' qālī* h	ear! voice-my H	ear my voice!
ܐܝܢܐ * ܕܥܡܪܐ	haww yāq' īn* b	e-pl. knowing K [m.pl.]	now (be knowing)!
ܠܐ ܬܕܗܠ * ܢ	lā tedḥal* n	ot you-fear D	o not be afraid!
ܐܠܝܐ * ܕܥܡܪܐ	'ezlaw w-emraw* g say-pl.!	o-pl.! and G [m.pl.]	o and tell!
ܐܬܬܐ * ܕܥܡܪܐ	'aḥwāynī 'attā* s	how-me! sign S	how me a sign!

SECTION 3: THE INFINITIVE (VERBAL NOUN / MAŠDAR)

3.1 The Nature of the Syriac Infinitive

Syriac, like Arabic and Hebrew, possesses a **verbal noun** — a noun derived from the verb root that expresses the action in abstract form. In Arabic this is called the **mašdar** (مصدر, “source”). In Hebrew it corresponds to the **infinitive construct**. In Syriac it functions similarly and is often called the **infinitive** in grammars. It can serve as the subject of a sentence, the object of a verb, or — most commonly in narrative — as a **complementary infinitive** after a modal or semi-modal verb, introduced by the preposition ܠ- (“to”).

3.2 Infinitive Formation by Stem

Peal Infinitive: meCCaC pattern. Insert me- prefix and reduce the stem. E.g., k-t-b → **mektab** ܡܟܬܒ ‘the writing / to write’. Root š-m-‘ → **mešma** ܡܫܡܐ ‘the hearing’.

Paael Infinitive: mCaCCāCū — m- prefix, doubled middle radical, ā before the last radical, final ū. E.g., barrek (bless, Paael) → **mbarrākū** ܡܒܪܪܐܟܘܬܐ ‘the blessing’.

Aphel Infinitive: maCCāCū — ma- prefix with ā-vowel before final radical + ū. E.g., ‘appeq (bring out, Aphel) → **mappāqū** ܡܦܩܘܬܐ ‘to bring out’.

3.3 Infinitive Forms — Five Key Verbs

ROOT	MEANING	PEAL INF.	PAAEL INF.	APHEL INF.
k-t-b	write mektab כתב	mkatābū כתבו	'aktābū כתבו	
š-m-ʿ	hear mešma שמע	mšamā' ū שמוע	'ašmā' ū שמוע	
q-ṭ-l	kill meqṭal חמץ	mqaṭālū חמץ	'aqṭālū חמץ	
p-q-d	command mepqad מצוה	mpaqādū מצוה	'apqādū מצוה	
y-d-ʿ	know mīda ידע	myādā' ū ידע	'awdā' ū ידע	

3.4 The Critical Construction: l- + Infinitive

The l- + Infinitive Construction

PATTERN: MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE

This construction expresses purpose or complement: 'he began to write', 'she is able to hear'.

The preposition l- is prefixed directly to the infinitive with no space.

Compare: Greek + infinitive (γράφειν); Latin accusative + infinitive (scribere); Arabic أن + imperfect.

In Hebrew the parallel is the lamed + infinitive construct: לכתוב (liktōv).

Eight Example Sentences with 1- + Infinitive:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܫܪܝܠܡܟܬܒ * ܒ	šarī l-mektab* b	egan to.write H	e began to write.
ܝܐܩܠܠܡܫܡܐ * ܝ	yākel l-mešma ' * i	s.able to.hear H	e is able to hear.
ܒܐܝܠܡܡܐ * ܠܡܝܠܐ	bā ' ē l-me ' zal* w	ants to.go H	e wants to go.
ܫܒܐܠܡܥܩܬܐ * ܠܡܡܝܠܐ	šābē l-meqṭal* w	ishes to.kill H	e wishes to kill.
ܦܩܕܠܡܥܝܪܐ * ܬܝܠܝܕ	paqed l-me ' sar* c to.bind	ommanded H to bind.	e commanded (them)
ܫܕܪܠܡܥܒܕܐ * ܬܝܠܝܕ	šadar l-me ' bad* s	ent to.do/make H act.	e sent (them) to
ܠܐܝܩܠܠܡܥܝܪܐ * ܠܡܝܠܐ	lā yākel l-me ' zal* n to.go	ot is.able H go.	e is not able to
ܫܪܝܬܠܡܥܩܪܐ * ܡܠܬܐܝܬܝܠܥܪܐ	šarīt l-meqrā maltā* y to.read	ou.began Y the word. word.the	ou began to read

SECTION 4: VERBS OF BEGINNING, ABILITY, AND DESIRE

4.1 Semi-Modal Verbs

These verbs function like **modal auxiliaries** in English and govern an infinitive complement introduced by l-. They are extremely common in Syriac narrative. Master these verbs and their paradigms, as they appear repeatedly in the Acts of Mar Yukhannan.

š-r-y, 𐰽𐰺 — begin

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šarī, שָׁרִי

Example: שָׂרִי לִמְכַתֵּב, *šarī l-mektab* — He began to write.

Note: Very common in narrative openings. Note final yod (weak root š-r-y).

y-k-l **حَدَّثَ** — be able / can

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: yākel **حَدَّ**

Example: يَاكُلُ الْمِيتَةَ *yākel l-meqtal* — He is able to kill.

Note: The Syriac equivalent of Greek δύναμι, Latin possum. Often negated: lā yākel.

b-ʿ -y ܒܥ — want / seek / ask

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: bāʿ ē ܒܥ

Example: ܒܥ ܠܡܥܠ ܒܐ ܥܠܡܐ ܒܐ ܥܠܡܐ *bāʿ ē l-meʿzal* — He wants to go.

Note: Can also mean ‘ask’ or ‘pray’. Third-aleph weak root.

ṣ-b-y ܒܥܝ — wish / will / be pleased

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: ṣābē ܒܥܝ

Example: ܒܥܝ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܐܒܝ ܐܒܝ *ṣābē l-meqṭal* — He wishes to kill.

Note: Related noun ṣebyānā (will/wish) is key theological vocabulary.

p-q-d ܦܩܕ — command / order

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: paqed ܦܩܕ

Example: ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥܬܐ *paqed l-meʿsar* — He commanded to bind (him).

Note: Often takes a direct object (the recipient of the order) + l- + infinitive.

š-d-r ܫܕܪ — send

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šadar ܫܕܪ

Example: ܫܕܪ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܫܕܪ ܠܡܥܬܐ *šadar ʿenāšē l-meqṭal* — He sent men to kill.

Note: The l-+infinitive here expresses purpose: ‘sent in order to kill’.

SECTION 5: MILITARY AND EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS

This vocabulary set is essential for the narrative of Lesson 9. Many of these words appear in the story and

exercises. Learn both the verbal root and its noun/adjective derivatives.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>m-ḥ-y</i>	ܡܚܝ <i>mḥā / nemḥē</i>	strike, smite	, hit
<i>d-ḥ-l</i>	ܕܚܠ <i>*dḥel / nedḥa</i>	l* fear, be afra	id
<i>ḥ-d-y</i>	ܚܕܝ <i>ḥdī / neḥdē</i>	rejoice, be g	lad
<i>’-s-r</i>	ܐܣܪ <i>*’asar / ne’ s</i>	or* bind, tie, im	prison
<i>š-r-y</i>	ܫܪܝ <i>šrā / nešrē</i>	loosen, relea	se, begin
<i>r-m-y</i>	ܪܡܝ <i>rmā / nerme</i>	throw, cast	
<i>’-ḥ-d</i>	ܚܕ <i>*’ḥad / ne’ ḥo</i>	d* seize, grab,	take hold
<i>g-r-r</i>	ܓܪܪ <i>*grār / negro</i>	r* drag, pull	
<i>’-r-q</i>	ܪܩ <i>*’raq / ne’ ro</i>	q* flee, escape	
<i>r-d-p</i>	ܪܕܦ <i>*rdap / nerdo</i>	p* pursue, chase	, persecute
<i>q-ṭ-l</i>	ܩܬܠ <i>*qṭal / neqṭo</i>	l* kill, slay	
<i>p-ṣ-’</i>	ܦܨܐ <i>*pṣā’ / nepsa</i>	’ * wound, injure	
<i>z-’-q</i>	ܙܥܩ <i>*z’aq / nez’ o</i>	q* cry out, shou	t
<i>p-q-d</i>	ܦܩܕ <i>*pqad / nepqo</i>	d* command, orde	r
<i>k-n-š</i>	ܟܢܫ <i>*knaš / neksn</i>	oš* gather, assem	ble
<i>estrātyōṭā</i>	ܐܫܬܪܬܝܘܬܐ <i>estrātyōṭā</i>	soldier (Gree	k loanword: στρατιώτης)
<i>ḥaylā</i>	ܚܐܝܠܐ <i>ḥaylā</i>	army; strengt	h, power (dual meaning)
<i>saypā</i>	ܣܝܦܐ <i>saypā</i>	sword	
<i>nūrā</i>	ܢܘܪܐ <i>nūrā</i>	fire	
<i>’attūnā</i>	ܐܬܘܢܐ <i>’attūnā</i>	furnace, oven	
<i>šalšaltā</i>	ܫܠܫܠܬܐ <i>šalšaltā</i>	chain (relate	d to Heb. שְׁלָשָׁלַת)
<i>gūbbā</i>	ܓܘܒܒܐ <i>gūbbā</i>	pit, cistern;	den (as in lion’s den)
<i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	ܒܝܬܐ ܕܥܝܪܐ <i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	prison (lit.	‘house of the bound ones’)
<i>kansā</i>	ܟܢܫܐ <i>kansā</i>	crowd, gather	ing, assembly

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>qālā</i>	קָלַל <i>qālā</i>	voice, sound	
<i>rugzā</i>	רָגַז <i>rugzā</i>	anger, wrath	
<i>dehltā</i>	דָּחַל <i>dehltā</i>	fear (noun; f	rom d-h-l)
<i>'ammīnūttā</i>	אָמַן <i>'ammīnūttā</i>	steadfastness	, courage, endurance
<i>pūqdānā</i>	פָּקַד <i>pūqdānā</i>	command, comm	andment (noun from p-q-d)
<i>ṣebyānā</i>	שָׁבַח <i>ṣebyānā</i>	will, wish, d	esire (key theological term)

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 9

The King Commands: Seize Yukhannan

The narrative reaches a climax. Having heard reports of Yukhannan's preaching and miracles, the king summons his soldiers and issues a series of direct commands. The passage is rich in imperatives and *l-* + infinitive constructions, giving you immediate practice in the new grammar.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܢ ܕܐ ܫܡܐ ܕܬ ܡܠܠܐ ܗܠܐܢ	malkā den kad šma ‘ t he.heard wor	he.king now when N ds these heard these	ow when the king words,
ܐܬܡܠܝ ܒܪܘܓܝܐ ܗܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܩܠܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܩܠܐ	’etmalī b-rugzā h ā rabbā* with-anger	e.was.filled h anger and cr and-he.cried.out with- voice great	e was filled with ied out with a great voice.
ܠܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	paqed h w(hy)* to- his.soldi	e.commanded H ers soldiers,	e commanded his
ܠܝܫܐܠܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ ܝܫܐܠܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ	’ezlaw w- ’eḥodw g Yukhannan (ob	o.pl! and seize.pl! ” j.) Yukhannan!	Go and seize
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	w- ’atīw w- ’armōhy a and-throw.hi	nd-come.pl! C m! into the fur in-the.furnace	ome and throw him nace!
ܠܐ ܬܕܠܝܢ ܡܢ ܢܝܫܐܝܬܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ ܠܐ ܬܕܠܝܢ ܡܢ ܢܝܫܐܝܬܐ ܕܝܫܐܠܐ	lā tedḥlūn men n signs- his	ot you.fear.pl from D signs!”	o not fear his
ܠܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	estrāṭyōṭē šarīw s to.go l-me ’zal	oldiers they.began T to go.	he soldiers began
ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	bā ‘ ē ḥad mennhon w to.turn.back	anted one from-them O to turn back	ne of them wanted .
ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	’emar: lā yākelnan h dīqā* we.are.able	e.said not H to.kill not able to righteous.man	e said: ‘We are kill a righteous man.’
ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	’aḥrānē ’asrw o šalšaltā* hands-his wi	thers they.bound O th- chain hands with a	thers bound his chain.
ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	w-grarwōhy lawāt a toward furna	nd-they.dragged.him A ce him toward t	nd they dragged he furnace.
ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܠܡܥܠܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	Yūḥannan dēn lā Yu allī* dhāl ’ellā ṣ	khannan but not Bu t not fear; in he.prayed	t Yukhannan did stead he prayed.

Smooth English Translation:

Now when the king heard these words, he was filled with anger and cried out with a great voice. He commanded his soldiers: “Go and seize Yukhannan! Come and throw him into the furnace! Do not fear his signs!” The soldiers began

to go. One of them wanted to turn back. He said: “We are not able to kill a righteous man.” Others bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace. But Yukhannan did not fear; instead he prayed.

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

Write out all four imperative forms (msg, fsg, mpl, fpl) for each of the following roots in the Peal stem. Include Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. ' -z-l (go) — Peal imperfect 2msg: tēzal → imperative: ?
2. ' -b-d (do, make) — Peal imperfect 2msg: te' bod → imperative: ?
3. q-r- ' (read, call) — Peal imperfect 2msg: teqrā → imperative: ?

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation

Form the Peal, Paael, and Aphel infinitives for each root. Use the pattern: Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCaCCāCū; Aphel = maCCāCū.

1. n-p-q (go out)
2. q-b-l (receive)
3. š-d-r (send)
4. ḥ-z-y (see)
5. ' -l-l (enter)
6. y-l-d (give birth)
7. r-ḥ-m (have mercy)
8. s-g-d (worship)

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into English. Identify any imperatives and l-+infinitive constructions.

1. ܡܠܟܐ ܕܝܫܪܐ ܕܝܫܪܐ

2. ܐܡܪ, ܡܠܟܐ ܕܐܠܡܐ.
3. ܠܐ ܗܝܠܝܚܝܐ.
4. ܐܝܬܐ, ܠܡܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
5. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
6. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
7. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
8. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Express each sentence in Syriac. Use Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. Hear me, O king! (m.sg.)
2. Do not kill the righteous man! (m.pl.)
3. He began to pray.
4. The soldier is not able to flee.
5. The king commanded to throw him into the furnace.
6. She wants to read the book.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6 and answer the following questions in English.

1. Why did the king fill with anger?
2. What two commands did the king give his soldiers?
3. What did one soldier say? Why was he reluctant?
4. How was Yukhannan restrained before being brought to the furnace?
5. How did Yukhannan respond to his situation?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

'-z-l (go):

- msg: 'ezal עזאל
- fsg: 'ezlī עזלי
- mpl: 'ezlaw עזלע
- fpl: 'ezlān עזלען

'-b-d (do):

- msg: 'bod בוד
- fsg: 'bodī בודי
- mpl: 'bodw בודע
- fpl: 'bodān בודען

q-r-' (read/call):

- msg: qrī קרי (III-aleph/yod: vowel changes)
- fsg: qrīy קריי
- mpl: qrīw קריע
- fpl: qrīn קריען

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation (selected answers)

n-p-q: Peal mappaq מפקע; Paael mnappāqū מנפקען; Aphel mappāqū מפקע

š-d-r: Peal mešdar משרד; Paael mšadrū משרען; Aphel 'ašdrū משרע

y-l-d: Peal mīlad מלד; Paael myāladū מלדען; Aphel 'auldū מלדע

Exercise 3: Translation

1. Go to Jerusalem!
2. Hear the voice of God! (to a woman)
3. Do not cry out! (m.pl.)
4. He began to read the book.
5. The king wanted to bind Yukhannan.
6. God is able to strike the soldiers.
7. He commanded them to throw (him) into the furnace.
8. Yukhannan wished to pray.

Exercise 4: Production

1. שמעו, מלכא šma ' nī malkā
2. לא תעטלון לזדדיקא lā teqtlūn l-zaddīqā
3. שרי, למשלā šarī l-mešlā
4. עטרתיקתא לא יאכל למע' ראק estrātyōṭā lā yākel l-me ' raq
5. פאקד מלכא למרמיו לה ב- ' attūnā paqed malkā l-mermyū leh b- ' attūnā
6. בא' יא למערא קטבא bā ' yā l-meqrā ketābā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. He heard the words (reports) about Yukhannan and was filled with anger.
2. (1) Seize Yukhannan; (2) throw him into the furnace.
3. One soldier said they were not able to kill a righteous man — showing moral hesitation.
4. They bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace.
5. Yukhannan did not fear; he prayed instead.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

The Imperative at a Glance

FORM	ENDING	EXAMPLE (K-T-B)	ESTRANGELA
Masculine Singular	CCoC (bare k stem)	tob ܬܒ	ܬܒܐܬ
Feminine Singular	CCoC + k ī	tobī ܬܒܝ	ܬܒܝܐܬ
Masculine Plural	CCoC + k w	tobw ܬܒܘ	ܬܒܘܐܬ
Feminine Plural	CCoC + k ān	tobān ܬܒܢ	ܬܒܢܐܬ

Infinitive Patterns

STEM	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Peal	meCCaC mektab ܡܝܬܒܐ	Most common;	parallel to Hebrew inf. construct with l-
Paael	mCaCCāCū mbarrākū ܡܒܪܟܐܬܐ	Double middl	e radical characteristic
Aphel	maCCāCū mappāqū ܡܦܩܐܬܐ	'a- prefix as	in the Aphel perfect

The l- + Infinitive Construction

Quick Reference

MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE = 'to [do X]'

šarī l-mektab = He began to write

yākel l-mešma' = He is able to hear

bā' ē l-me' zal = He wants to go

paqed l-me' sar = He commanded to bind

NEGATIVE: lā + IMPERFECT (not imperative!) for prohibitions

LESSON 10

The Passive Voice

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–9

Lesson 9 introduced the **imperative** (direct commands), the **infinitive** (verbal noun / maṣdar), and the **l- + infinitive construction** for expressing purpose, ability, desire, and obligation. Before proceeding, confirm you can recall the following:

- **Imperative formation:** Peal msg = CCoC; fsg = CCoC+ī; mpl = CCoC+w; fpl = CCoC+ān
- **Negative commands:** lā + imperfect (never imperative)
- **Infinitive:** Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCaCCāCū; Aphel = maCCāCū
- **Semi-modals:** šarī, yākel, bā ‘ ē, šābē, paqed, šadar — all govern l- + infinitive

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	Give the Peal imperative m.sg. of ‘-z-l (go).	‘zel — go!	ܕܝܠ
2	How do you say “Do not kill!” (m.pl.)?	<i>lā teqṭlūn</i>	ܠܐ ܬܩܬܠܘܢ
3	What is the Peal infinitive of q-ṭ-l (kill)?	<i>meqṭal</i>	ܡܩܬܠܐ
4	Translate: <i>šarri l-mešma ‘</i> .	He began to hear.	ܬܪܝܠܡܫܡܐ
5	What does <i>puqdānā</i> mean?	commandment, command (noun from p-q-d)	ܩܘܕܢܐ

SECTION 2: THE PASSIVE/REFLEXIVE STEMS — OVERVIEW

2.1 The Principle of Passive Formation in Syriac

In Syriac, the passive voice is not expressed by auxiliary verbs (as in English: ‘is killed’, ‘was written’) but by a separate, **inflected stem** built from the active stem by means of a characteristic prefix: **’Et-** or **Et-**. These are called the **Et-stems**. Each active stem has a corresponding Et-stem that functions as its passive or reflexive counterpart.

Students of Hebrew will recognise an analogy with the **Niphal** (נִפְעַל, passive of Qal) and **Hitpael** (הִתְפַּעֵל, reflexive of Piel). Arabists will recognise the parallel with **Forms V, VI, VII, and VIII**: the tā ’-prefixed (تَفَعَّلَ) and n-prefixed (انْفَعَلَ) passives/reflexives. In Greek, the same **passive voice** forms (e.g., παίδεσθαι) serve the function. Latin uses separate passive endings (-or, -ris, -tur etc.).

2.2 The Three Et-Stems

ET-STEM NAME	ACTIVE COUNTERPART	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Ethpeel ܐܬܦܥܠ	Peal	’et-	Passive or reflexive of Peal: ‘to be killed’, ‘to wash oneself’
Etpaael ܐܬܦܥܠ	Paael	’etpa-	Passive or reflexive of Paael: ‘to be blessed’, ‘to be sanctified’
Ettaphal ܐܬܦܥܠܐ	Aphel	’etta-	Passive of Aphel (causative): ‘to be saved’, ‘to be sent’

Cross-Linguistic Summary: Passive Formation

Syriac Ethpeel: ’et- + Peal root → parallel to Hebrew Niphal / Hitpael

Syriac Etpaael: ’etpa- + Paael → parallel to Arabic Form V تَفَعَّلَ

Syriac Ettaphal: ’etta- + Aphel → parallel to Arabic Form VII اِنْفَعَلَ

Greek: active + passive endings (same paradigm structure, different endings)

Latin: active vs. passive endings (-o/-or, -s/-ris, -t/-tur etc.)

SECTION 3: THE ETHPEEL STEM

3.1 Formation of the Ethpeel

The Ethpeel is formed by prefixing 'et- to the Peal root. The perfect stem is 'etCCeC. The participial form, which is very common, is metCCeC. In texts, the prefix may appear as 'et- or 'it- depending on dialect and vowelling.

Example: Root q-ṭ-l (kill) → Ethpeel perfect: 'etqṭel ሂቶላረ 'he was killed'; Participle: metqṭel ሂቶላኑ 'being killed'

3.2 Phonological Rules — Assimilation and Metathesis

When the Peal root begins with certain consonants, the t of the 'et- prefix undergoes phonological changes:

- **Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): Metathesis** — the t and the sibilant swap positions. E.g., š-m- ' → 'et-šma ' becomes 'eš-t-ma ' ሂቶላረ 'it was heard'; similarly 'et-z ' aq → 'ez-t- ' aq
- **Before dental/emphatic consonants (d, ṭ): Assimilation** — the t assimilates to the following consonant. E.g., d-k-y → 'et-dky becomes 'ed-dky (with doubling), sometimes written without the doubled letter.
- **Before all other consonants: No change** — e.g., q-ṭ-l → 'etqṭel; k-t-b → 'etkatteb

3.3 Full Paradigm: Ethpeel of q-ṭ-l (be killed)

Perfect (all 10 forms):

PERSON / NUMBER / GENDER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭel	he was killed	
3fsg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelat	she was killed	d
2msg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelt	you (m.sg.) w	ere killed
2fsg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭeltī	you (f.sg.) w	ere killed
1sg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelet	I was killed	
3mpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelw	they (m.) wer	e killed
3fpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭel(n)	they (f.) wer	e killed
2mpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭeltūn	you (m.pl.) w	ere killed
2fpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭeltēn	you (f.pl.) w	ere killed
1pl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelan	we were killed	d

Participial Forms (Ethpeel Participle of q-ṭ-l):

FORM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
Active Participle m.sg.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭel	being killed	(m.sg.)
Active Participle f.sg.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelā	being killed	(f.sg.)
Active Participle m.pl.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelīn	being killed	(m.pl.)
Active Participle f.pl.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelān	being killed	(f.pl.)

SECTION 4: THE ETTAPHAL AND ETPAAEL STEMS

4.1 The Ettaphal — Passive of the Aphel

The **Ettaphal** is the passive counterpart of the Aphel (causative) stem. Its formation inserts 'etta- before the root. Since the Aphel adds the causative meaning ('to cause to X'), the Ettaphal means 'to be caused to X' — i.e., the passive of a causative, as in 'to be saved' (from 'to save'), 'to be sent' (from 'to send').

Example 1: Root ḥ-y-y / Aphel 'ahyī (save/give life) → Ettaphal: 'ettahyī ሠሐሐጽ 'he was saved / given life'

Example 2: Root 'l-p / Aphel 'alep (teach) → Ettaphal: 'ettalap ለእሱ 'he was taught'

Example 3: Root 'q-m / Aphel 'aqīm (raise up) → Ettaphal: 'ettaqam ጸዕኑ 'he was raised up'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of š-d-r (be sent): (Paael *šaddar* 'send' → 'eštaddar; before š the t of 'et- swaps places with it)

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሰጸው 'eštaddar	he was sent	
3fsg	ሰጸች 'eštaddrat	she was sent	
2msg	ሰጸክ 'eštaddart	you (m.sg.)	were sent
1sg	ሰጸኝ 'eštaddret	I was sent	
3mpl	ሰጸው 'eštaddarw	they (m.) we	re sent
1pl	ሰጸን 'eštaddarn	we were sent	

4.2 The Etpaael — Passive/Reflexive of the Paael

The **Etpaael** is the passive or reflexive of the Paael (intensive/causative) stem. Its prefix is 'etpa-. Since the Paael often carries intensive meaning ('to bless greatly', 'to teach'), the Etpaael means 'to be blessed', 'to be taught', 'to be sanctified'. It can also be reflexive ('to sanctify oneself').

Example 1: Root b-r-k / Paael barrek (bless) → Etpaael: 'etbarrak ህጸኑ 'he was blessed'

Example 2: Root y-l-p / Paael yallep (teach) → Etpaael: 'etyallap ለእሱ 'he was taught / he learned'

Example 3: Root q-d-š / Paael qaddeš (sanctify) → Etpaael: 'etqaddaš ሠጸኑ 'he was sanctified / he sanctified himself'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of b-r-k (be blessed):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሂታሉ 'etbarrak	he was blesse	d
3fsg	ሐታሉ 'etbarkat	she was bless	ed
2msg	ሐታሉ 'etbarkart	you (m.sg.) w	ere blessed
1sg	ሐታሉ 'etbarkaret	I was blessed	
3mpl	ሐታሉ 'etbarkaw	they were ble	ssed
1pl	ሐታሉ 'etbarkan	we were bless	ed

SECTION 5: THE PASSIVE PARTICIPLE (PEAL)

5.1 Form and Usage

Distinct from the Ethpeel, the **Peal passive participle** is a simple adjectival form expressing a **completed passive state**: ‘written’ (ktīb), ‘killed’ (qtīl), ‘bound’ (‘sīr). Its pattern is **CāCoC** or in vocalized manuscripts **CCīC**. It agrees in gender and number with its noun, like any adjective. It is often used in **verbless clauses** with a predicative function: *gawrā qtīlā* ሰብአዊ = ‘the man is killed / the killed man’.

Students of Arabic will recognise the **passive participle (ism al-maf‘ ūl)**: مَقْتُول maqtūl ‘killed’, مَكْتُوب maktūb ‘written’. The Hebrew equivalent is **qāṭūl**: קָטוּל. The pattern is strikingly consistent across Semitic languages.

5.2 Passive Participles — Ten Key Verbs

ROOT	ESTRANGELA (M.SG.)	TRANSLIT. (M.SG.)	ESTRANGELA (F.SG.)	ENGLISH MEANING
<i>k-t-b</i>	כתב <i>ktīb</i>	*כתבת <i>*ktibtā*</i>	written <i>kūbtā*</i>	
<i>q-ṭ-l</i>	قتل <i>qṭīl</i>	*قتلت <i>*qṭiltā*</i>	killed, slain <i>qṭiltā*</i>	
<i>ʿ-s-r</i>	סר <i>ʿsīr</i>	*סרת <i>*ʿsirtā*</i>	bound, impris <i>ʿsirtā*</i>	oned
<i>š-r-y</i>	שר <i>šrī</i>	שרת <i>šrīyā</i>	loosed, relea	sed
<i>š-d-r</i>	דר <i>šdīr</i>	*דרת <i>*šdirtā*</i>	sent <i>šdirtā*</i>	
<i>p-q-d</i>	פקד <i>pqīd</i>	*פקדת <i>*pqīdtā*</i>	commanded; co <i>pqīdtā*</i>	mmandment (noun)
<i>ʿ-m-d</i>	מד <i>ʿmīd</i>	*מדת <i>*ʿmīdtā*</i>	baptized (lit <i>ʿmīdtā*</i>	. ‘dipped’)
<i>š-l-b</i>	שלב <i>šlīb</i>	*שלבת <i>*šlībtā*</i>	crucified; al <i>šlībtā*</i>	so: the cross
<i>q-b-r</i>	קבר <i>qbīr</i>	*קברת <i>*qbīrtā*</i>	buried <i>qbīrtā*</i>	
<i>b-r-k</i>	ברך <i>brīk</i>	*ברכת <i>*brīktā*</i>	blessed (adj. <i>brīktā*</i>	)

5.3 Passive Participle in Verbless Clauses

Examples of the passive participle used predicatively in verbless clauses:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
הוא *מת <i>gawrā qṭīlā*</i>	<i>gawrā qṭīlā*</i> m killed.m.sg	an.the T	he man is killed.
הוא *סר <i>Yūḥannan ʿsīr*</i>	<i>Yūḥannan ʿsīr*</i> Yu	khannan bound Yu	khannan is bound.
הוא *כתב <i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā*</i>	<i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā*</i> b written	ook.the T in truth. in-truth	he book is written
הוא *ברך <i>Mšīḥā brīk l-ʿālam*</i>	<i>Mšīḥā brīk l-ʿālam*</i> M blessed fore	essiah.the T ver blessed fore	he Messiah is ver.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS (PASSIVE FOCUS)

These 30 words are central to Lesson 10 and to Syriac Christian literature generally. Each entry includes the basic (Peal) root, an Et-stem form where relevant, and the English meaning. Many are important

theological terms.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-m-d	ܡܕܝܬܐ* / ܡܕܐ	'mad / 'et' med* b immerse)	aptize / to be baptized (dip,
g-l-y	ܓܠܝܬܐ* / ܓܠܐ	glā / 'etgli* r appear	eveal / to be revealed,
h-y-y / Aph.	ܚܝܝܬܐ* / ܚܝܐ	'ahyī / 'ethayyī* s	ave, give life / to be saved
q-t-l	ܩܬܠܐ* / ܩܬܐ	qṭal / 'etqṭel* k	ill / to be killed
'-s-r	ܥܣܪܐ* / ܥܣܐ	'asar / 'et' eser* b	ind / to be bound
š-r-y	ܫܪܝܬܐ* / ܫܪܐ	šrā / 'etšrī* l released	oosen / to be loosed,
š-d-r	ܫܕܪܐ* / ܫܕܐ	šaddar / 'eštaddar*	send / to be sent (Etpaael)
'-s-y	ܥܣܝܬܐ* / ܥܣܐ	'asī / 'et' asī* h	eal / to be healed
q-w-m / Aph.	ܩܡܝܬܐ* / ܩܡܐ	'aqīm / 'ettaqam* r (Ettaphal)	aise up / to be raised
k-n-š	ܬܬܝܬܐ* / ܬܬܐ	knaš / 'etkneš* g	ather / to be gathered
d-k-y	ܕܬܩܝܬܐ* / ܕܬܩܐ	dkā / 'etdkī* p	urify / to be purified
š-b-q	ܫܒܩܐ* / ܫܒܐ	šbaq / 'etšbaq* f forgiven	orgive, leave / to be
b-r-k	ܒܪܝܬܐ* / ܒܪܐ	barrek / 'etbarrak* b (Etpaael)	less (Paael) / to be blessed
y-l-p	ܝܠܠܐ* / ܝܠܐ	yallep / 'etyallap* t (Etpaael)	each (Paael) / to be taught
m-š-ḥ	ܡܫܚܐ* / ܡܫܐ	mšah / 'etmšah* a	noint / to be anointed
š-l-b	ܫܠܒܐ* / ܫܠܐ	šlab / 'etšlab* c	rucify / to be crucified
q-b-r	ܩܒܪܐ* / ܩܒܐ	qbar / 'etqbar* b	ury / to be buried
d-w-n / Aph.	ܕܠܝܬܐ* / ܕܠܐ	'addīn / 'ettaddīn* j (Ettaphal)	udge / to be judged
h-y-b	ܚܝܒܐ* / ܚܒܐ	ḥayyeb / 'ethayyab* c condemned	ondemn, make guilty / to be

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>p-r-q</i>	ܡܦܩܐ* / ܡܦܩ	praq / 'etpraq* r	edeem, save / to be redeemed
<i>k-l-l</i>	ܟܠܠܐ* / ܟܠܠ	kallel / 'etkallal* c	rown / to be crowned
<i>r-w-m / Aph.</i>	ܡܪܝܡ* / ܡܪܡ	'arīm / 'etrīm* e	xalt / to be exalted
<i>š-p-l</i>	ܫܦܠܐ* / ܫܦܠ	špel / 'etšpal* h	umiliate / to be humbled
<i>t-r-d</i>	ܬܪܝܕܐ* / ܬܪܝܕ	trad / 'ettrad* c out	ast out, expel / to be cast
'-w-d / Aph.	ܐܘܕܝܐ* / ܐܘܕܝܐ	confess, give	thanks (Aphel)
<i>t-w-b</i>	ܬܘܒܐ* / ܬܘܒ	tāb / tāyib* r (participle)	eturn, repent; repentant
<i>y-l-d</i>	ܝܠܕܐ* / ܝܠܕ	yled / 'etyled* g (Ethpeel)	ive birth / to be born
<i>n-h-r / Aph.</i>	ܢܗܪܐ* / ܢܗܪ	nahhar / 'etnahhar* enlightened	illuminate / to be illumined,
<i>m-l-y</i>	ܡܠܝܐ* / ܡܠܝ	mlā / 'etmlī* f	ill / to be filled
<i>p-r-š / Aph.</i>	ܦܪܫܐ* / ܦܪܫ	'aprash / 'etpreš* s separated	eparate, distinguish / to be
'-h-d	ܐܚܕܐ* / ܐܚܕ	'aḥad / 'et 'aḥed*	unite / to be united
<i>ḥ-l-m</i>	ܚܠܡܐ* / ܚܠܡ	ḥelam / 'eṭḥelam*	dream / to be dreamed

Additional words

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING
ܡܕܢܐ	madd' ā	m. noun	knowledge, mind (root y-d-')
ܐܪܡܠܘܬܐ	'armlūtā	f. noun	widowhood
ܐܪܒܐ	'esbā	m. noun	grass, herb
ܫܦܠܐ	'ašpel	verb (Aphel)	to humble, bring low (root š-p-l)
ܚܬܝܬܐ	ḥṭtā	f. noun	sin (root ḥ-ṭ-y)

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 10

Yukhannan Is Thrown into the Fire — and Saved

The narrative continues from Lesson 9. Yukhannan has been bound and dragged to the furnace. Now the passive voice dominates the story: things happen *to* Yukhannan — he is thrown, he is saved, the miracle is revealed to the city. The story showcases Ethpeel, Ettaphal, and passive participle forms throughout.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܠܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'attūnā	w- 'etremy Yūḥannan an Yukhannan in	d-was.thrown An to- furnace thrown into	d Yukhannan was the furnace.
ܠܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ leh	w-nūrā lā qrebet a it.approache	nd-fire.the not B d to.him not approach	ut the fire did him.
* ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ,ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ Ḥananyā w-ḥa	'ayk d- 'et ' bed ' am a brāw(hy)* Hananiah	s that-was.done with J with Hanania and- companions-his	ust as it was done h and his companions.
* ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ d-nūr b-gaw	'ethzī gēr gabrā w 'attūnā* of.fire in-m	as.seen for man F idst was seen in furnace.the	or a man of fire the midst of the furnace.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ men nūhreh	w-Yūḥannan ' etnahhar a was.illumine	nd-Yūḥannan An d from illuminated by light-his	d Yukhannan was his light.
* ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ paršūpeh ' ay	w-kad nepaq ' ethzī a k šemšā* was.seen fac	nd-when he.went.out A e- his like out, his fac sun	nd when he came e was seen like the sun.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ d-neḥzē	kulleh kansā ' etknaš a was.gathered	ll crowd.the A to.see gathered to	ll the crowd was see.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ' etyāde ' b-k	w-rabbā ' attā a ulleh was.made.kno mdintā*	nd-great sign A wn in-all was made kno city.the	nd the great sign wn in all the city.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ' etpanīw	saggī ' ē dḥelw m and- they.tur	any they.feared M ned.back repented.	any feared and
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ' Alāhā d-Yūḥ	w- 'āmṛīn: brīk hū a annan* is God of-Yūḥ	nd-they.say: blessed A annan 'Blessed is th	nd they said: e God of Yukhannan!'
* ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ,ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ men ' īdī	w-Yūḥannan ' etpraq an was.redeemed ba ' eldabbāw(hy)*	d-Yūḥannan And from saved from t hands.of enemies-his	Yukhannan was he hands of his enemies.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ' Alāhā	w-šubḥā ' etyahab a to- God	nd-glory was.given A to God.	nd glory was given

Smooth English Translation:

And Yuxhannan was thrown into the furnace. But the fire did not approach him — just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions. For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace, and Yuxhannan was illumined by his light. When he came out, his face was seen like the sun. All the crowd was gathered to see. And the great sign was made known in all the city. Many feared and repented. And they said: ‘Blessed is the God of Yuxhannan!’ And Yuxhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies, and glory was given to God.

Biblical Allusion: The reference to Ḥananyā and his companions (Hananiah/Shadrach — cf. Dan 3) is intentional. This is a common hagiographic motif in Syriac martyr literature: the saint re-enacts biblical miracles.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify the stem of each verb form (Peal, Paael, Aphel, Ethpeel, Etpaael, or Ettaphal) and give its basic meaning.

1. 'etq̄tel ܐܬܩܬܝܠ
2. 'etbarrak ܐܬܒܪܟܝܠ
3. 'eštaddar ܐܬܫܬܕܪܝܠ
4. metq̄tel ܡܬܩܬܝܠ
5. 'etpraq ܐܬܦܪܩܝܠ
6. 'et 'med ܐܬܡܝܕܝܠ
7. 'ettaqam ܐܬܬܩܡܝܠ
8. brīk ܒܪܝܬܝܠ
9. 'etnahhar ܐܬܢܗܗܪܝܠ
10. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗܝܠ
11. 'etyallap ܐܬܝܠܠܦܝܠ
12. 'etpreš ܐܬܦܪܝܬܝܠ

Exercise 2: Active to Passive Transformation

Rewrite each active sentence in the passive voice using the appropriate Et-stem. Adjust agreement as needed.

1. malkā qṭal l-gawrā — the king killed the man.
2. kāhnā barrek l-‘ammā — the priest blessed the people.
3. šadar malkā estraṭyōṭā — the king sent the soldiers.
4. ‘Ayī ‘aḥyī l-ḥalīšā — the healer saved the weak man.
5. yallep rabbā tlāmīdē — the teacher taught the disciples.
6. ‘aqīm l-‘mītā — he raised the dead man.

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into smooth English.

1. ܐܪܡܝܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
2. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
3. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
4. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
5. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
6. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
7. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
8. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Write each sentence in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

1. He was baptized in the river.

2. The soldiers were sent to the city.
3. The dead man was raised.
4. She was healed by the saint.
5. The word of God was heard in all the land.
6. He was crowned by the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following questions in English.

1. What happened when Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace?
2. What was the biblical parallel mentioned in the story?
3. What was seen in the midst of the furnace?
4. How did the people of the city respond to the miracle?
5. What phrase do the people use to glorify God? Translate it word for word.

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

1. 'etqṭel — Ethpeel (passive of Peal) — 'he was killed'
2. 'etbarrak — Etpaael (passive/reflexive of Paael) — 'he was blessed'
3. 'eštaddar — Etpaael (passive of Paael šaddar) — 'he was sent'; note metathesis of t after š
4. metqṭel — Ethpeel participle — 'being killed'
5. 'etpraq — Ethpeel — 'he was redeemed/saved'
6. 'et 'med — Ethpeel — 'he was baptized'
7. 'ettaqam — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel 'aqīm) — 'he was raised'
8. brīk — Peal passive participle — 'blessed' (adjective)

9. 'etnahhar — Etpaael (passive of Paael nahhar 'illumine') — 'he was illumined'
10. 'etmšah — Ethpeel — 'he was anointed'
11. 'etyallap — Etpaael (passive of Paael yallep) — 'he was taught / he learned'
12. 'etpreš — Ethpeel — 'he was separated'

Exercise 2: Active to Passive

1. 'etq̄tel gawrā (l-malkā) — The man was killed (by the king).
2. 'etbarrak 'ammā (l-kāhnā) — The people were blessed (by the priest).
3. 'eštadrw estrāṭyōṭā — The soldiers were sent.
4. 'eṭḥayyī ḥalīšā — The weak man was saved.
5. 'etyalpw tlāmīdē — The disciples were taught.
6. 'ettaqam 'mītā — The dead man was raised.

Exercise 3: Translation

1. He was thrown into the fire.
2. He was saved/redeemed from (his) enemies.
3. The light was revealed in the darkness.
4. The crowd was gathered in the city.
5. The Messiah was crucified and buried.
6. The Son of God was born.
7. He is killed / he was killed on account of our sins.
8. His voice was heard in every place.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. ܐܬܡܫܚ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ 'et 'med b-nahrā

2. ܐܫܬܕܪܘ ܥܫܬܪܬܝܐܬܝܐܬܝܬܝܐܠܡܕܝܢܬܐ 'eštadrw estrāṭyōṭē l-mdīntā
3. ܐܬܩܡ ܡܝܬܐ 'ettaqam mītā
4. ܐܬ ܐܫܝܬ ܡܢ ܩܕܕܝܫܐ (f.) 'et 'asīt men qaddīšā (f.)
5. ܐܫܬܡܐ ܡܠܬܐ ܕܐܠܗܐ ܒܠܝܠܐ ܐܪܬܐ 'eštma ' maltā d- 'Alāhā b-kullā ar ' ā
6. ܐܬܟܠܠ ܡܢ ܡܠܟܐ 'etkallal men malkā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. The fire did not approach him — he was unharmed.
2. Hananiah (Shadrach) and his companions in the fiery furnace (Daniel 3).
3. A man of fire (an angelic figure) was seen in the midst of the furnace.
4. Many feared and repented, and said 'Blessed is the God of Yukhannan!'
5. 'Brīk hū 'Alāhā d-Yukhannan' — Blessed (is) he, the God of Yukhannan. Word-for-word: brīk = blessed; hū = he (is); 'Alāhā = God.the; d- = of; Yukhannan = Yukhannan.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

Complete Table of All Six Syriac Verbal Stems

This is the master reference table for all six Syriac stems. Memorise the patterns, the characteristic prefixes, and the cross-linguistic equivalents.

STEM	PERF. 3MSG	PARTICIPLE	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Peal ܦܥܠ	q̄tal ܩܬܐܠ	qāṭel ܩܬܐܠܐ	(none)	Basic active: 'he killed'
Paael ܦܥܥܠ	qaṭtel ܩܬܬܐܠ	mqaṭtel ܩܬܬܐܠܐ	doubling	Intensive / denominative: 'he slew repeatedly / he executed'
Aphel ܦܥܠܐ	'aqtel ܐܩܬܐܠ	maqtel ܡܩܬܐܠ	'a-	Causative: 'he caused to kill'
Ethpeel ܦܥܠܐܝܐ	'etqtel ܐܬܩܬܐܠ	metqtel ܡܬܩܬܐܠ	'et-	Passive/reflexive of Peal: 'he was killed'
Etpaael ܦܥܥܠܐܝܐ	'etqaṭtal ܐܬܩܬܬܐܠ	metqaṭtal ܡܬܩܬܬܐܠ	'etpa-	Passive/reflexive of Paael: 'he was executed'
Ettaphal ܦܥܠܐܝܐܝܐ	'ettaqtal ܐܬܩܬܐܠܐܝܐ	mettaqtal ܡܬܩܬܐܠܐܝܐ	'etta-	Passive of Aphel: 'he was caused to be killed'

Passive Participle Pattern

Peal Passive Participle

Pattern: CCīC (or CāCoC in some vocalization traditions)

Agrees in gender and number with noun (like any adjective)

m.sg.: ktīb ܟܬܒܐ / f.sg.: ktībtā ܟܬܒܬܐ / m.pl.: ktībīn ܟܬܒܝܢ / f.pl.: ktībān ܟܬܒܝܢ

Used predicatively in verbless clauses: gawrā qṭilā = 'the man is killed'

Compare: Arabic maf'ūl (مَكْتُوب maktūb 'written'); Hebrew qāṭūl (קָטוּל)

Ethpeel Phonological Rules

Assimilation & Metathesis in Ethpeel

Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): METATHESIS — t moves after the sibilant

*'et- + š-m- ' → 'eštma ' (not * 'etšma ')*

Before dentals (d, ṭ): ASSIMILATION — t assimilates to the following letter

'et- + d-k-y → 'eddkī

Before all other consonants: no change — 'et- + q-ṭ-l → 'etqṭel

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LESSON 11

Verbal Suffixes: The Fast Direct Object

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF PREVIOUS CONCEPTS

Quick Summary

Throughout the course, we have used the preposition **l-** (ܠ) to mark the direct object of a verb. For example, *q̄tal l-malkā* (he killed the king) or *q̄tal l-ēh* (he killed him). We also learned how to attach pronominal suffixes to nouns and prepositions to indicate possession or indirect objects (*bayt-eh* = his house; *l-ēh* = to him).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. Translate: *Nēthūn* (from *’-t-y*, they will come).
2. What happens to the noun *malkā* when you add the suffix for “my”?
3. Translate: *’Eqṭūl*.
4. How do you say “to us” using the preposition *l-*?
5. How does Syriac traditionally mark a definite direct object?

SECTION 2: THE VERBAL SUFFIX — OVERVIEW

While *q̄tal l-ēh* (“he killed him”) is perfectly valid Syriac, Semitic languages prefer a tighter, faster construction for pronoun objects. They allow you to attach the object pronoun **directly to the verb itself**.

This creates a single, highly compressed word that contains the Action, the Subject, and the Direct Object.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Object Suffixes on Verbs

- **Hebrew:** *q̄tal-ō* (קָטַל-וֹ — he killed him). The suffix *-ō* is attached directly to the perfect verb.
- **Arabic:** *q̄atal-a-hu* (قَاتَلَ-ا-هُ — he killed him). The suffix *-hu* is attached directly to the verb.
- **Syriac:** *q̄at̄l-eh* (ܩܬܠ-ܝܗ — he killed him). The suffix *-eh* attaches directly, altering the internal vowels of the verb.

- **Greek/Latin:** Indo-European languages generally keep the object pronoun separate (e.g., *auton apektelnen, eum interfecit*), though spoken Romance languages often compress them into clitics (Spanish: *matarlo*).

Core Principle: A suffix attached to a noun is possessive (“his house”). A suffix attached to a verb is the direct object (“he killed him”). The suffix *never* represents the subject of the verb.

SECTION 3: MORPHOLOGY OF VERBAL SUFFIXES (PEAL PERFECT)

When you attach a pronoun suffix to a verb, the vowels inside the verb often shift to accommodate the new rhythm. We will focus on attaching suffixes to the 3rd person masculine singular Peal perfect (*qṭal*, “he killed”).

1. Connecting Vowels (The “Nun” buffer)

Sometimes, attaching a suffix directly to a verb ending sounds clunky or ambiguous. Syriac frequently uses a *Nun* (n) as a buffer consonant.

- “He killed me”: Not *qṭal-y*, but *qṭl-anī*.
- “He killed us”: *qṭl-an*.

2. Vocalization Shifts

When adding an object suffix to *qṭal* (which has no vowel between the first two consonants: q-ṭ-a-l), the vowel shifts back to separate the first two consonants.

- *qṭal + eh* → *qṭl-eh* (q-a-ṭ-l-e-h).

3. Meaning

Qṭleh means “He killed him”.

- Subject: He (inherent in the base verb form).
 - Object: Him (the suffix).
-

SECTION 4: VERBAL SUFFIX PARADIGM (ROOT Q-Ṭ-L)

Here is how the 3rd person masculine singular Perfect (*qṭal*, “he killed”) takes all the object suffixes.

OBJECT (ENGLISH)	SUFFIX FORM	ATTACHED TO QṬAL (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
me (1 c.sg.)	ܐ (-anī)	ܩܬܠܐܝ	qatlanī	he killed me
you (2 m.sg.)	ܟ (-āk)	ܩܬܠܟ	qatlāk	he killed you (m)
you (2 f.sg.)	ܚ (-ēky)	ܩܬܠܚ	qatlēky	he killed you (f)
him (3 m.sg.)	ܐ (-eh)	ܩܬܠܐܗ	qatleh	he killed him
her (3 f.sg.)	ܐ (-āh)	ܩܬܠܐܗ	qatlah	he killed her
us (1 c.pl.)	ܐ (-an)	ܩܬܠܐܢ	qatlan	he killed us
you (2 m.pl.)	ܟܢ (-kūn)	ܩܬܠܟܢ	qatlkūn	he killed you (mpl)
you (2 f.pl.)	ܟܢ (-kēn)	ܩܬܠܟܢ	qatlkēn	he killed you (fpl)
them (3 m.pl.)	ܟܢ (-hūn)	ܩܬܠܗܢ	qatlhūn	he killed them (m)
them (3 f.pl.)	ܟܢ (-hēn)	ܩܬܠܗܢ	qatlhēn	he killed them (f)

Note: Suffixes can also be attached to the Imperfect and Imperative forms (e.g., “Kill him!”). The suffixes remain fundamentally identical, though the connecting vowels may vary slightly.

SECTION 5: SYNTAX COMPARISON TABLE

How to say “He killed him” three ways in Syriac:

STYLE	SYRIAC TRANSLIT	BREAKDOWN	NOTES
Independent Obj	qṭal l-ēh	he-killed to-him	Standard, highly common.
Verbal Suffix	qatl-eh	he-killed-him	Fast, literary, deeply Semitic.
Demonstrative	qṭal l-hū	he-killed to-that-one	Used for emphasis (“That guy”).

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (HEALING, NATURE, COMMUNITY)

Many verbs related to interpersonal action (healing, forgiving, striking) frequently take verbal suffixes.

ROOT (PEAL/APHEL)	VERB EXAMPLE (3 M.S)	MEANING	WITH 1ST PERSON SUFFIX (-ANĪ)
פ.ר.ק (p-r-q)	praq (Peal)	to save, deliver	parqanī (he saved me)
א.ש.י (' -s-y)	'asī (Aphel)	to heal (causative)	'asyanī (he healed me)
פ.ב.ק (š-b-q)	šbaq (Peal)	to leave, forgive	šbaqanī (he left me)*
מ.ח.י (m-h-y)	mḥā (Peal)	to strike, hit	mḥānī (he struck me)
ק.ר.י (q-r-y)	qrā (Peal)	to call	qrānī (he called me)
נ.ח.מ (n-h-m)	naḥḥem (Paael)	to raise (the dead), revive	naḥḥmanī (he revived me)
ח.ט.י (ḥ-ṭ-y)	ḥṭā (Peal)	to sin	(intransitive usually)
כ.ר.ח (k-r-h)	kurhānā (Noun)	illness, sickness	
ח.ט.י (ḥ-ṭ-y)	ḥṭtā (Noun)	sin	
נ.פ.ל (n-p-l)	npal (Peal)	to fall	npal b-kurhānā (fell ill)
ת.ב.ר (t-b-r)	tbar (Peal)	to break	tabranī (he broke me)

*Note: Forgiving is usually expressed with **ל-**: šbaq lī (he forgave to me).

SECTION 7: THE STORY – PART 11

The Healing

Narrative note: The king, having fallen ill, begs for physical and spiritual salvation. Notice the dense use of verbal suffixes (fast direct objects) as he pleads with Yukhannan.

Sentence 1

וּבְיוֹמָא הַהוּא נְפַל מַלְכָּא בְּכֻרְחָנָא בִּישָׁא. וּבְיוֹמָא (and-in-day) haw (that) npal (fell) malkā (the-king) b-kurhānā (in-illness) bišā (evil/bad). → And in that day, the king fell into a severe illness.

Sentence 2

ወ- 'etā l-wāt Yūḥannan, w-npal qdāmāw-hy, w- 'emar l-ēh:
 w- 'etā (and-came) l-wāt (to-the-presence-of) Yūḥannan (John), w-npal (and-fell) qdāmāw-hy (before-
 him), w- 'emar (and-said) l-ēh (to-him): → And he came to Yukhannan, and fell before him, and said to
 him:

Sentence 3

ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ 'asy-anī men kurhān-y, w-parq-anī men mawtā! 'asy-anī (heal-me
 [Aphel Impv]) men (from) kurhān-y (illness-my), w-parq-anī (and-save-me [Peal Impv]) men (from)
 mawtā (death)! → “Heal me from my illness, and save me from death!”

Sentence 4

ወ- 'šbūq lī ḥṭitt-y d-saggī 'ā hī! w- 'šbūq (and-forgive [Peal Impv]) lī (to-me)
 ḥṭitt-y (sin-my) d-saggī 'ā (which-is-great/much) hī (she-[is])! → “And forgive me my sin, which is great!”

Sentence 5

ወ- 'qrāwhy Yūḥannan l-Alāhā w- 'emar: qrāwhy (he-called-him [3msg Peal Perf.
 of q-r-y + 3msg obj. suffix]) Yūḥannan (John) l-Alāhā (to-God) w- 'emar (and-said): → Yukhannan called
 upon God and said: *Note: III-Yodh verbs contract the final yodh before the suffix: qrā + -wh + y → qrāwhy.*

Sentence 6

ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ Alāhā nneḥt-āk, w-naḥyē-k hāšā. Alāhā (God) nneḥt-āk (he-will-give-rest-
 you), w-naḥyē-k (and-he-will-give-life/save-you [Aphel Imperfect]) hāšā (now). → “God will give you rest,
 and will save you now.”

Sentence 7

ወ- 'asy-eh Alāhā b-ṭaybütt-eh. w- 'asy-eh (and-he-healed-him) Alāhā (God)
 b-ṭaybütt-eh (by-grace-his). → And God healed him by his grace.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification

Identify the verb root, the tense/form (if you can), and the person/gender of the suffix.

1. ለፍፁም ሕይወቴ (qatlhūn)

2. ܦܪܩܢܝ (parqanī)
3. ܐܣܝܐܬܝܢ (ʾasyāṭ)
4. ܩܪܝܬܝܢܐ (qrāwhī — III-Yodh verb q-r-y with 3msg direct object suffix; final yodh contracts before suffix)

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Take the Peal perfect 3 m.sg verb *šbaq* (he left/abandoned) and attach suffixes to mean:

1. He abandoned me.
2. He abandoned us.
3. He abandoned her.
4. He abandoned them (m).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following clauses featuring verbal suffixes.

1. Mḥānī barnāšā bišā b-tar ʿ ā.
2. Alāhā qaṭleh l-malkā tammān. (Note: Syriac sometimes uses both the suffix *and* the preposition **l-** for extreme emphasis).
3. ʾ Emar malkā: “Parqanī!”
4. Alāhā ʾ asyan b-melt-eh.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following actions into single-word Syriac verbs with suffixes (using 3rd m.sg *qṭal* base).

1. He killed us.
2. He saved (praq) him.
3. He left (šbaq) you (m.sg).
4. He struck (mḥā) them (m.pl).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. What three imperative commands does the sick king give to Yukhannan?
2. Why does the king ask for forgiveness regarding his sin?

3. Who ultimately performs the healing in sentence 7?

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. They will come.
2. It drops the Emphatic Alaph and takes the suffix **-y** : *malky*.
3. I will kill.
4. *lān*.
5. By placing the preposition **l-** before the object.

Exercise 1: Suffix Identification

1. Root: *q-ṭ-l*. Suffix: 3rd m.pl (them). He killed them.
2. Root: *p-r-q*. Suffix: 1st c.sg (me). He delivered me.
3. Root: *'-s-y*. Suffix: 2nd m.sg (you). He healed you.
4. Root: *q-r-y*. Suffix: 3rd m.sg (him). He called him.

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

1. šbaqanī (or šabqanī)
2. šabqan
3. šabqāh
4. šabqhūn

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. The evil man struck me in the gate.
2. God killed him, the king, there.
3. The king said: "Save me!"
4. God healed us (*'asy-an*) by his word.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. qaṭlan

2. parqeh
3. šabqāk
4. mḥāhūn

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. Heal me ('aṣyanī), save me (parqanī), forgive me (šbūq lī).
2. Because it is great (saggī 'ā hī).
3. God (Alāhā).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE VERBAL SUFFIX PARADIGM (He killed...)

ENGLISH	SUFFIX ON VERB	EXAMPLE
...me	-anī	qaṭlanī (he killed me)
...you(m)	-āk	qaṭlāk (he killed you)
...you(f)	-ēky	qaṭlēky (he killed you)
...him	-eh	qaṭleh (he killed him)
...her	-āh	qaṭlāh (he killed her)
...us	-an	qaṭlan (he killed us)
...them(m)	-hūn	qaṭlhūn (he killed them)

DOUBLE DETERMINATION RULE

Sometimes Syriac uses the verb suffix AND the preposition **l-** in the same sentence. This is called *prolepsis* or double determination, used for clarity or emphasis. *Qaṭl-eh l-malkā* = He killed him, [namely] the king.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following 30 genuinely new high-frequency words supplement this lesson's vocabulary, focusing on verbs and nouns related to interpersonal action (commonly taking object suffixes) and related

abstract/derived nouns.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܢܫܟ	nasak	verb	to pour, cast	common with suffixes
ܕܒܥܩ	dābeq	verb	to cling, adhere	transposes object suffix
ܕܒܪ	gāder	verb	to fence, hedge in	takes object suffix
ܫܗܕ	səhed	verb	to witness, testify	object suffix usage
ܫܢܐ	šānē	verb	to change, alter	object suffix common
ܫܪܒ	šāreb	verb	to drink	takes object suffix
ܦܫܐ	pāsa ʿ	verb	to cut, prune	object suffix frequent
ܕܫܐ	kassī	verb	to cover, conceal	takes object suffix
ܫܐܢ	ʿāšan	verb	to strengthen, prevail	object suffix usage
ܕܠܗ	dāleh	verb	to draw water	takes object suffix
ܒܐܝܬ	baz	verb	to plunder, rob	object suffix common
ܫܪܪ	šarrar	verb	to confirm, make firm	takes object suffix
ܢܓܕ	ngad	verb	to pull, draw	object suffix usage
ܫܩܐܠ	šqal	verb	to lift, carry	takes object suffix
ܕܓܐܫ	dāgaš	verb	to push, press	object suffix frequent
ܦܕܐ	pāda ʿ	verb	to inform, make known	transposes object suffix
ܫܬܐܕ	ʿāmed	verb	to stand firm	object suffix usage
ܪܩܒ	rākeb	verb	to ride, mount	takes object suffix

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܠܐ	klā	verb	to prevent, withhold	object suffix common
ܠܡܐ	‘āmar	verb	to dwell, inhabit	transposes object suffix
ܠܡܥܐ	ḥāsar	verb	to lack, be deprived	takes object suffix
ܕܡܝܪܬܐ	gmīrūtā	f. noun	completion, perfection	derived from g-m-r
ܕܡܪܗܡܢܘܬܐ	mraḥmānūtā	f. noun	mercy, compassion	related to r-ḥ-m
ܢܨܬܐ	nussākā	m. noun	pouring, libation	from n-s-k
ܕܡܝܪܬܐ	dəbīqūtā	f. noun	clinging, adherence	from d-b-q
ܫܡܝܪܐ	šēmīrā	m. noun	watch, guard	from š-m-r
ܡܢܢܐ	pūnnāyā	m. noun	answer, return	from p-n-y
ܩܒܠܐ	qubbālā	m. noun	acceptance, reception	from q-b-l
ܫܬܝܐ	šetyā	m. noun	drinking	from š-t-y
ܡܡܟܟܐ	mūkkākā	m. noun	humiliation, lowliness	from m-k-k

LESSON 12

Fringes of Syntax: Demonstratives, Numbers, and Conditionals

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSON 11

Quick Summary

In Lesson 11, we examined how Syriac attaches direct object pronouns directly to the verb, creating a highly compressed “fast direct object” (e.g., *qaṭl-eh*, “he killed him” vs. *qṭal l-ēh*, “he killed to-him”).

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

(Answers in Section 9)

1. How does Syriac buffer the 1st person singular object suffix on a Peal perfect verb?
 2. Translate: *Parq-anī*.
 3. Break down the components of *qaṭlhūn*.
 4. Why does *qṭal* become *qaṭl-* when adding a suffix?
 5. Translate the double-determined phrase: *ʾAsyeh Alāhā l-malkā*.
-

SECTION 2: DEMONSTRATIVES AND NUMBERS — OVERVIEW

As we wrap up our core tour of Syriac syntax, we encounter the final few connective tissues that hold sentences together: Demonstrative pronouns (this, that, these, those) and Numbers.

Cross-Linguistic Comparison: Demonstratives

Semitic languages feature a close-range pointing word (“this”) and a far-range pointing word (“that”).

- **Hebrew:** זֶה (*zeh* — this, m), הַהוּ (*hahū* ’ — that, m).
- **Arabic:** هَـذَا (*hādhā* — this, m), ذَـلِكَ (*dhālika* — that, m).
- **Syriac:** ܗܢܐ (*hānā* — this, m), ܗܘܐ (*haw* — that, m).

Syriac Trick: The far demonstrative (“that”) is spelled and pronounced exactly like the 3rd person independent pronoun (*hū* = he/it; *haw* = that). Context dictates the meaning.

1. Pointing Words (Demonstratives)

Demonstratives in Syriac must agree with the noun they modify in gender and number. Unlike English (which puts “this” *before* the noun: “this king”), Syriac prefers to place the demonstrative *after* the noun, or even isolated at the front of a sentence.

- *Malkā hānā* = This king (The king, this one).
- *Malkūttā hādē* = This kingdom.
- *Gabrē hāllēn* = These men.

2. Conditional Clauses (**’en**)

Syriac expresses “If X, then Y” using the particle **’en** (if). The “if” half of the sentence is the *protasis*, and the “then” half is the *apodosis*. Usually, Syriac doesn’t even use a word for “then”; it simply starts the second clause, often with **w-** (and).

- *’En teḥzē, teida* (If you see, [then] you will know).

3. Comparatives (**men**)

Syriac lacks special adjective forms for “bigger,” “faster,” or “better” (like Greek’s -τερος or English’s -er). Instead, it uses the standard adjective and the preposition **men** (from/than).

- *Nūhrā ṭābā hū men ḥešūkā* (Light is good from darkness → Light is **better than** darkness).
- *Rabbā hī men malkūttā* (She is great from the kingdom → She is **greater than** the kingdom).

SECTION 4: DEMONSTRATIVE PRONOUN PARADIGM

DISTANCE	GENDER / NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLIT	TRANSLATION
Close	Masc Sg	הָנָא	hānā	this (m)
Close	Fem Sg	הָדֵא	hādē	this (f)
Close	Common Pl	הָלְלֵנ	hāllēn	these (c)
Far	Masc Sg	הָו	haw	that (m)
Far	Fem Sg	הָי	hāy	that (f)
Far	Masc Pl	הָנֹנ	hānōn	those (m)
Far	Fem Pl	הָנֵנ	hānēn	those (f)

SECTION 5: THE NUMBERS 1-10

Semitic numbers famously exhibit “gender polarity”—masculine nouns often take what looks like the feminine absolute number ending, and vice versa. However, you only need to recognize them to read them.

NUMBER	MASC FORM (USED WITH FEM NOUNS)	FEM FORM (USED WITH MASC NOUNS)	TRANSLIT
1	אֶחָד (ḥad)	אֶחָדָא (ḥdā)	(One)
2	אַרְבָּע (trēn)	אַרְבָּעָא (tartēn)	(Two)
3	שְׁלֹשָׁה (tlāt)	שְׁלֹשָׁא (tlātā)	(Three)
4	אַרְבַּעַת (‘arba‘)	אַרְבַּעַתָּא (‘arba‘ ā)	(Four)
5	חֲמִישָׁה (ḥameš)	חֲמִישָׁא (ḥamšā)	(Five)
6	שֵׁשֶׁת (šet)	שֵׁשֶׁתָּא (štā)	(Six)
7	שְׁבַעַת (šba‘)	שְׁבַעַתָּא (šab‘ ā)	(Seven)
8	תְּמָנָה (tmānē)	תְּמָנָא (tmānyā)	(Eight)
9	תֵּשַׁעַת (tša‘)	תֵּשַׁעַתָּא (teš‘ ā)	(Nine)
10	עָשָׂר (‘sar)	עָשָׂרָא (‘esrā)	(Ten)

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY (CONCEPTS & CONCLUDING WORDS)

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER	MEANING	NOTES
ܠܝܬܐ	šrārā	m.	truth, reality	Root š-r-r (to be firm). Cf. Heb 'ēmet
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	m.	peace, greeting	Root š-l-m. Heb <i>Shalom</i> , Arabic <i>Salam</i>
ܠܝܬܐ	ḥayyē	m.pl.	life	Used heavily by John in the NT
ܠܝܬܐ	ʿālmā	m.	world, eternity	Temporal and spatial boundary
ܠܝܬܐ	hākannā	adv.	thus, so	
ܝܢ	'en	conj.	if	Introduces condition
ܠܝܬܐ	ḥešūḳā	m.	darkness	Antonym of <i>nūhrā</i> (light)
ܠܝܬܐ	šlah (Peal)	verb	to strip off / cast away	Used for removing garments or sin

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 12

The Departure

Narrative note: The conclusion of the initial cycle of Mar Yukhannan's acts. The king uses a conditional statement ("If any man...") to establish a new decree. The section closes with a demonstrative and thematic "peace".

Sentence 1

ܠܝܬܐ ܝܘܚܢܢ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܩܡܐ. kad 'asy-eh Yūḥannan l-malkā, malkā qām. kad (when) 'asy-eh (he-healed-him) Yūḥannan (John) l-malkā (to/the-king), malkā (the-king) qām (stood-up). → When Yukhannan healed the king, the king stood up.

Sentence 2

w- 'emar l- 'ammā d-īl-eh hākannā: w- 'emar (and-said) l- 'ammā (to-the-people) d-īl-eh (which-were-his) hākannā (thus): → And he said to his people thus:

Sentence 3

’en ’aynā barnāšā lā nešlah ḥṭtā d-il-eh, neqtlün-yhy! ’en (If) ’aynā (which/any) barnāšā (man) lā (not) nešlah (will-cast-away) ḥṭtā (sin) d-il-eh (which-[is]-his, neqtlün-yhy (they-will-kill-him)! → “If any man does not cast away his sin, they shall kill him!”

Sentence 4

ܝܘܚܢܢ ܝܥܡܪ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܐ ܗܝܟܢܢܐ. Yūḥannan 'emar l-malkā: lā hākannā. Yūḥannan (John) 'emar (said) l-malkā
 (to-the-king): lā (not) hākannā (thus/so). → Yukhannan said to the king: "Not so."

Sentence 5

אלהא דשרארה שְׁבַּאק מֵנִי בִישָׂא. Alāhā d-šrārā šbaq men bišā. Alāhā (God) d-šrārā (of-truth) šbaq (forgave) men (from) bišā (evil). → “The God of truth forgave the evil.”

Sentence 6

ܠܗܘܬܐ ܡܢ ܠܗܘܬܐ nūhrā hānā ṭābā hū men ḥešūkā. nūhrā (the-light) hānā (this) ṭābā
(good) hū (it-is) men (from) ḥešūkā (darkness). → “This light is better than darkness.”

Sentence 7

w-šbaq Yūḥannan l-malkūttā b-šlāmā, w-
'ezal b- 'ūrḥā d- 'ālmā. w-šbaq (and-left) Yūḥannan (John) l-malkūttā (the-kingdom) b-šlāmā (in-peace),
w- 'ezal (and-went) b- 'ūrḥā (in-way/road) d- 'ālmā (of-eternity/the-world). → And Yukhannan left the
kingdom in peace, and went in the way of eternity.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Demonstrative & Number Identification

Identify the gender, number, and meaning of these modifiers.

1. ስጋጥ (hādē)
2. ስጋላላ (tlātā)

3. ܚܢܢ (hānōn)

4. ܚܕܐ (ḥdā)

Exercise 2: Comparative Translation

Translate these sentences using **men** as a comparative.

1. Alāhā rabbā hū men malkā.
2. Ḥayyē ṭābīn hennōn men mawtā.
3. 'Ar 'ā hādē bīštā hī men šmayyā (heaven).

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following conditional and demonstrative clauses.

1. 'En tešbūq l-Alāhā, neqtūl lāk malkā hānā.
2. Gabrā haw npal b-kūrā.
3. W- 'etaw talmīdē hāllēn l-bayteh.
4. Lā hākannā 'emar Yūḥannan b-šrārā.

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac)

Render the following sentences into Syriac transliteration.

1. This word (f.sg) is better than that word.
2. If you (m.pl) hear the voice, you will live (ḥ-y-y, imperfect).
3. The three men went out from the kingdom. (Three = *tlātā*).
4. God saved this evil world ('ālmā hānā).

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read Section 7 and answer:

1. What extreme punishment does the king decree for those who do not cast away their sin?
 2. How does Yukhannan correct the king's theology?
 3. With what emotion or state does Yukhannan depart the kingdom?
-

Section 1 Warm-Up

1. It inserts a *Nun* (n) buffer, e.g., *qaṭlanī*.
2. Save me! (Imperative).
3. Root *q-ṭ-l* (killed), plus 3rd masc plural suffix *hūn* (them) = He killed them.
4. The addition of the suffix forces a shift in the stress, causing the vowel *a* to move forward (*qṭa-leh* → *qaṭ-leh*).
5. “God healed him, the king” (Double determination using the suffix *and* the preposition *l-*).

Exercise 1: Identification

1. Feminine singular close (This, f)
2. Number three (used with masc nouns)
3. Masculine plural far (Those, m)
4. Number one (f)

Exercise 2: Comparative Translation

1. God is greater than the king.
2. Life is better than death.
3. This earth is worse than heaven.

Exercise 3: Translation Drill

1. If you abandon God, this king will kill you.
2. That man fell into illness.
3. And these disciples came to his house.
4. “Not so” said Yukhannan in truth.

Exercise 4: Production Drill

1. Meltā hādē ṭābtā hī men meltā hāy.
2. ‘En tešm ‘ūn qālā, tēḥūn / teḥyūn.
3. Tlātā gabrīn nṣaqū men malkūtā.
4. Alāhā praq l- ‘ālmā hānā bīšā.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

1. They will be killed (*neqṭlūn-yhy*).
2. By reminding him that the God of truth forgave the evil (“Not so,” *lā hākannā*).
3. In peace (*b-šlāmā*).

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

DEMONSTRATIVES

CLOSE (THIS / THESE)	FAR (THAT / THOSE)
hānā (m) / hādē (f)	haw (m) / hāy (f)
hāllēn (pl)	hānōn (m.pl) / hānēn (f.pl)

CONDITIONALS & COMPARISONS

CONSTRUCTION	EXAMPLE	MEANING
'en (If) + Imperf	'en teḥzē	If you see...
Adj + <i>men</i> (from)	ṭābā men malkā	Better than the king
Noun + Demonstrative	malkā hānā	This king

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 8 terms.

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING	NOTES
ܬܪܓܡܐ	tregumā	m. noun	translation	
ܐܘܡܐ	'ōkmā	adv	how	relative/interrogative
ܕܡܢ	dumān	adv	from that place	subordinating
ܠܐ	lā	neg_adv	not	negation/discourse
ܡܚܠܐ	makknatā	f. noun	place, position	
ܐܝܢܐ	ḥādyā	m. num	one	first numeral
ܚܡܫܐ	ḥammšā	m. num	five	numeral
ܐܫܬܐ	'esrā	m. num	ten	numeral

Appendix A: Paradigm Tables

THE ACTS OF MAR YUKHANNAN

— a reference collection of every paradigm taught in Lessons 1–12. Transliteration follows the lessons. The lesson where each table is taught is given in brackets.

A.1 PRONOUNS

Independent and enclitic personal pronouns [L1, L2]

PERSON	SYRIAC	INDEPENDENT	ENCLITIC
1 c.sg.	ܐܢܝ	ʿenā	-nā
2 m.sg.	ܕܝܢܝ	ʿant (said ʿat)	-t
2 f.sg.	ܕܝܢܝܐ	ʿantī (said ʿat)	-tī
3 m.sg.	ܐܘܬܐ	hū	hū
3 f.sg.	ܐܘܬܐܐ	hī	hī
1 c.pl.	ܐܡܢܝ	ḥnan	-ḥnan
2 m.pl.	ܕܝܢܝܐܝ	ʿantūn (said ʿattūn)	-tūn
2 f.pl.	ܕܝܢܝܐܝܐ	ʿantēn (said ʿattēn)	-tēn
3 m.pl.	ܐܘܬܐܝܐ	hennōn	—
3 f.pl.	ܐܘܬܐܝܐܐ	hennēn	—

Demonstratives [L12]

	NEAR ('THIS, THESE')	FAR ('THAT, THOSE')
m.sg.	ܐܠܝܗܐ hānā	ܐܠܝܗܐ haw
f.sg.	ܐܠܝܗܐ hādē	ܐܠܝܗܐ hāy
pl.	ܐܠܝܗܐ hālēn	ܐܠܝܗܐ hānōn (m), ܐܠܝܗܐ hānēn (f)

The three states [L1]

	MASCULINE	FEMININE
Emphatic sg. (normal form)	ܡܠܟܐ malkā ‘the king, a king’	ܡܠܟܬܐ malktā ‘queen’
Absolute sg.	ܡܠܟ melek	ܡܠܟܐ malkā
Construct sg.	ܡܠܟ malk	ܡܠܟܬ malkat
Emphatic pl.	ܡܠܟܐ malkē (with <i>syāmē</i>)	ܡܠܟܬܐ malkātā
Absolute pl.	ܡܠܟܝ malkīn	ܡܠܟܝ malkān

The plural dots (*syāmē*,) mark plurals that would otherwise look singular.

Possessive suffixes on a singular noun [L4] — *malk-* ‘king’

PERSON	SUFFIX	SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION
my	-ī	ܡܠܟܐ	malk-ī
your (m.sg.)	-āk	ܡܠܟܝ	malk-āk
your (f.sg.)	-ēk	ܡܠܟܬܝ	malk-ēk
his	-eh	ܡܠܟܬܐ	malk-eh
her	-āh	ܡܠܟܬܐ	malk-āh
our	-an	ܡܠܟܝܢ	malk-an
your (m.pl.)	-kūn	ܡܠܟܝܢ	malk-kūn
your (f.pl.)	-kēn	ܡܠܟܝܢ	malk-kēn
their (m.)	-hūn	ܡܠܟܝܢ	malk-hūn
their (f.)	-hēn	ܡܠܟܝܢ	malk-hēn

On a **plural** noun the suffixes take a *y* link: ܡܠܟܝ malkay ‘my kings’, ܡܠܟܬܐ malkaw ‘his kings’, ܡܠܟܬܐ malkēh ‘her kings’.

Prepositions with suffixes [L4]: ܠ lī, ܠܝ lāk, ܠܝ lēk, ܠܝ leh, ܠܝ lāh, ܠ lan, ܠܝ lkūn, ܠܝ lkēn, ܠܝ lhūn, ܠܝ lhēn. **Possession:** ܠ ܝܬ lī ‘I have’; ܠ ܝܬ layt lī ‘I do not have’.

A.3 THE STRONG VERB: PEAL

Perfect [L3] — *k-t-b* ‘write’

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.	PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.
3 m.sg.	ܟܬܒ	ktab	3 m.pl.	ܟܬܒܐ	ktabū
3 f.sg.	ܟܬܒܬ	ketbat	3 f.pl.	ܟܬܒܬܝ	ktabī
2 m.sg.	ܟܬܒܬ	ktabt	2 m.pl.	ܟܬܒܬܝܬܐ	ktabtūn
2 f.sg.	ܟܬܒܬܝ	ktabtī	2 f.pl.	ܟܬܒܬܝܬܝ	ktabtēn
1 c.sg.	ܟܬܒܬ	ketbet	1 c.pl.	ܟܬܒܬܡܢ	ktabn

Imperfect [L8] — *q-ṭ-l* ‘kill’

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.	PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.
3 m.sg.	ܩܬܠ	neqtūl	3 m.pl.	ܩܬܠܐ	neqtlūn
3 f.sg.	ܩܬܠܬ	teqtūl	3 f.pl.	ܩܬܠܝܬ	neqtlān
2 m.sg.	ܩܬܠܬ	teqtūl	2 m.pl.	ܩܬܠܬܝܬܐ	teqtlūn
2 f.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܝܬ	teqtlīn	2 f.pl.	ܩܬܠܬܝܬܝܬ	teqtlān
1 c.sg.	ܩܬܠܬܝܬ	’eqtūl	1 c.pl.	ܩܬܠܬܡܢ	neqtūl

Imperative [L9] — m.sg. ܩܬܠ qṭol, f.sg. ܩܬܠܝ qṭolī, m.pl. ܩܬܠܐ qṭolū, f.pl. ܩܬܠܝܬ qṭolēn. Negative commands use ܠ lā + imperfect: ܩܬܠܬܝܬ ܠ lā teqtūl ‘do not kill!’.

Participles [L2, L10]

	ACTIVE (CĀCEC)	PASSIVE (CCĪC)
m.sg.	ܟܬܒܐ kāteb	ܟܬܒܐ ktīb
f.sg.	ܟܬܒܬܐ kātā	ܟܬܒܬܐ ktībā
m.pl.	ܟܬܒܝܬܐ kātībīn	ܟܬܒܝܬܐ ktībīn
f.pl.	ܟܬܒܝܬܐ kātībān	ܟܬܒܝܬܐ ktībān

The present tense is participle + enclitic: ܟܬܒܬܝܬܐ kātīb-nā ‘I write, I am writing’ [L2].

Infinitive [L9] — ܩܬܠ meqṭal, usually with ܠ l-: ܠܩܬܠ l-meqṭal ‘to kill’.

A.4 THE DERIVED STEMS

Overview of the six stems [L5, L6, L10] — 3 m.sg. perfect

STEM	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	MEANING	PASSIVE PARTNER
Peal	CCaC	ሃጥላ qṭal	he killed	Ethpeel ሃጥላ 'etqṭel 'he was killed'
Paael	CaCCeC	ፀጠላ qaddeš	he sanctified	Etpaael ፀጠላ 'etqaddaš 'he was sanctified'
Aphel	'aCCeC	ሰጠላ 'aqreb	he offered	Ettaphal ሰጠላ 'ettaqrab 'he was offered'

Before a sibilant (s, š, ṣ, z) the *t* of 'et- swaps places with it: ፀጠላ 'eštma ' 'he was heard', ሰጠላ 'eštaddar 'he was sent' [L10].

Perfect of the derived stems — Paael *q-d-š* 'sanctify', Aphel *q-r-b* 'offer'

PERSON	PAAEL	APHEL
3 m.sg.	ፀጠላ qaddeš	ሰጠላ 'aqreb
3 f.sg.	ፀጠላ qaddšat	ሰጠላ 'aqrbat
2 m.sg.	ፀጠላ qaddešt	ሰጠላ 'aqrebt
1 c.sg.	ፀጠላ qaddšet	ሰጠላ 'aqrbet
3 m.pl.	ፀጠላ qaddešū	ሰጠላ 'aqrebū
2 m.pl.	ፀጠላ qaddeštūn	ሰጠላ 'aqrebtūn
1 c.pl.	ፀጠላ qaddešn	ሰጠላ 'aqrebn

Other forms of the derived stems

	PAAEL	APHEL
Imperfect 3 m.sg.	ܬܩܕܕܝܫ nqaddeš	ܬܩܪܒ naqreb
Imperative m.sg.	ܬܩܕܕ qaddeš	ܬܩܪܒ 'aqreb
Participle m.sg.	ܬܩܕܕܝܫ mqaddeš	ܬܩܪܒ maqreb
Infinitive	ܠܬܩܕܕܝܫ l-mqaddāšū	ܠܬܩܪܒ l-maqrābū

Passive stems: participles [L10] — the prefix *met-*: ܬܩܕܕܝܫ metqṭel ‘being killed’, ܬܩܕܕܝܫ metqaddaš, ܬܩܪܒ mettaqrab.

A.5 WEAK VERBS

III-Yodh perfect [L7] — ܬܪܝܬ ܬܪܝܬ ‘see’

PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.	PERSON	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.
3 m.sg.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzā	3 m.pl.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzaw
3 f.sg.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzāt	3 f.pl.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzay
2 m.sg.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzayt	2 m.pl.	ܬܪܝܬܝܬ	ḥzaytūn
1 c.sg.	ܬܪܝܬ	ḥzēt	1 c.pl.	ܬܪܝܬܝܬ	ḥzayn

III-Yodh imperfect: ܬܪܝܬ neḥzē ‘he will see’, ܬܪܝܬ 'eḥzē, ܬܪܝܬ neḥzōn.

Other weak classes [L7]

CLASS	EXAMPLE	PERFECT	IMPERFECT	NOTE
I-Alaph	'-m-r 'say'	ܐܡܪ 'emar	ܐܡܪܢ nēmar	Alaph is silent after the prefix
I-Yodh	y-d- 'know'	ܝܕܐ īda	ܝܕܢ nedda	initial y becomes ī
I-Nun	n-p-q 'go out'	ܢܦܩ npaq	ܢܦܩܢ neppūq	n assimilates: Aphel ܢܦܩܐ 'appeq
Doubly weak	'-t-y 'come'	ܐܬܝܐ 'etā	ܐܬܝܢ nētē	1 c.sg. ܐܬܝܬ 'etēt
'to be'	h-w-y	ܠܗ hwā	ܠܗܢ nehwē	ܠܗܡ hwā after a participle makes the past continuous

A.6 OBJECT SUFFIXES ON THE VERB

On the 3 m.sg. perfect [L11] — *qṭal* 'he killed' → *qṭal-*

OBJECT	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.	OBJECT	SYRIAC	TRANSLIT.
me	ܡܠܝܐ	qatlanī	us	ܡܠܝܢ	qatlan
you (m.sg.)	ܡܠܝܟܐ	qatlāk	you (m.pl.)	ܡܠܝܟܝܢ	qatlkūn
you (f.sg.)	ܡܠܝܟܬܐ	qatlēk	you (f.pl.)	ܡܠܝܟܬܝܢ	qatlkēn
him	ܡܠܝܗ	qatleh	them (m.)	ܡܠܝܗܝܢ	qatlhūn
her	ܡܠܝܗܐ	qatlāh	them (f.)	ܡܠܝܗܬܝܢ	qatlhēn

A.7 NUMBERS

1–10 [L12] — the form ending in *-ā* goes with masculine nouns

	WITH M. NOUNS	WITH F. NOUNS
1	አ አድ ḥad	አድ ሃድ ḥdā
2	ከሁለት trēn	ከሁለት ትሬት tartēn
3	ሶስት tlātā	ሶስት ትላት tlāt
4	አራት 'arb ' ā	አራት ትላት ' arba '
5	አምስት ḥamšā	አምስት ሃሙሽ ḥammeš
6	ስድስት štā	ስድስት ትሺት šet
7	ሦስት šab ' ā	ሦስት ትሺት ' šba '
8	ጠባቂ tmānyā	ጠባቂ ትሙኔ tmānē
9	ቴሽት teš ' ā	ቴሽት ትሻት ' tša '
10	፳ esrā	፳ት sar

Appendix B: Syriac–English Glossary

All 419 words taught in Lessons 0–12, in Syriac alphabetical order. The last column gives the lesson where the word is introduced.

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ⲁⲃⲁ	ʾabā	Father	noun, m	4
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾaglā	reveal	verb, m, Aphel, root g-l-y	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁⲧⲁ	aglūtā	revelation	noun, f, Peal	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaglī	to reveal	verb, Aphel, root g-l-y	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾaddīn	judge	verb, Aphel, root d-w-n	10
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾednā	ear	noun, f	1
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾawdī	confess, give thanks	verb, Aphel, root ʾ-w-d	10
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾōkmā	how	adv	12
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾōlyā	perhaps	adv	8
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾūlpānā	teaching	noun, m	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗⲁ	ʾūrḥā	way, road	noun, f	1
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾezal	to go	verb, Peal, root ʾ-z-l	7
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaḥā	Brother	noun, m	4
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaḥad	to unite, make one	verb, Peal, root ʾ-ḥ-d	10
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaḥyī	save, give life	verb, Aphel, root ḥ-y-y	10
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaḥyā	give life	verb, m, Aphel, root ḥ-y-y	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaḥyī	to save	verb, Aphel, root ḥ-y-y	5
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾidā	Hand (f)	noun, f	4
ⲁⲓⲕⲗ	ʾaykō	Where?	interrogative	4

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܐܠܟ	ʿekal	to eat	verb, Peal, root ʿ -k-l	7
ܐܠܚܝܐ	ʿkraz	to proclaim	verb, Aphel, root k-r-z	5
ܐܠܒܫܐ	albūšā	clothing	noun, m, Peal	5
ܐܠܒܫ	ʿalbāš	clothe	verb, m, Aphel, root l-b-š	5
ܐܠܗܐ	Alāhā	God	noun, m	0
ܐܠܦܐ	ʿalpā	teach	verb, m, Aphel, root l-p-y	5
ܐܠܦܘܬܐ	alpūtā	teaching	noun, f, Peal	5
ܐܡܡܐ	ʿemmā	Mother	noun, f	4
ܐܡܡܐ	ʿemmā	mother	noun, f	4
ܐܡܪ	ʿemar	to say	verb, Peal, root ʿ -m-r	7
ܐܢ	ʿen	if	conjunction, conj	8
ܐܢܐ	ʿenā	I	pronoun	1
ܐܢܗܪ	ʿanhar	illuminate	verb, Aphel, root n-h-r	10
ܐܢܬ	ʿant	You (m)	pronoun	1
ܐܢܬܘܢ	ʿantūn	You (m.pl)	pronoun	1
ܐܢܬܝ	ʿanti	You (f)	pronoun	1
ܐܢܬܐܢ	ʿantēn	You (f.pl)	pronoun	1
ܐܫܐ	ʿasī	heal	verb, Peal, root ʿ -s-y	10
ܐܫܘܪܐ	ʿesūrā	bond, chain	noun, m, root ʿ -s-r	7
ܐܫܬܪܐܢܠܐ	Estrangelā	“Rounded” script	noun, f	0
ܐܫܐ	ʿasī	to heal	verb, Aphel, root ʿ -s-y	11

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܐܨܪ	ʾasar	to bind, tie	verb, Peal, root ʾ-s-r	9
ܐܨܡܐ	ʾastmā	hide	verb, m, Aphel, root s-t-m	5
ܐܠܬܐ	aʾ lūtā	ascent	noun, f, Peal	5
ܐܦܩ	ʾappiq	I will bring out	pronoun	8
ܐܦܩܕ	ʾapqad	entrust	verb, m, Aphel, root p-q-d	5
ܦܪܩ	ʾpraq	to redeem	verb, Aphel, root p-r-q	5
ܦܪܫ	ʾaprash	separate, distinguish	verb, Aphel, root p-r-š	10
ܐܩܕܕܝܫ	ʾaqaddeš	I will sanctify	pronoun	8
ܩܡܐ	ʾaqūm	raise, stand	verb, m, Aphel, root q-w-m	5
ܩܬܐ	ʾeqtūl	I will kill	pronoun	8
ܩܡܐ	ʾaqīm	raise up	verb, Aphel, root q-w-m	10
ܩܪܒ	ʾaqreb	to bring near	verb, m, Aphel, root q-r-b	5
ܐܪܡ	ʾarīm	to exalt	verb, Aphel, root r-m	10
ܐܪܡܝ	ʾarmī	lift up	verb, m, Aphel, root r-m-y	5
ܐܪܡܠܘܬܐ	ʾarmlūtā	widowhood	noun, f	10
ܐܪܐ	ʾar ʾ ā	earth, land	noun, f	0
ܐܪܕܐ	asdūtā	sending	noun, f, Peal	5
ܐܪܕ	ʾašdar	send	verb, m, Aphel, root š-d-r	5

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܐܫܦܠ	'ašpel	to humble	verb, Aphel, root š-p-l	10
ܐܬܐ	'etā	to come	verb, Peal, root ' -t-y	7
ܐܬܐ	'ātā	sign, omen	noun, f, root ' -t-y	7
ܐܬܪܐ	'atrā	place, country	noun, m	1

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܒܗܬܬܐ	behttā	shame, disgrace	noun, f, root b-h-t	7
ܒܘܪܟܬܐ	būrktā	blessing	noun, f	5
ܒܙ	baz	to plunder, rob	verb, Peal, root b-z-z	11
ܒܝܫܐ	bīšā	evil, bad	noun, m	1
ܒܝܬܐ	baytā	house	noun, m	4
ܒܝܬܐ	baytā	House	noun	4
ܒܢܐ	bnā	to build	verb, Peal, root b-n-y	7
ܒܢܝܢܐ	benyānā	building, structure	noun, m, root b-n-y	7
ܒܫܡܐ	besmā	incense, spice	noun, m	6
ܒܫܪܐ	besrā	flesh	noun, m	1
ܒܬܐ	bā ‘ ē	to want, seek	verb, Peal, root b- ‘ -y	9
ܒܪܐ	bar	son	noun, m	4
ܒܪܐ	brā	Son	noun, m	4
ܒܪܐ	brā	to create	verb, Peal, root b-r- ‘	5
ܒܪܬܐ	brīttā	creation	noun, f	5
ܒܪܪܝܟܐ	barrek	to bless	verb, Paael, root b-r-k	6
ܒܪܢܫܐ	barnāšā	Human, son of man	noun, m	1
ܒܪܬܐ	brattā	Daughter	noun, f	4
ܒܪܬܐ	brattā	daughter	noun, f	4



SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܕܒܥܪܐ	gibbōrā	mighty, strong	adj, m, Peal	4
ܕܕܘܠܘܬܐ	gdūlūtā	greatness, grandeur	noun, f, Peal, root g-d-l	2
ܕܕܪܐ	gāder	to fence, hedge in	verb, Peal, root g-d-r	11
ܕܒܒܐ	gūbbā	pit, cistern	noun, m	9
ܕܕܪܐ	gūrā	dwelling, cave	noun, m, weak, root g-w-r	7
ܕܕܪܐ	gzar	to decree, cut	verb, Peal, root g-z-r	8
ܕܕܪܐ	glā	to reveal	verb, Peal, root g-l-y	10
ܕܕܪܐ	glāyā	revelation, disclosure	noun, f	5
ܕܕܪܐܬܐ	gelyūtā	revelation, manifestation	noun, f, root g-l-y	3
ܕܕܪܐܬܐ	gmīrūtā	completion, perfection	noun, f, root g-m-r	2
ܕܕܪܐܬܐ	gmīrūtā	completion, perfection	noun, f, root g-m-r	11
ܕܕܪܐܬܐ	gəməlūtā	kindness, mercy	noun, f, Peal, root g-m-l	2
ܕܕܪܐ	ganbā	thigh	noun, m, Peal	4
ܕܕܪܐܬܐ	gənūbūtā	theft, stealing	noun, f, Peal, root g-n-b	3
ܕܕܪܐ	garbā	scab, leprosy	noun, m, root g-r-b	3
ܕܕܪܐ	garmā	bone	noun, m	1
ܕܕܪܐ	grār	to drag	verb, Peal, root g-r-r	9

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܕܒܩܘܬܬܐ	dəbīqūttā	clinging, adherence	noun, f, root d-b-q	2
ܕܒܥ	dābeq	to cling, adhere	verb, Peal, root d-b-q	11
ܕܒܪܢܐ	dəbrānā	word, matter	noun, m, Peal, root d-b-r	2
ܕܕܓܫ	dāgaš	to push, press	verb, Peal, root d-g-š	11
ܕܕܩܐ	dūqā	bench, throne	noun, m, weak, root d-w-q	7
ܕܕܪܟܐ	dūrkā	treading, path	noun, m, root d-r-k	3
ܕܠܐ	dḥal	to fear	verb, Peal, root d-ḥ-l	10
ܕܠܐ	deḥlā	fear	noun, m, Peal	8
ܕܠܬܐ	deḥltā	fear, religion	noun, f	1
ܕܠܬܐ	deḥltā	fear/reverence	noun, f, root ܕܠܬܐ / ܕܠܐ	8
ܕܝܘܬܐ	dīyūtā	ink	noun, f	0
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	judgment	noun, m	1
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	judgment, law	noun, m, root / ܕܝܢܐ / ܕܝܢܐ	8
ܕܝܢܐ	dīnā	judgment, law	noun, m	8
ܕܝܫܐ	dayšā	trampling, treading	noun, m, root d-w-š	7
ܕܟܐ	dkā	to purify	verb, Peal, root d-k-y	10
ܕܟܝ	dakkī	to purify	verb, Paael, root d-k-y	6
ܕܟܪܢܐ	dəkrānā	memory, remembrance	noun, m, Peal, root d-k-r	2
ܕܠܗ	dāleh	to draw water	verb, Peal, root d-l-h	11

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܕܡܘܬܬܐ	dāmūttā	likeness, image	noun, f, Peal, root d-m-y	7
ܕܡܢ	dumān	from that place	adv	12
ܕܡܥܬܐ	dem' otā	tear, weeping	noun, f, root d-m-ʿ	3
ܕܢ	dān	to judge	verb, Peal, root d-w-n	8
ܕܪܥܐ	dar' ā	arm	noun, f, Peal	4

ܐ

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܗܕܐ	hādē	this (f)	demonstrative, f	12
ܗܘ	hū	He / It	pronoun	1
ܗܘܐ	haw	that (m)	demonstrative, m	12
ܗܘܝܐ	hewyā	being, existence	noun, m, root h-w-y	7
ܗܝ	hī	She / It	pronoun	1
ܗܝܐ	hāy	that (f)	demonstrative, f	12
ܗܝܠܐ	hayklā	temple, palace	noun, m	1
ܗܝܡܢܘܬܬܐ	haymānūttā	faith, trust	noun, f	5
ܗܝܟܢܐ	hākannā	thus, so	adverb	12
ܗܝܠܠܐܢ	hāllēn	these (c)	demonstrative, c.pl	12
ܗܝܢܐ	hānā	this (m)	demonstrative, m	12
ܗܝܢܐܢ	hennōn	They (m)	pronoun	1
ܗܝܢܐܢ	hānōn	those (m)	demonstrative, m.pl	12
ܗܝܢܐܢ	hennēn	They (f)	pronoun	1
ܗܝܢܐܢ	hānēn	those (f)	demonstrative, f.pl	12

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܐܒܢܐ	zabnā	time	noun, m	8
ܐܒܢܐ	zabnā	time	noun, m, root ܐܒܢ / ܐܒܢܐ	8
ܐܢܐ	zannā	time, era	noun, m, Peal	8
ܐܒܢܐ	z' aq	to cry out	verb, Peal, root z- ' -q	9

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܠܗܕܝܐ	ḥādyā	one	num, m, Peal	12
ܠܗܓܓ	ḥagag	feast	verb, Peal ḥ-g-g	6
ܠܗܕ	ḥad	one	number	12
ܠܗܕܘܬܐ	ḥadūtā	joy	noun, f	8
ܠܗܕܝܐ	ḥdī	to rejoice	verb, Peal, root ḥ-d-y	9
ܠܗܕܝܘܬܐ	ḥadāyūtā	oneness, unity	noun, f, root ḥ-d-y	7
ܠܗܙܐ	ḥāzē	to see	verb, Peal, root ḥ-z-y	2
ܠܗܙܐ	ḥzā	to see	verb, Peal, root ḥ-z-y	7
ܠܗܙܘܐ	ḥezwā	vision, sight	noun, m, root ḥ-z-y	7
ܠܗܬܬܐ	ḥūtā	sin	noun, f	10
ܠܗܝܝܐ	ḥayyē	life	noun, m	1
ܠܗܝܐ	ḥyā	to live	verb, Peal, root ḥ-y-y	7
ܠܗܝܝܐܒ	ḥayyeb	condemn, make guilty	verb, Paael, root ḥ-y-b	10
ܠܗܝܝܘܬܐ	ḥayyūtā	animal, beast	noun, f	8
ܠܗܝܠܐ	ḥaylā	power, army	noun, m	1
ܠܗܝܠܡܬܐ	ḥekmtā	wisdom	noun, f	8
ܠܗܝܠܡ	ḥelam	to dream	verb, Peal, root ḥ-l-m	10
ܠܗܝܠܡܐ	ḥelmā	dream	noun, m, weak, root ḥ-l-m	7
ܠܗܝܠܡܘܬܐ	ḥammīmūtā	heat, warmth	noun, f, root ḥ-m-m	3
ܠܗܝܠܡܫܐ	ḥammšā	five	num, m, Peal	12
ܠܗܝܠܢܐ	ḥnan	We	pronoun	1
ܠܗܝܠܐܪ	ḥāsar	to lack, be deprived	verb, Peal, root ḥ-s-r	11
ܠܗܝܠܐܬܐ	ḥešūkā	darkness	noun, m	12
ܠܗܝܠܐܬܐ	ḥatnā	bridegroom	noun, m, Peal	4

ܬ

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܬܒܐ	ṭābā	good	noun, m	1
ܬܦܣܐ	ṭūpsā	pattern, type	noun, m	7
ܬܪܐ	ṭūrā	mountain	noun, m	8
ܬܝܒܘܬܐ	ṭaybūtā	grace, goodness	noun, f	5
ܬܥܥܐ	ṭappā	strike, beat	verb, m, Paael, root t-p-p	6

ܝ

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܝܕܐ	īda ʿ	to know	verb, Peal, root y-d- ʿ	7
ܝܕܐ	yed ʿ ā	knowledge	noun, m, Peal	8
ܝܕܐܬܐ	īda ʿ tā	knowledge	noun, f, root y-d- ʿ	2
ܝܠܬܐ	yahb	to give	verb, Peal, root y-h-b	7
ܝܘܗܢܢܐ	Yūḥannan	John	noun, m	0
ܝܡܐ	yūmā	day	noun, m, root ܡܐ / ܝܡܐ	8
ܝܙܥܦܐ	yāzəpā	beauty, form	noun, m, noun, root y-z-p	7
ܝܚܕܐ	yḥīddā	alone, unique	adj, m, Peal	4
ܝܬܐܠ	yākel	to be able	verb, Peal, root y-k-l	9
ܝܠܕܐ	īled	to give birth	verb, Peal, root y-l-d	3
ܝܠܕܐ	yled	to give birth	verb, Peal, root y-l-d	10
ܝܠܬܐ	yaleltā	lamenting, wailing	noun, f, root y-l-l	7
ܝܠܥܐ	yallep	teach	verb, Paael y-l-p, root y-l-p	6
ܝܬܐܒܐ	īteb	to sit/enthroned	verb, Peal, root ܬܐܒܐ,	8

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܟܢܘܬܬܐ	kēnūttā	righteousness	noun, f	5
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	stone, rock	noun, f	1
ܟܡܐ	kāhnā	priest	noun, m	6
ܟܡܘܬܐ	kahnūttā	priesthood	noun, f	6
ܟܝܢܐ	kyānā	nature, being	noun, m, root k-w-n	3
ܟܠܗ	kulleh	all	noun, m	5
ܟܠܐ	klā	to prevent, withhold	verb, Peal, root k-l-y	11
ܟܠܒܐ	kalbā	dog	noun, m	8
ܟܠܠ	kallel	to crown	verb, Peal, root k-l-l	10
ܟܠܬܐ	kaltā	bride	noun, f, Peal	4
ܟܢܘܫܬܐ	knūštā	synagogue	noun, f	6
ܟܢܐܫ	knaš	to gather	verb, Peal, root k-n-š	10
ܟܢܫܐ	kansā	crowd, gathering	noun, m	9
ܟܫܐ	kāsā	cup	noun, m	6
ܟܫܝܐ	kassī	to cover, conceal	verb, Pael, root k-s-y	11
ܟܦܪܐ	kəprā	village, hamlet	noun, m, noun, root k-p-r	2
ܟܬܒܐ	ktābā	book, scripture	noun, m	5

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܠܐ	lā	not	particle	3
ܠܒܫܐ	lbūšā	garment, clothing	noun, m, Peal, root l-b-š	2
ܠܒܫܐ	lbūšā	Garment	noun	4
ܠܒܟܬܐ	lebḵātā	capture, grasping	noun, f, root l-b-k	2
ܠܚܡܐ	lahmā	bread, food	noun, m	6
ܠܬܐ	laṭ	curse	verb, Peal l-ṭ	6
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	tongue, language	noun, m	1

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܡܢܐ	mānā	what	pronoun	4
ܡܠܟܐ	ʾallep	to teach	verb, Aphel, root ʾ-l-p	5
ܡܝܬܬܐ	me ʾtittā	coming, arrival	noun, f, root ʾ-t-y	7
ܡܒܪܟܐ	mbarrek	blessing (participle)	noun, m	6
ܡܓܠܬܐ	megalltā	scroll	noun, f	0
ܡܕܒܚܐ	madbhā	altar	noun, m	6
ܡܕܒܪܐ	madbārā	wilderness	noun, m	5
ܡܕܒܪܐܢܐ	mədbərānā	leader, guide	noun, m, Peal, root d-b-r	3
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	city	noun, f	1
ܡܕܕܐ	madd ʾā	knowledge	noun, m, root y-d-ʿ	10
ܡܡܘܚܒܬܐ	mawhaḇtā	gift, offering	noun, f, root y-h-b	7
ܡܡܠܟܐ	mūkkākā	humiliation, lowliness	noun, m, root m-k-k	11
ܡܡܠܚܐ	mḥā	to strike	verb, Peal, root m-ḥ-y	11
ܡܡܠܚܬܐ	mḥūtā	striking, blow	noun, f, root m-ḥ-y	3
ܡܡܠܚܬܐ	meḥartā	tomorrow	noun, f, Peal	8
ܡܡܠܚܬܐ	maṭartā	guard, watch	noun, f, root n-ṭ-r	3
ܡܡܝܐ	mayyā	water	noun, m	1
ܡܡܠܟܬܐ	makknatā	place, position	noun, f, Peal	12
ܡܡܠܬܐ	mektab	writing, book	noun, m	9
ܡܡܠܐ	mlā	to fill	verb, Peal, root m-l-y	10
ܡܡܠܟܐ	malkā	king	noun, m	0

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܡܠܚܘܬܐ	malkūttā	kingdom	noun, f	1
ܡܠܠ	mallel	to speak	verb, Paael, root m-l-l	6
ܡܠܬܐ	meltā	word, Logos	noun, f	1
ܡܠܠܐ	mamlā	speech, discourse	noun, m, root m-l-l	3
ܡܢܐ	mānā	What?	interrogative	4
ܡܫܟܢܐ	meskennā	poor, humble	adj, m, Peal	4
ܡܫܟܢܘܬܐ	meskēnūttā	poverty, want	noun, f, root m-s-k-n	2
ܡܫܩܢܐ	masqānā	ascent, rising	noun, m, root s-l-q	3
ܡܫܩܬܐ	masqetā	ascent, exaltation	noun, f, root s-l-q	7
ܡܫܚܘܬܐ	ma' mūdittā	baptism	noun, f	5
ܡܫܩܩܢܐ	mappqānā	going out, exit	noun, m, root n-p-q	3
ܡܫܚܡܢܘܬܐ	mraḥmānūttā	mercy, compassion	noun, f, root r-ḥ-m	11
ܡܪܡܐ	marmā	raise, exalt	verb, m, Paael, root r-m-y	6
ܡܫܬܗ	mašeḥ	anoint, smear	verb, Paael m-š-ḥ	6
ܡܫܬܗ	mšaḥ	anoint	verb, Peal, root m-š-ḥ	10
ܡܫܬܗ	mešḥā	oil, ointment	noun, m	1



SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܢܒܘܬܬܐ	nebūttā	prophecy	noun, f	5
ܢܒܝܐ	nḇīyā	prophet	noun, m, root n-b- ʾ	7
ܢܓܕ	ngad	to pull, draw	verb, Peal, root n-g-d	11
ܢܗܪ	nahar	to illuminate	verb, Aphel, root n-h-r	10
ܢܗܪܐ	nahrā	river	noun, m	1
ܢܗܪܐ	nūhrā	light	noun, m	0
ܢܘܐ	nūnā	fish	noun, m	1
ܢܘܫܐܬܐ	nussākā	pouring, libation	noun, m, root n-s-k	11
ܢܘܪܐ	nūrā	fire	noun, f	9
ܢܗܗܡ	naḥḥem	to raise (the dead), revive	verb, Paael, root n-ḥ-m	11
ܢܬܪܐܬܐ	nāṭōrūtā	watching, guarding	noun, f, root n-ṭ-r	3
ܢܬܪܐ	nāṭōrtā	guard, watchfulness	noun, f, root n-ṭ-r	2
ܢܬܪ	nṭar	to keep, watch	verb, Peal, root n-ṭ-r	3
ܢܝܗܐ	nyāḥā	rest, tranquility	noun, m, root n-w-ḥ	7
ܢܡܘܫܐ	nāmūsā	Law (from Gk Nomos)	noun, m	0
ܢܫܐܬ	nasak	to pour, cast	verb, Peal, root n-s-k	11
ܢܦܠ	nfal	to fall	verb, Peal, root n-p-l	11
ܢܦܩ	npaq	to go out	verb, Peal, root n-p-q	3

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܫܒܘܬܐ	səb ʿ ūttā	satisfaction, plenty	noun, f, Peal, root s-b-ʿ	3
ܫܒܪܐ	sabrā	hope	noun, m	1
ܫܓܕ	sgad	bow down	verb, Peal s-g-d	6
ܫܓܓܕ	saggad	worship	verb, m, Paael, root s-g-d	6
ܫܓܕܘܬܐ	saḡdūtā	worship	noun, f, Peal	6
ܫܗܕ	sehed (Peal)	to testify/witness	verb, root ܫ.ܗ.ܕ	8
ܫܗܕ	səhed	to witness, testify	verb, Peal, root s-h-d	11
ܫܗܕܐ	sāhdā	witness, martyr	noun, m	1
ܫܗܕܘܬܐ	sāhdūtā	testimony, witness	noun, f, root s-h-d	7
ܫܗܪܐ	sahrā	moon	noun, m	1
ܫܝܓܐ	syāgā	enclosure, hedge	noun, m, root s-w-g	2
ܫܠܩ	sālaq	to ascend, climb	verb, Peal, root s-l-q	3
ܫܘܬܐ	sputā	lip	noun, f, Peal	4
ܫܦܪܐ	sāprā	scribe, writer	noun, m	0

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܒܪܐ	‘ābed	to do, make	verb, Peal, root ‘-b-d	2
ܥܠܐ	‘aggālā	calf (leg part)	noun, m, Peal	4
ܒܠܐ	‘addālā	just, righteous	adj, m, Peal	4
ܒܪܟܐ	‘damā	until	preposition, root ܪܒܟܐ	8
ܐܘܕܪܐܢܐ	‘awdērānā	help, aid	noun, m, noun, root ‘-d-r	7
ܐܘܨܢܐ	‘ūšnā	strength, might	noun, m, root ‘-š-n	2
ܐܘܨܢܐ	‘ūšnā	strength, power	noun, m, root ‘-š-n	7
ܥܝܢܐ	‘aynā	eye	noun, f	1
ܐܠܡܐ	‘ālmā	world, eternity	noun, m, root ‘-l-m	7
ܐܠܡܐ	‘ālmā	world, eternity	noun, m, root ܐܠܡ / ܐܠܡܐ	8
ܐܠܡܐ	‘ālmā	world, eternity	noun, m	8
ܐܠܩܐ	‘alqā	ascent, stairway	noun, m, Peal, root ‘-l-q	2
ܐܡܡܐ	‘ammā	people	noun, m	5
ܒܡܕ	‘mad	to baptize	verb, Peal, root ‘-m-d	10
ܒܡܕ	‘āmed	to stand firm	verb, Peal, root ‘-m-d	11
ܒܡܕܐ	‘amdā	pillar, column	noun, m, noun, root ‘-m-d	3
ܒܡܡܪܐ	‘ammūrā	uncle (paternal)	noun, m, Peal	4
ܒܡܡܩܐ	‘ammqā	deep	adj, m, Peal	4

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܐܡܪ	‘āmar	to dwell, inhabit	verb, Peal, root ‘-m-r	11
ܐܡܡܬܐ	‘ammtā	aunt (paternal)	noun, f, Peal	4
ܐܫܒܐ	‘esbā	grass	noun, m	10
ܐܫܪܐ	‘esrā	ten	num, m, Peal	12
ܐܩܪ	‘aqar	to root out, dig	verb, Peal, root ‘-q-r	3
ܐܩܬܐ	‘āqtā	distress, anguish	noun, f	8
ܐܪܒܐ	‘erbā	sheep	noun, m	8
ܐܪܕܩܐ	‘ārōqā	fugitive	noun, f, Peal, root ‘-r-q	3
ܐܪܬܐܝܬܐ	‘arṭlāyūtā	nakedness, exposure	noun, f, root ‘-r-ṭ-l	2
ܐܪܩ	‘raq	to flee	verb, Peal, root ‘-r-q	3
ܐܫܢ	‘əšan	to strengthen, prevail	verb, Peal, root ‘-š-n	11
ܐܬܬܪܐ	‘attirā	rich, mighty	adj, m, Peal	4

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܩܠܬܐ	p'āltā	trust, confidence	noun, f, Peal	8
ܩܝܪܐ	pīrā	fruit	noun, m	8
ܩܝܪܐ	peg'ā	encounter, accident	noun, m, root p-g-'	2
ܩܕܐ	pəda'	to inform, make known	verb, Peal, root p-d-'	11
ܩܠܬܐ	pūlhānā	labor, toil	noun, m, Peal, root p-l-ḥ	2
ܩܡܐ	pūmā	mouth	noun, m	1
ܩܡܐ	pūnnāyā	answer, return	noun, m, root p-n-y	11
ܩܡܕܐ	pūqdānā	commandment	noun, m	6
ܩܝܪܐ	pūrā	fruit	noun, m, weak, root p-w-r	7
ܩܡܝܐ	purqānā	redemption, salvation	noun, m	5
ܩܠܓܐ	palggā	divide	verb, m, Paael, root p-l-g	6
ܩܠܓܬܐ	pəlgūtā	division, share	noun, f, Peal, root p-l-g	2
ܩܠܓܬܐ	palgūtā	division	noun, f, Peal	6
ܩܠܬܐ	plah	to serve, work	verb, Peal, root p-l-ḥ	3
ܩܠܬܐ	pəlhūtā	service, labor	noun, f, Peal, root p-l-ḥ	3
ܩܠܬܐ	paltā	escape, safety	noun, m, Peal	4
ܩܡܡܐ	pəsmā	measure, standard	noun, m, noun, root p-s-m	2
ܩܡܐ	pāsa'	to cut, prune	verb, Peal, root p-s-'	11
ܩܡܐ	paqed	to command	verb, Peal, root p-q-d	9
ܩܡܐ	pəqrā	opening, aperture	noun, m, Peal, root p-q-r	2
ܩܡܐ	parzappā	interpreter	noun, m, Peal	6
ܩܡܐ	pāraḥtā	bird	noun, f	8
ܩܡܐ	praq	to save, redeem	verb, Peal, root p-r-q	10
ܩܡܐ	praq	redeem, save	verb, Peal, root p-r-q	10

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܦܪܫܐ	prāš	to separate	verb, Aphel, root p-r-š	10

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SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܫܒܐ	šābē	to wish	verb, Peal, root š-b-y	9
ܫܒܝܢܐ	šebyānā	will, desire	noun, m	9
ܫܒܝܐ	šeb̄ ‘ ā	finger	noun, f, root š-b-‘	2
ܫܠܒܐ	šlab	to crucify	verb, Peal, root š-l-b	10
ܫܠܒܐ	šlab	crucify	verb, Peal, root š-l-b	10
ܫܠܬܐ	šlūttā	prayer	noun, f	6
ܫܠܝܐ	šallī	pray	verb, Pael, root š-l-y	6
ܫܡܐ	šam	fast, abstain	verb, Peal, root š-w-m	6
ܫܝܪܐ	širē	side, rib	noun, f, Peal	4

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܩܒܠ	qabbel	to receive	verb, Paael, root q-b-l	6
ܩܒܪ	qbar	to bury	verb, Peal, root q-b-r	10
ܩܕܕܫܐ	qaddāšā	make holy	verb, m, Paael, root q-d-š	6
ܩܕܕܫܘܬܐ	qaddištūtā	holiness, sanctity	noun, f, root q-d-š	2
ܩܕܡ	qdām	before	preposition	3
ܩܕܫ	qaddaš	to sanctify	verb, Paael, root q-d-š	5
ܩܕܫܘܬܐ	qaddšūtā	holiness	noun, f, Peal	6
ܩܒܒܠܐ	qubbālā	acceptance, reception	noun, m, root q-b-l	11
ܩܘܡܐ	qūmā	standing, resurrection	noun, m, I-Yodh, root q-y-m	7
ܩܘܪܒܐ	qūrbā	drawing near, approach	noun, m, root q-r-b	3
ܩܘܪܒܐܢܐ	qūrbānā	offering	noun, m	6
ܩܬܐ	qṭal (Peal)	to kill	verb, Peal, root ܩ.ܬ.ܠ	8
ܩܬܠܐ	qetlā	slaughter, killing	noun, m, root q-ṭ-l	3
ܩܝܡܐ	qyāmā	covenant	noun, m	1
ܩܝܫܐ	qaysā	wood, tree	noun, m	1
ܩܠܐ	qālā	Voice (m)	noun, m	4
ܩܠܝܠܐ	qlillā	small, few	adj, m, Peal	4
ܩܠܡܐ	qalmā	pen, reed	noun, m	0
ܩܠܦܬܐ	qalpəttā	shell, exterior	noun, f, noun, root q-l-p	2

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܩܪܐ	qrā	to call, read	verb, Peal, root q-r-	7
ܩܪܐ	qerā	cold	noun, m, III-Alaph, root q-r-	7
ܩܪܒ	qreb	to draw near	verb, Peal, root q-r-b	3
ܩܪܐܬܐ	qerūtā	calling, vocation	noun, f, III-Alaph, root q-r-	7
ܩܪܬܐ	qrītā	village	noun, f	1
ܩܪܫܐ	qarṣā	parchment	noun, m	0

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SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܪܐܝܐ	rāzā	mystery	noun, m	5
ܪܒܐ	rabbā	Great, large	noun, m	1
ܪܒܠܐ	reglā	foot	noun, f	1
ܪܒܡܐ	regmā	stoning, lapidation	noun, m, root r-g-m	3
ܪܕܦܐ	redūpyā	pursuit, persecution	noun, m, root r-d-p	3
ܪܕܝܐ	rugzā	rage, wrath	noun, m, root r-g-z	2
ܪܕܝܐ	rugzā	anger, wrath	noun, m	9
ܪܗܐ	rūḥā	spirit, wind	noun, f	5
ܪܡܐ	rawmā	height, elevation	noun, m, root r-w-m	2
ܪܡܡܐ	raḥmē	mercy	noun, m	5
ܪܫܐ	rēšā	Head (m)	noun, m	4
ܪܝܒܐ	rākeb	to ride, mount	verb, Peal, root r-k-b	11
ܪܡܐ	rmā	to throw, cast	verb, Peal, root r-m-y	9
ܪܫܐ	rešā	head (leadership)	noun, m, Peal	8

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܫܒܒܗ	šabbeḥ	to praise	verb, Paael, root š-b-ḥ	6
ܫܒܝܐ	šəbyā	captive, prisoner	noun, m, root š-b-y	3
ܫܒܝܬܐ	šbītā	captivity, escape	noun, f, root š-b-y	3
ܫܒܩ	šbaq	to leave, abandon	verb, Peal, root š-b-q	3
ܫܒܬܐ	šabbtā	sabbath, week	noun, f, root š-b-t	2
ܫܕܪ	šadar	send	verb, Peal, root š-d-r	10
ܫܕܪܐ	šedārā	sending, mission	noun, m	5
ܫܘܒܗܐ	šūbhā	glory, praise	noun, m	5
ܫܘܒܩܐܢܐ	šūbqānā	(one) abandoned	noun, m, Peal, root š-b-q	3
ܫܘܒܩܐܢܐ	šubqānā	forgiveness, remission	noun, m, root š-b-q	3
ܫܘܠܗܐ	šuhlāpā	change, alteration	noun, m, root š-ḥ-l-p	2
ܫܘܩܐ	šūqā	street, market	noun, m	8
ܫܠܗ	šlah	to strip off / cast away	verb, verb, Peal, root š-l-ḥ	12
ܫܠܝܐ	šelyā	quiet, peace	noun, m, root š-l-y	7
ܫܠܝܬܐ	šallītā	authority, ruler	noun, m, root š-l-ṭ	3
ܫܠܡܐ	šlāmā	peace, greeting	noun, m	1
ܫܠܡܘܬܐ	šəlmūttā	completeness, wholeness	noun, f, Peal, root š-l-m	2
ܫܡܝܪܐ	šəmīrā	watch, guard	noun, m, Peal, root š-m-r	11

SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܫܡܐ	šāma ʿ	to hear	verb, Peal, root š-m- ʿ	2
ܫܡܡܝܫ	šammeš	minister	verb, Paael š-m-š	6
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	sun	noun, m	1
ܫܢܐ	šānē	to change, alter	verb, Peal, root š-n-y	11
ܫܡܠ	špel	humiliate	verb, Peal, root š-p-l	10
ܫܡܠܐ	šep ʿ ā	abundance, plenty	noun, m, Peal, root š-p- ʿ	2
ܫܩܠ	šqal	to lift, carry	verb, Peal, root š-q-l	11
ܫܪܐ	šrā	loosen, release	verb, Peal, root š-r-y	3
ܫܪܒ	šāreb	to drink	verb, Peal, root š-r-b	11
ܫܪܝ	šarī	to begin	verb, Peal, root š-r-y	9
ܫܪܪܐ	šarrar	to confirm, make firm	verb, Pael, root š-r-r	11
ܫܪܪܐ	šrārā	truth, reality	noun, m	12
ܫܬܝܐ	šetyā	drinking	noun, m, root š-t-y	11

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SYRIAC	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH	GRAMMAR	L.
ܬܒ	tāb	to return	verb, Peal, root t-w-b	10
ܬܒ	tāb	return, repent	verb, Peal, root t-w-b	10
ܬܒܐ	tbar	to break	verb, Peal, root t-b-r	11
ܬܐܪܐ	tawrā	bull, ox	noun, m	1
ܬܠܓܐ	talggā	ridge, back	noun, m, Peal	4
ܬܪܕ	trad	cast out, expel	verb, Peal, root t-r-d	10
ܬܪܓܡܐ	tregumā	translation	noun, m, Peal	12
ܬܪܐ	tar ʿ ā	door, gate	noun, m	1